

My Dear D.R. Evans

I am taking a few moments to send my best regards to all of you there in the far West.

As I have no better way to pass on information to my brothers D. Robert and John Roberts – if they have been fortunate enough and had the health, to reach their journey's end as they had hoped. Please make inquiries about them and pass on this letter or take the opportunity to convey its contents. I want to give them information about some incidents that have occurred since they set off.

1. David Lloyd (from Tremadog) died on July 6th (6?)
2. Grace Pugh (from Fron Heulog) has died.
3. William Jones (Bryn Golau) has also gone the way of all worldly beings.
4. I go on to outline what happened to our Father. On the 21st of September he began shaking, and this fever continued - almost every other day. Within two days of his death the fever went on all day and he died on October 3rd at 4p.m. On the afternoon of the 7th of that month we went on to lay his worldly remains in Ramoth Cemetery, in the same grave as our dear Mother.

In the short time between your departure and his passing he thought a lot about you and the family and very often spoke about you to me whilst we were in the workshop. He wondered how things were for you and the children. We, that is Ellin and myself, have a great feeling of longing after you (*he uses the word Hiraeth – a Welsh word which conveys the feeling of loss/longing and for which there is no real English translation.*)

In regards to news about the Erw family (*family farm*), there have been a few changes since you began your journey. Rees has married Anne, the youngest daughter of Thomas Roberts (Garreg) and Ellin has gone to America with her uncle William David, formerly of Cae Glas. He and his wife returned to the Old Country and she went back with them. They set off on September 1st and arrived safely in America on 2nd of October.

The rest of the family are well as usual. As regards our own situation, we are thinking about returning to live in Gelli.

We would have written to you earlier, but we were expecting to hear from you again – we have received a total of six letters from you – 3 from Liverpool, and 3 from America.

I thought that you would appreciate hearing about the Creuau family but I do not have much to say other than that everything is much as it always is. Mary Owens of Tan-y-Ddualt is well.

We would write in more detail if we knew that this letter was actually going to reach you. When we receive a letter back from you saying that you have safely reached your journey's end and settled into employment, we can go on to exchange more detailed letters. I will remain concerned about you until I receive a detailed letter from you describing how you got on. As they say in English "*The Truth and Nothing but the Truth!*".

We send Gwen our very best regards and want to know how she and her children are getting on. We wish her every success – both materially and spiritually.

We really look forward to receiving a reply to this letter – either from you {*D.R. Evans*} or from one of our brothers. If you cannot find any information about them, please write to let us know that nothing is known about them.

I am your servant

Edward Roberts, Gelli Park, Llanfrothen, Tan y Bwlch, Caernarvonshire

To Mr D.R. Evans, Great Salt Lake

From John Lloyd

Not much has changed since I last wrote on August 1st. We are both in fairly good health and send you our best regards. We await your reply as soon as possible. If anything unusual happens, I will keep you informed.

John Lloyd

To the Elder David Roberts

Dear Brother

My heart is thrilled to have the privilege of writing this letter to you in the "Mountain Valley" – that place where you heart longed to see for such a long period and where my heart also longs to visit. But I have not yet sold my soul to Br. Despair and I don't intend to do so either. I believe that I may be given the honour to come over there, after I have finished my work here- but I would love to come even sooner. The word Despair is almost out of use amongst the Saints these days, replaced by the words Br. Faith in their vocabulary – a much better friend don't you think? I am sure that you have read much about the strength of Br. Faith but not much is written about Br. Despair - he never did very much.

Perhaps you will remember reading in the 'Herald Gymraeg' {*Welsh newspaper*} that the two most hated words in the Welsh language are "except" and "If only" and these are certainly closely connected.

When I waved you goodbye in Liverpool (I lost sight of you as you boarded the steam tug) I had a strange new feeling that I find hard to describe. It gave me *hiraeth* {*longing*} and certainly made me very uncomfortable. I felt as happy as I'd ever felt before I left you. a strange feeling suddenly came over me - almost as if I something flashed through my whole constitution. We people are not accustomed to such feelings, but we control our feelings and passions in circumstances such as these rather than allow ourselves to be governed by them. These feelings were all the more intense because I had planned to be there with and made such a commitment to this, and I was deeply disappointed that these plans could not be realised but had to be cast aside. I have decided not to concentrate so much on but to await the command "Go! You are now free to go." Then, as you can imagine, it will not be long before I make myself ready for the journey.

Since I last reported to you up until September 3rd I have been travelling through the Merionethshire Conference. At that time I received a letter from Machynlleth from Br. Daniels asking me to take on the Conwy Valley & Anglesey Conference because my precursor Evan S Morgans wanted to be relieved. I decided to agree to this request but not until I had thought hard about my weaknesses because of my???... ???.... the commands and resting that I undertake them after taking upon myself this work. More than anything, I worry because I am not a very good preacher – as you well know! But "Strength by the day and assistance will follow the need" as the saying goes.

I came to Eglwysbach on Sunday, September 7th for the Cymanfa {*singing festival*} that was to be held there and I was confirmed in the post on that day. I am keen to perform this work diligently and not to bring shame in any way. I know that I must pray and work hard, and try to keep myself in suitable spirits, lest I allow myself to fall to the evils of pride and boastfulness, forgetting that I am the servant and not the master. It is quite difficult work to keep to the centre-path but much is to be gained from keeping to that path and keeping the wheels on track. Our responsibility is to pray and take care to be the best driver that we can be.

Well, it is good to inform you that I am currently enjoying good health, despite being quite unwell last summer, when I suffered quite a bit, but I am now improved, so that I look as good as ever and I am feeling good. I am much better than I would have been had I come there with you – it is important to follow advice and stay put if advised to do so. ... ??Staying?? in Hell is what I intend to do now (as Little Jane says).

I hope that you are well and comfortable when you receive this letter, and all the family likewise. We are currently very far apart but, don't worry, everything will be fine if we do our duty. That is what will in the end bring us Eternal Life.

Six of your letters have reached Ffestiniog and they were excellent letters - excelling on ones that I had seen from other emigrants. Two letters, from ... Jones and one from Pastor Parry, were quite good but the others were pretty poor, to tell the truth. I would advise anybody who intends to write to Wales, to ask somebody who can actually write well for assistance (unless they write properly themselves) because, when people receive a letter from the Valley, they expect to learn something about what is going on there, and hope to get something for the shilling which pays for its

receipt. {at the time, **recipients** probably paid for postage} I will now leave this subject, but I do wish people would do the best they could.

I replied to all of the letters (except the one that was sent to Owen Prichard – that one didn't turn up) and I read them to all the Saints from the North. There was great praise from everybody – both from the Saints and the worldly people (because I read them to tens of people 'of the world'). "That's what a proper letter should be like" said one, "Good on you, Dafydd" said another "What a fine man Dafydd was" said the others. There was great praise from the quarrymen in Ffestiniog for the letter that you sent them and they hope that you will write after you reach the Valley. They gave special praise for the englyn {poems} which you sent - remember to send more the next time. Continue to set a good example and send as many letters as possible in order to clear the fog that continues to cloud the minds of the people here about these things.

I now want to say a few words aimed at those brothers who have been over there for a number of years, but have not sent a letter to their relatives or anybody else since their arrival. Brothers! Wake up, and help us to clear the minds of these people about the Saints' ways and our beliefs. You know pretty well that there are many of these people, and tell them the truth and I am sure that the men would believe what they read in a letter from one of you. But alas, it is not so, and the people just say "They cannot write anything other than what their leaders tell them to. They are ashamed of the new country, otherwise they would have written something about it. They would say how bad it is but they are so determined to stay, that they have decided to keep quiet and say nothing."

Brothers, this is what they say, and now in order to help these people to change their tune (and to help us dispel these bad, unfounded rumours that are told about you over here), write back, every one of you, and seriously, get on with the task! "Better late than never".

Tell David Evans to write back to his sister and relatives and tell Peter Edwards the same. They complained bitterly that they had not received letters. There are many brothers who, on leaving, promised faithfully that they would write once they had settled but they did not do so. In this group we have John Evans Esq. Brothers all, remember to fulfil your promises immediately, so that people are not greatly disappointed in us. They expect us to be better than we can ever be, but we should make every effort to be as good as we possibly can. Tell Br. Evans that the people of Waen Hir, Llandygai, Bangor have long expected a letter from him but have not received a single one. Hence Br. Evans should write them an excellent letter lest they have reason to tell false rumours about him. I don't think that Br. Evans is alone in this group. Oh, no! Some dozens are in the same group. Brothers, "If the cap fits", then don't blame me. I have to tell the truth if I am not to disappoint thousands of people. I don't wish to upset anybody, I always do what is in your best interests.

To finish, I will always do everything possible to protect your character, one and all but I wish that you would throw yourself at this task "With both hand and heart" so that you restore your loved ones' faith in you. Because their allegiance at the moment is wearing pretty thin. Dozens of letters arriving there will give them a refresh and who knows, that this will not encourage them to spread God's Word more than ever.

The people from Waen Hir's address are as follows: Mr Robert Thomas (or Robert Thomas Roberts), Waen Hir, Llandygai, Nr Bangor, Caernarfonshire, North Wales. Br. Evans should remember to note Caernarfonshire as there is another Bangor in Flintshire.

I am sure that you would like some news about what is happening to the Church here in Wales. Dewi Elfed and John Jones returned to the church. Dewi had been travelling through the south Wales conferences and Br. Jones is a Pastor for the north, instead of Parry, but not in the same sense as Parry. Br Jones only travels through the conferences there is a Council in every Conference every month and Br. Jones attends every one and travels to every branch in all the Conferences. He is very lively and does great work here in the north. I got a letter from him yesterday . He sends you all his best regards.

There has been much public baptisms recently throughout the south. There was a lot of persecution of the Saints in Mold recently as some old fool came to lecture against them causing a lot of bad feeling amongst people but things turned out well for us in the end. Seven people were baptised in about two months before then as some people rose up against this fraud.

This reminds me of something that I heard about the Fench. "If they aren't warring against somebody else, then they will make war against themselves!" I am sure that these Saints are of the same mind.

Many have been baptised in this Conference recently but you would not know them so I shall not note their names here.

The Merinethshire Conference is pretty flat still despite the efforts to sell books in every town, village and almost every house in the Conference. Two were baptised in Machynlleth namely Hugh Edwards (the south Walian that you have heard me talk about and who was quite drawn to getting drunk) and his son and also Br. Edwards is determined to make a real effort from now on.

The Kingdom has been put in place in this country at this time and indeed it is flourishing s a result of being well-received on the whole, but we know that some are opposing this advice but they may as well not bother because I am certain that it is bound to make its way amongst the Saints in Wales. Every one now pays one tenth of their earnings as a collection and this Tithe money is split, some towards some towards the Temple and some towards other similar collections. This is a far better way to share the burden equally between everybody. Br. Pratt has decided to give every Saint a lot to do. Everybody has to take two essays a week which they will lend to their neighbours informing them about our principles. Women, children and everyone who is a Saint is to undertake this task. Two essays to every household and the following week they are to collect them and replace them with two others and taking the old ones to others. Hence the work will multiply as new people will receive them every week. Br. Pratt is determined that through this means, with the Saints working faithfully, warn all the British people about this within a year.

The names and prices of our books, where they may be bought, and when and where our meetings are held, is printed on the covers, for they supply covers for all the essays already published and give details of all the publications. On the back cover of all of these is written "The reader is asked to keep this essay clean. It will be collected at the end of the week when it can be bought or returned. Training will be given to any reader who wishes to follow the teachings of this church. If they inquire to the President of this Conference".

The essay which was published in "Deserett News" under the heading "Mormon Marriage in Utah" was translated into Welsh by Dewi Elfed and there is a big effort to spread it throughout Wales. We have almost sold 550 copies of this essay in this Conference. I read in last edition of The Star about an excellent meeting that the Saints held in Durham, England about a fortnight ago on ..., Sunday in a powerful spirit. Br. Amos Muss... called it a Pentecostal Meeting (it was he that wrote the article) and that is quite an appropriate name for it. Some other prophesied, some spoke and some translated and "Angels" were in attendance. Br. Israel Evans and Astyn(?) visited me in the North and honestly, we learnt a lot from them. Almost everybody in the North has been re-baptised, and all through Wales I believe. We feel much better because of this.

In many places there are major efforts to learn English. I am sure that you saw the letter in the "Herald Gymraeg" from Richard M Stevens, complaining that the Saints had stolen his money. He has died and his wife has an interesting letter in the Herald last week (it would be better for her too to be quiet lest she see what sort of a place there is in the Land of the Spirits sooner than she may wish). It is a letter that she wrote to her brother in Wrexham and I copy it for you here.

"Grabbing Coal Diggers" St. Jonis/Louis(?) June 26, 1856

Dear Brother

I take this opportunity to write hoping that you are well. They leave me in quite a poorly state to be honest.

Dear Brother

I am sad to write that Richard Stevens has died. He worried a lot after leaving home. He never enjoyed himself but always wanted to return home. The doctor says that he killed himself by vexing and having too little food. He died last Sunday leaving us lonely and poor but, if I trust in my God he will be my good friend.

Dear Brother

It is very bad for us since we came over. I don't have money to bury Stevens but the neighbours helped out and I still depend on their charity.

Dear Brother

We have been very unfortunate. We had lost all our boxes (chests) with all our possession except what we had on our backs. I did not like going to Salt Lake. They stole our clothes and refused to give them back despite my having repaid our debts. Will you please inform William Williams (Abergele) that you have heard from us and send all my regards to anyone who asks about me.

I would be very grateful if you could reply. We will speak again. I would have written but poor Stevens begged me not to and prevented me from doing so.

I am your heartbroken sister,
Anne Stevens

To: Mr Frederick Roberts"

This is an example of the way that the Devil uses her as a weapon to blaspheme the Hallowed Saints. I explained the background to this letter yesterday whenever I had the opportunity to do so.

You probably will want some news about home. I have not heard anything from them since six weeks ago, but everybody was well when I left. I slept at Gelli twice and had the warmest possible welcome by all the family.

Edward ???heard??? the Old New Religion from me (???) and your father was very respectful towards me. He wanted to talk about you all the time "Dafydd was a great son" he said "I really loved Dafydd".

"He signed up everybody that came to his meetings" he said, "He signed almost 60 of them in the quarry once".

"I won't say anything bad about them because they went away" he said "I did my best to get them to stay but, as they were intent on going, I wished them every blessings along the way".

Everyone at Gelli was very glad that you sent a letters home. Everybody at Creuau was healthy but everything seemed to be going too well for them – perhaps they would prefer to hear that Sister Roberts was ill rather than she was doing as well as you described. I visited Mary Owen (Mary's mother) and read her your letters. She was very welcoming towards me and wanted me to send Br. Roberts, Mary and the children her best regards. She reports that she is as well as when they left. A terrible tragedy had just struck the locality at the time. About two months prior a gentleman from England had visited the Maentwrog Vicar together with his two sons and they went swimming or doing something by the river, both boys drowned and their father was the one that raised the bodies from the river. I have been with Margaret Jones (Garreg) many times and always received warm welcome from her and her mother. We were never allowed to leave without a bellyful of food, Mormon principles still burn in Margaret's breast although some clouds have been cast over her. She and her mother send you all theiur very warmest regards. Rees, your nephew married the girl from the shop at Gar.... after you had left , he was married when {page ends}

... that he had received a letter from Robert. Her brother Robert's daughter, has emigrated to America about two months ago. She married some lad from Traeth Bach recently; his name was Owen Jones. I think that he is the son of Old Hen Gaeau (as they used to call him) who had a horse and cart and used to ford the estuary. Somehow or other, he ended up in a whirlpool, and was drowned. The horse came safely to shore but it was a long time before his body was found.

There was some trouble in Ffestiniog some time back. What happened was that John Jones (Penlan) had an accident at Llechwedd Quarry (I believe) and broke his ribs and right arm, and only lived for a week after this. He was attended to by John Roberts {*an un-qualified, quarry first-aider, very popular with the workmen, but detested by the professional doctors (who were much more expensive of course!)*}. It was not realised he had broken ribs until after his death - if they had found this out at the beginning and treated him properly, he would have lived, some alleged. An inquest was held and a post-mortem undertaken and John Roberts was subsequently accused of Manslaughter. Roberts was brought before the magistrates at Dolgellau but found to be Not Guilty- much to the acclaim of Ffestiniog quarrymen. On his return to Congl-y-Wal, they carried him shoulder high through the village, shouting "Hurrah!" and everybody had a great time. They all agreed that John had had a close shave – the two qualified doctors (the "Red" Doctor and Vaughan Jones) had tried their best to have John found guilty, but old John won the day.

Jason and his family were well when I last saw them and he sends his best regards. Griffiths (Harlech) did not receive the clothes that you had left for him, or the sack either. ...?... Anne Jones was?... the sack ...?... but denies all responsibility and knowledge ...?... for the clothes ...?... thus leaving poor Griffith with none of the clothes. Griffith and family were healthy but Owen Jones (Sister Hughes' brother) had been very ill recently, but he was much better when I last saw him.

The Cricieth people are well and send their best regards to you and to Pastor Parry. They want Pastor Parry to write them a letter. It should be addressed to "Capt. Robert Williams, Ty'n y Grisiau Cottage, Cricieth, Caernarfonshire.

I got a letter from Br. Daniels ...?... was healthy ...?... David Davies (Machynlleth) married a local girl, Mary Wilson , a small woman but as full of spirit as you have ever seen! They got married about a month after you set off.

As regards the World Situation, the Crimean War has now finished, but some disputes persist.

There is something between the Allies and Naples at the moment and the king refuses to do something that they insist upon. They are sending their navies there to send him some hot projectiles! The "Herald Gymraeg " {newspaper} reported that a letter from Marseilles reports "The French fleet is about to set off for Naples and some Sardinians are to set off from Genoa. They continue to prepare their defences in Naples. A letter from Ajaccio on the 14th says that the British fleet had set off according to instructions sent from London."

Russia is thought of as being rather like Ismael and?... by being up for a fight against anybody. Russia is always at war with someone as this report from the Herald shows "Journal de Constantinople: A fierce battle has been fought on the river Taka between the Russians and Turks when the latter won a temporary battle with their foes. The Russians left 16th....?... and 800 captives in the hands of the Circasians".

It is reported that the Russian army was forced back to the river Ruban with significant loses in men and arms. There was fierce fighting between the Persians and some of their neighbours recently (the Afghanistans) when the Persians killed about 800 of them and took their city on the river Herat. It is likely that England saw that the Persians had been unfair in this. This is what the Herald has to say "Constantinople: The English have sent 16,000 men to the Persian Gulf to attack that country due to the ...?... Herat which was contrary to the Treaty of 1853"

There was an accident in London recently when seven people were killed and 60 injured. It appears that a very important preacher with the Baptists who goes by the name C.H. Spurgeon used to preach at Exeter Hall. However, the hall became too small for him and consequently another, larger hall was used and they paid £15 a night in somewhere called Surrey Gardens. He was to preach there the Sunday before last. The hall was packed with people - about 10,000 inside and another 8,000 outside, failing to get admittance. When the preacher was half way through his sermon some idiots shouted from the middle of the balcony (there were three balconies there) "Fire! Fire! The place is on fire!" there was an indescribable rush and the hall was filled with women and children screaming and people rushing for exits and jumping through windows. Despite every effort by the preacher to warn them that there was no danger, the result was that seven were killed and 60 injured with broken legs, arms and horrible wounds.

There was an accident at a coal mine close to my home in Neath two months ago. Fire broke out underground and 114 were killed on one day. The mine was Cymmer, Rhondda.

There was an announcement in the newspapers about a terrible earthquake that happened in ...?... Islands when about 3,000 lost their lives.

Water flooded a coal pit at Brymbo, Denbighshire about three weeks ago and 20 were killed.

I must bring this letter to a close. Tell Br. John Roberts that I send him, Mary and the children my best regards. Tell them that I visited their debtors three times and I tried my best to get some money from them, but with no success. Remember me to Parry and William Lewis and Br. Hughes and Sister Hughes (Harlech)and Margaret Jones and Susannah Roberts and remember me to Robert Roberts (formerly of Llantrisant).

All the Saints of the Conference send you their best regards. John Davies (Bethesda) is working very hard. They all want to send their best wishes to Abel Evans.

Why don't you write a letter her, you cad! I send you and Sister Roberts my best regards, and to Robert Thomas and Daniel, and Anne Elizabeth very kindly and especially to Jane. This line from Gwilym Hiraethog's poem describes her "The fondest mother ever to be born in all of Wales".

I hope that you will reply as soon as possible. Address as follows: William Ajax, c/o Edward Parry, Tanygraig, Llandudno, Caernarfonshire

Your Brother in the Lord
William Ajax

Dear Friend

I had totally given up all hope of hearing from you.

There have been many changes since you left but I cannot give you any information about Ffestiniog since Dafydd will be reviewing ATOLYGU my work and so I will leave that to him as he was there more recently than I was and I don't hear much about the place despite being quite close.

My dear friend, I have been here for six months now and I was in Llwyn-y-gell three months before being here. What takes most of my time now is learning my tasks that I am given.

I was delighted to understand that you had arrived over there fit and well. I send you all as a family my best regards – especially Daniel and little Jane. I appeal to you dear friend, please write me a letter and tell me the **truth** about things are. I know that there are many things being said about what is happening to the Saints in California.

I forgot to say that I ...?...

Date: 1857

12th Carried wood and slate flooring to the ship to finish loading (plenty of flags or slate flooring were to be found along the lake shore)

13th The anchor was raised and sails extended to the wind for a second time but as we set off there wasn't enough depth of water for us to sail as there was a wind blowing towards the shore and the water was too shallow. By 4 o'clock in the afternoon they managed to get her to deeper water. We were close to being blown onto Church Island {today called Antelope Island} but by 4a.m. on the 14th we reached Black Rock with the Timely Gull (that was the ship's name) carrying its first(?) cargo. They reached Salt Lake City on Saturday 15th. My father heard Arapeen, one of the Indian chiefs, speaking in the Tabernacl, where there were about 2,00 people present in the audience.

16th Stayed in the City

17th Returned home.

On the 23rd of the above month my father and I set off for Boxelder about 42 miles north of here, where my Aunt Gwen and family live. We received a very warm welcome. I think that my Uncle David R. Evans is a very good man. They have enough worldly goods around them. Plenty of wheat GWENITH to feed them and plenty of animals at their service.

We saw a letter written from Cae'r Llwynog {Gwen's father's home in Croesor} after we had set off from the Old Country. And from this we understood that you had gotten married, and a few other things. We visited David Peters and his family, Cadwaladr Owens and his family, Owen Jones (formerly of Tŷ Main). Owen Jones looks particularly well. He has a machine to help with the work and with this he collected 60 bushels of wheat last year. He is very well-dressed.

We visited many of the other Welsh people and received every kindness. It really was like being back in the Old Country. The sound of the Welsh language was to be heard there in both speech and song; very pleasant.

David Peters and Cadwaladr Owens and family are fit and successful. We set back home on the 28th and stayed at Ogden, with my old Master. They had been ...?? The reason why I left was that they were worried that they did not have much wheat. We arrived home on the 1st of March (a Sunday) {This, together with mention of his father being alive, confirms that this letter was written in 1857} and found the family comfortable and well. The weather is fine these days and the people are starting on their chores. There are prospects of plenty of work and a good wage. There is a need for 300 stone cutters to work on the Temple. The wage will be from \$3 to \$3-50 a day. Nothing much(?) is to be had here for free.

I believe that America from the Atlantic to the Pacific is a much better place in which to live. I think that you will have seen the letters that my father sent. A farm worker earns about \$2-50 a month plus his food.

Now I need to draw this letter to a close. {He puts it nicely "I want to put a tail on this letter"}

Remember me and all of us here to your family and my grandfather, the Gelli family, the Creuau family and Carregalltraeth and all our old neighbours in Llanfrothen. Give our best regards to the Cae'r Llwynog family and my father and mother send their best regards to Williams Davies of Cae Glas (your uncle) and John Edmunds and the Park family. Tell everybody that asks about us that we are all well and really like the country. This is an exceptionally healthy country, there is little talk of any death or illness. Remember us very kindly to our old acquaintances in Ffestiniog. My father sends his regards to Gwilym Ystradau and Ellis Wyn o Wyrfa. Aunt Mary and children are here with us. They are well. Elizabeth is still in the same(?) place. Neither she nor ourselves had as much?? bread.... as before(?).

Robert D. Roberts

Elder John Roberts Dear Brother

I hope that Brother David Roberts has received the letter that I sent him or at least that he has received it well before you get this letter. I hope that you are all well {unclear}....

No doubt, you had terrible difficulties to overcome on your journey - as one would expect, because it is not a small matter to travel seven or eight thousand miles through such places.

I read in The Star and the Udgorn that you were put to quite a testing time and the fire that occurred {unclear}.... had to turn back as their constitution {unclear} could not suffer such heat.

I have often thought that the migrating Saints are much like potatoes, carried in a truck which has holes in its bottom! With every yard forward, some of the potatoes fall out, and if the ground is rocky, even more will be lost. It is quite similar with the emigrating Saints; say seven or eight hundred start off together from Liverpool, perhaps only four or five hundred will reach journey's end. Because of this we should pray that some of the potatoes are large (Chr....{unclear}.... Sectarian) so that they will not fall through the holes.

I was pleased to read in Br. David Grant's account that you had a successful journey at least up to Fort Laramie and he was hopeful that you would complete the rest of your journey even more successfully. I read all your names in Br. Grant's letter and it brought me great joy to read that you were still alive and had travelled so well. I was especially glad that you had beaten the "wagon people" and all the Saints in Wales were glad to hear that. To be honest, we did not wish those who travelled by wagon to succeed (as Brigham had said that it would be better for them to travel using handcarts) with exceptions of course for those unable to do so.

I saw a letter in The Star about a fortnight ago from Br. Thomas Bullock stating that he had come across a large "Welsh Camp" about three days out of the Valley and that is the last report that I have received about you. I trust that you have by now arrived there and are now settled and that you are all healthy and comfortable.

I am pleased to report that I am well and that my health is better than it has been in years. My friendship with "Mr. Cold Water" is such that I have my Honourable Friends Tea and Coffee and have thrown all of their relatives out of the house and locked the door behind them! If people made more business with Mr. Cold Water and less with those two Gentlemen Tea and Coffee then the doctors could hang up their harps as they wished {*Psalm 137*}, but mankind's taste for these is almost as if they had sworn allegiance to these habits.

I was in Ffestiniog last week, seeing Jason and family. They were well at the time but Jason had been in having a problem with his hand - which had turned black preventing him from working for about three weeks. Jason has a Level {*quarrying term*} in Hafodty, which he shares with another man. They have enough slate to work until August. They employ four workers and amongst them is Br. Treharne who has been working with them this past month as the Conference locally is in a poor state - but they are trying their best. After all, you took many of his group along with you last time, so there are not many members left now. They will keep Br. Treharne on all winter. He was well and in excellent spirits and wished to send you his best regards - every one of you. Jason also told me to send his best regards, especially to Br. David Roberts. Tell him and Sister Roberts that Old Phebe started shaking her head {in despair?} when I was there. So, you see that times were quite dark in the Ffestiniog district when I was there.

There has been a lot of building from Rhiw to Tanygrisiau and they are building a new road from Blaenau to Llan. It starts from the old road by the house at the top of the hill above Cae'r Blaidd mill, keeping further east than the old road and coming out on the crossroad beyond Blaen Ddôl.

Tell Br. D. Roberts, that I visited David and Martha Williams and that they sent you, him and all of his family their best regards. Martha misses Pierce greatly and she gave me one of his books to remember him by.

Recently, many children have died in Ffestiniog recently as a result of Scarlet Fever - three from a single house (you would not know them as they are new to the district).

I have called on your debtors four times but to no avail, so I have now given up as I don't think that you will get a single penny from them. As South Walians used to say "Even the Devil himself could not get it out of them!".

I went from Ffestiniog to Maentwrog to visit your mother-in-law and received a very warm welcome and was told to call again, whenever I was in the area. I was there on January 2nd. She too wished me to pass on her kindest regards to you and to Mary and the children. I was to tell you that she was making a very good living and was in good health.

From there, I went on to Margaret Jones' home in Carreg and she gave me the warmest welcome that she could. She knew that I had ??LOGELL?? {*a fund?*} and that a little money would be useful for that. To be honest, she has been very kind to me every time that I have visited, as was her mother before her. She too wished to be remembered to you and to Mary and the children and to Br. Roberts and his family. Margaret is still a Saint in principle but has not been baptised yet, but is thinking about having this done.

I went from Garreg to Gelli but there are fewer family members there now compared to my previous visit. Your father has passed away - he died about three months ago. I think that he died of a fever. He had only been ill about a fortnight and was still getting out of bed and visiting Edward's workshop occasionally even during that time. Edward said that the day before he died, he had told him that this would be the last time that he would come into the workshop - and that's how things turned out: he died the next day. Others have told me that Edward suffered terribly grief after him and this persisted for a long time afterwards. He was however quite well as was his wife, when I visited and I received a warm welcome.

I slept there overnight and had plenty to eat and a warm welcome - all free of charge. I have stayed there on previous occasions and they have never accepted a penny from me, they just say that they are glad to see me and they made that very clear by their actions. I always judge things according to this saying "Faith without action is dead" {*Judge them by their actions not their words?*}. They were both quite well but Edward had been having trouble with his eyes and had not been able to work for about five weeks, but when I was there, he was better and had been able to resume work. They sent you their kindest regards.

From there I went on to Creuau, where I of course, had to drop in and have something to eat. Margaret (Catherine's sister) gave me a sandwich to put in my carpet bag. She too sends her regards - especially to her sister Catherine. They have a new maid there.

There have been quite a few deaths in the locality, since you left - Daniel Lloyd (Tremadog) who died before your letter reached his hand. Others have set off on their journey to the Land of Spirits - amongst those who have set off on the 'Long Trail' is old Judge Lloyd and old William Williams (Rhyd). I wonder when they will return?

Cadwaladr Owen (Dolwyddelan) and old John Williams (Llecheiddior) and John Williams (Drenwydd) had gone away to some far country looking for work I suppose, that is why people usually go there.

I went from Llanfrothen to Caernarfon and there, I visited the home of Sister Lloyd. Who was there but old Robin Ddu Eryri {a poet - his bardic name}. He was lodging there for two weeks. Before that, his work was going from fair to fair, visiting the inns and reciting "Adam's Will" {*long poem*}. He is currently translating "Chambers' People's Education".

The last volume is now in the press and there are two or three volumes already in print, printed by Hugh Humphries (Caernarfon).

Fair play to him, Robin did not say a word against the Saints although he has left the Church. He recalled that when he was in an inn in Bethesda once, somebody asked him about the Saints. Parry said that the Saints were the best people that he had ever met. "Aren't they doing bad things over there in the Valley?" asked one. "How do you know this?" responded Parry, "It is in all the newspapers" he said. "Do you believe everything that you see in the newspapers?" asked Parry. "Yes" he replied. "Well" said Parry, "three months back, I read in a newspaper that Robin Ddu had got drunk, had to sleep out in a ditch and consequently had died. Did I believe that! Another time, I read that Robin Ddu had married a woman, even giving her name. I did not believe that either, although it appeared in print." The questioner suddenly became quiet.

Robyn wished to be remembered to you and to Jeremy, Phillips and Davies (the printers) and to Richard Morris and to Pastor John Parry and all his friends. He said that he would be baptised as soon as Pastor John Jones came by. I asked if he would like to send you a few englyn {poems} to the Valley as I would be writing shortly. He immediately composed these five poems for you. {*Here is a very poor attempt at translation!*}

Healthy under Zion's sky
You are, my dear friends
Me, I'm here making a living,
Far across the sea

Jeremy, is still fit and Philips
making a good living
And merry Morris happy
Accomplishing all that he can

Great it is to talk
Once more with Captain Jones daily
And an honour it is for the Saint
Once more to receive praise

Despite foreign difficulties
And a ship in difficulties
The dear Saints after waiting
Praise God in the Temple

Robin Ddu o Eryri

Well done Robin! It is a pity that he does not make better use of his talent.

There has not been much baptising in Merionethshire Conference recently. But one person was baptised in Machynlleth recently. I hear that the Saints there are doing well. Hugh Edward (Machynlleth) is still doing good work.

In my recent letter, I said that David Davies had got married and that he had at last got somebody who would enable him to better himself - if the so-and-so wanted to do so; but no good will come of it if he does not follow good advice.

When in Ffestiniog, I heard that James Anwyl was now home.

It is unlikely that anyone from Merionethshire will emigrate this time unless David Roberts (Dinas Mawddwy) decides to go to the States. It is unlikely that many from Wales even will emigrate this time - probably not more than 150. The following Presidents have been selected-

<i>President</i>	<i>Successor</i>
Israel Evans	Mither
Benjamin Ashby	Taylor
Thomas Harris	John Davies (Merionethshire)
Griffith Roberts (Denbigh)	Hugh Evans (Newmarket)
Thomas Jones (Aberystwyth)	Joseph Griffiths
William Jones (Carmarthen)	Thomas Rees, who had been a Leader at the Flint Conference the previous year and David John (Formerly of Haverfordwest) is to succeed him in that Conference.

The following are set to emigrate from this Conference. Hugh Davies (Bron yr Haul, Eglwysbach), David Davies (son of David & Sarah Davies from the same place) and Grace Jones (Bryn Dedwydd, near Conwy).

I give the names of these people so that their relatives know that they are on their way to join them. I do this because letters so often get lost in the post. If you happen to see the son-in-law and daughter of the said Grace Jones, tell them that she has sent them several letters and that her husband died some five months ago. She is quite well and has sold all her furniture and is now ready to emigrate - as soon as the call comes.

This year, Br. Pratt wants the emigrants to reach the Valley by around the start of autumn. To facilitate this, and ensure that it happens smoothly, everyone must send £3 (apart from the £1 deposit) to the Office so that it can immediately be sent to the States to get the things needed for the journey across the Plains - rather than having long delays in the States whilst the necessary provisions for the journey are bought. Nobody is allowed to emigrate from the British Isles using the Perpetual Fund - not even the ones that put £5 into it last year.

There have not been many baptisms in the North since I posted my last letter but I don't know how it is in other places. I have not heard of any particular revival anywhere, although baptisms are taking place regularly. We are not giving up and there again signs of more baptisms in some areas.

Br. Pratt is busy writing a book. He wrote four essays recently under the headings "True Faith", "True Repentance", "Baptism by water" and "Holy Spirit". These are currently being translated into Welsh by Dewi Elfed. Two have already been published. Every essay has 28 pages of the same size as the Udgorn and the series has been published in bound form, with all essays containing listing the names and prices of all the works published by the Saints in Europe. There is a cover for the essays, similar to that on "The New Old Religion" and the back cover lists all the places in Wales where the Saints meet, and lists the times of their meetings. These cost two pennies.

Saints borrow these publications every week and take them to show their neighbours. They take "The Real Truth" to a house this week, then the next week, they take it back, and leave "True Repentance" in its place, and they take "Real Truth" to another home. This continues until everyone has had the opportunity to see the principles so that they have no excuse for their disobedience.

Well, the Crimean War has come to a close since you left but Cadwaladr Llwyd was not killed yet as his aunt wished. He is currently at home, released from the army - not because of injury but because they could do nothing with him because of his 'inborn perfection'. {???

There have been quite a few losses at sea recently - or just last week, I should say. Four vessels were lost last Sunday between Llandudno and Mostyn. As a ship was being rattled by the storm near Prestatyn, a warning was sent for a lifeboat. They quickly set off lest another lifeboat got there ahead of them. They put up sails, but because the wind was so strong, the lifeboat overturned and their mast got stuck in the sand with the result was that all hands drowned - 13 in number.

Floods and strong winds have troubled these regions recently. There has not been such a flood in the Conwy river in living memory so they say. The lower part of Llanrwst was inundated with floodwater - it was a yard deep in Plas Helyg Street and the whole valley was under water. It looked as if a new sea inlet had been created rather than a track to bring the railway there from Llandudno. Talking about railroad, they say that somebody has agreed to dig large tunnel at Rhosydd {*actually, the Crimea Pass tunnel*}. £2,800 has to be raised and they will have to work the tunnel from several places. They will have to dig a vertical shaft down from the centre and then have two gangs working from there and one from either end.

{*letter ends*}

Dear Brother Roberts

I start this, my second letter to you. I have also written to Br. John Roberts but I don't know if either letter was received. I understand that it is difficult for letters from this country to reach the Saints once they have set off.

I am glad to report that I am fairly well and comfortable and I hope that you and all your family and all the brothers and sisters who accompanied, you are blessed when this letter reaches you. I am sure that you will have been tested along the way and suffered many difficulties as you went to the Kingdom of God.

We were glad to hear that you had arrived without having suffered half as much as the company that followed you did. The newspapers reported that the "Mormons" starved in their hundreds, but we did not believe this at all, although we were sure that there would have been testing times for you. But as the old saying goes "Empty vessels make the most noise" - the newspapers always make terrible sounds – like ghosts haunting a house. After hearing the noise, one goes to look to see what has happened and one always finds nothing amiss.

I have really looked forward to receiving a letter from you, but in vain (unless a letter has arrived in Llanfrothen). I have not received a letter from anyone from north Wales except one from somebody called John Parry, from Newmarket.

I am rather worried (although I do not believe this yet) that you intend to make yourself famous by learning the "Art of Silence" by not writing letters to us, but I think that you will be too set in your ways to learn this new 'art form' and will want to let me know that you are still alive.

I have not heard anything from Llanfrothen recently but I intend to visit in the near future – perhaps before I post this letter.

It is an important time for me in the British Isles at the moment as a Religious Revival is beginning. It started a month or two back and I can assure you that the Church in Wales or in England has never seen anything like it. There will be a proper pruning of the Orchard - and the trees within the Orchard really needed this done. The Orchard had become full of weeds and it was impossible for the trees to bear fruit whilst there was so much dead-wood on the trees. It will now be a time of much-needed pruning. Axes are aimed at the the boughs of every tree and ones that bear no fruit are to be cut down.

The CYNHYDDAROTS (??rules??) that who were once respected by some are once again being practised more than ever and there is talk about those who had upheld such things (when they were here) with respect for their efforts in upholding "God's Words" whilst being ignored for that (alas) by many of Israel's Elders. But things have changed since then and a Revival has made this the 'Major Subject of the Day' amongst the Saints in these countries now after receiving President Brigham Young's letter calling on all the Saints on these islands to change/revise.

A meeting was held in Liverpool for that purpose and also Apostle Ezra Benson recently visited Swansea. He was starting a new Revival in Wales and re-baptising everyone who wishes to be a Saint. From now, on everybody who has not been re-baptised will not be considered as being in the Church, and everybody who has been re-baptised will have their names recorded in a new place in the books. We will not see the Church start anew unless this happens. Also, the only ones to be re-baptised are those who pledge to pay the Tithe and to follow the Word of Truth - young and old must pledge, if they are to remain within the Church. You can argue that some will think this harsh, and already some complain that it is a Hard Master that we follow. Indeed, there is reason to think that this will cause many to turn to become followers of Demas. "Let them do so!" say I, for we need Doors to work in a way that people can enter to participate in the feast rather than their being like "...." {unclear} scaring away everybody who comes looking for somewhere to eat.

But all these rules will do is uphold True Mormonism; this has affected some more than anything that they learnt before, because some have decided to obey the Word of Truth more than they had ever done. I am glad to say that I have been keeping to this for more than a year and I was re-baptised last week, and I am now doing my utmost to re-baptise all of those who pledge to keep to the rules.

14th April

After writing the above, I came to Ffestiniog, a bit sooner than I was expecting when I started writing this letter. I had expected to receive a letter from you by now, but that was not to be. I was in Llanfrothen yesterday and met your brother Edward and his wife and they were both well. This time, I spent the night with them once again as I have done on numerous occasions and he and his wife were very kind to me. He too was really looking forward to receiving a letter from you. He and his wife send you their best regards. John Llwyd of Garth Llwynog and his wife are healthy and send you their regards. I also called at Garreg and saw Margaret Jones and she and her mother were both healthy and send you their regards. They are always kind towards me.

I also heard that the Creuau family were well but I didn't see any of them this time. The man at Parc had recently been buried when I visited. Owen Jones (Ty'n Ddôl) and the man from Morfa Du have also left for The Land of the Spirits a while back.

I will tell you about Ffestiniog now. Br. Jason Thomas and family are well and he is working in a level in Hafodty and it is turning out to be a very good site. Br Trehearne is working with him since the start of winter but will be stopping in about a month's time in order to go preaching.

Several have been involved in bad accidents in the quarries recently as a result of blast holes blowing back on them {*this happened to 'blind' John Roberts, DRR's brother*} Owen Cadwaladr (Jason's co-worker) was killed about a week ago and David Jones (Tanygrisiau or "Big" David Jones) and Sion the servant were lost due to the same horror. Evan Williams (Emah Williams – Dolgarregddu's husband) almost lost his eye, when a blast hole blew back on him before Christmas. He has not worked since. He is currently emigrating to Utica in the USA.

Everything is going on much the same over here - everything is quite expensive. Butter is one shilling and fourpence a pound here but 2d more expensive in the Bethesda area. Other things are pretty similar.

William Roberts the shoe-maker and his family are well and send their regards. He is currently moving to Congl-y-Wal.

There isn't much more success in making Mormons of Ffestiniog residents than there was when you were here, but we are not giving up, because some of our seeds may have hidden away in unexpected places. A fair wind may cause these to grow and become an adornment for some corner of the Orchard once again.

I heard that the Saints at Harlech were well when last seen by Br. Trehearne about a month back, and the Cricieth Saints the same as are all the Saints of this Conference.

I received a letter from Br. Edward Roberts (Dinas Mawddwy) about a week ago informing me that he had received a letter from his siter Susannah informing him of the death of Owen Jones (Tywyn). This reminded me of the spirit that he received in the Cymanfa in Towyn, Merionethshire when you were there. It was said at the time that there were some present that would not see one another after that, but would see one another in the Land of the Spirits.

Br. Roberts said that they were all well there and that they intended to write directly to Susannah. David, his brother has emigrated to the States.

I was in Liverpool a while back, delivering other migrants. They were setting off on March 27th on board the excellent ship George Washington (1649 tons). On board were 817 Saints, mostly going to The Valley . There were about 60 from Wales, 48 Swiss, about 20 from the Isle of Man, some Scots and the rest were English. I cannot list all of those from Wales, but these are the few that I did know.

<i>Name</i>	<i>Home address</i>	<i>County</i>	<i>Aiming for</i>
Griffith Robert & wife	Abergele	Denbigh	The Valley
Anne E Roberts	Abergele	Flint	The Valley
Elizabeth Jones	Rhuddlan	Flint	The Valley
Owen Williams, & wife & 2 children	Abergele	Flint	States
Evan Read & family	Nant-y-Glo	Glamorgan?	Not known
John Lewis & family	Penycae	Flint	Not known
Evan S Morgans	Pontardawe	Glamorgan	States
David Roberts	Dinas Mawddwy	Merionethshire	States

{end of letter}

To the Elder D.R. Roberts

Dear Brother

Today is probably the designated day for me to reply to your letter, which I received about eleven weeks ago.

It is not a lack of affection towards you, or a lack of time that caused this long delay; I thought that it would be futile to send a letter whilst there were still hostilities between the States and Utah. We heard three weeks ago that this difficulty had been settled, but it was not possible for me to write until now.

I am sure that Br. John E. Jones will have told you all the news about the North, from the time that you left up until the time that he himself left. I have not had much contact with Merionethshire recently. I got a letter from Br. Treharne about six weeks ago reporting that he was well as were Jason and family (as Br. Treharne has been working with them for about a year). I don't know how things are with Jason but I think that things are not going too well in the Church as I heard. Br. J.R. Jones that things were 'as dry as a bone'.

Phebe has been suffering from dropsy in her limbs once again. David was buried about a year or more ago.

Griffith (Harlech) is as thirsty as a bone and I don't really know if he remains in the Church or not. I heard that James Anwyl pays his Tithe and Br. Edward Roberts (Dinas Mawddwy) is still the same – trying his best, and he is certainly a good man.

There is nobody of any substance in Machynlleth, apart from Sister Griffiths and her parents, because only elderly people live there now. The Ellis Sisters are surely ...?... them and Sister Davies (Towyn) is working hard, all on her own, there.

I think that David Vaughan and his wife are out of the Church, but I am not certain about this. I have not heard anything about David Davies (Machynlleth) for about a year. He is still out of the Church and no good has come of him since he left Ffestiniog. It is a shame that a young man, in the prime of life, wastes his time at such an important time!!!

Br. Meredith (Llanidloes) remains a good man and pays his Tithe. Isaac Jones (formerly of Machynlleth) now resides about two miles away from me, in a place called Nant-y-Glo along with his family. I have visited him several times but he is too conceited/selfish to allow anybody to help him, and to be honest, I did not even try! I went to see him because he was family and because of old friendship. He is full of feelings of withdrawal so what I did with him was not to talk about Church principles, just let everything pass, as we do with other secular people.

I would like to give you news about your relatives but I am afraid that I can't at the moment.

Saints are few and far apart in the North at the moment - just a handful remain. Br. John Daniels (Bethesda) is working here at the moment. He was in hospital for nine months and there are only three months since he was released. His wife was like the devil to him, but he is now out of her grasps at last. He wishes to be remembered fondly to you.

Well, Br. Roberts, almost three years have passed since we parted on the river in Liverpool. If anyone had told me at the time that three years would have passed before I saw you again, I would have felt really feel sad, but the time has flown; the likelihood of this happening now is not much better than it was then. It is good that our future is hidden from us because faith and hope reign and we have can have some enjoyment.

I understand that you formed an excellent procession when setting off for the South. If only I was there with you! But perhaps there was some bitterness about this, yet again I think that every one of the Faith has some means/medicine in their possession, which will turn the bitter into sweet and turn everything to the service of those that believe in the Lord. People here wished to have the honour of experiencing the bitterness and sweetness that you experienced.

It is true that some became followers of Demas but they were of no value and we are better off without them.

In the South, everything is going well at the moment. The Saints are working particularly hard and a big effort is being made to repay the Debts Book. As proof of this, the Millennial Star received £566 this week. Truly, the Saints are making a very special effort. The people of this Conference are as good as any that have come down from Heaven. It is

a pleasure to be working with them. I am delighted to be with them. All of the officials and many of the sisters keep to the Word of Wisdom. Through this, I can say that I too have kept to this for two years now, and am determined to continue doing so.

I cannot yet say who will be emigrating next spring - this secret has not yet been disclosed to me.

The "Udgorn" is now published weekly and costs a penny ha'penny. Wales currently has many newspapers – here are their names: Y Cymro, Yr Herald Gymraeg, Baner Cymru, Yr Arweinydd, Y Gwladgarwr, Udgorn y Bobl, Yr Amserau, Y Gwron Cymreig, Y Gweithiwr, Seren Cymru and Punch Cymraeg. This last one is published in Holyhead and is in the same format as the English Punch. All the above are weekly publications apart from Gwron Cymreig and Punch, which are bi-weekly.

A large regional eisteddfod is to be held on 21-4th of this month in Llangollen, with prizes totalling £500. I am afraid that I don't know the subject of the competitions - I am sure that you would like to know what they are.

Employment is going well here but wages are not good, however food is more affordable – I think that ...?... is the most expensive, butter is one shilling and three pence and cheese costs the same.

On the whole, we had a very dry summer and we had good harvests – better than ever I believe. Crops of grass and wheat, apples and all sorts of fruit were plentiful. This reminds me of what you said in your letters about the prophecies of Br. Brigham about Three Years of Plenitude.

General news is in rather short supply for me at the moment so you will have to wait to hear very much, but I am sure that you get a lot of news in your newspapers and so there is no point in my repeating these.

Oh! I forgot to tell you about Br. John Davies (formerly of Merionethshire). He is now in Merthyr. I heard from him last week and both he and Sister Davies were well.

I would like to hear from you as soon as you possibly can. I will reply sooner next time than I did this time (as I have noted earlier).

I would like to know how Thomas, Robert, Daniel, Anne, Elizabeth and Jane are getting on.

Please address your letter to: William Ajax, 100 Newtown, Ebbw Vale, Newport, Monmouthshire.

Please show this letter to Br. J.E. Jones and anyone else that I know and remember me to Br. Jones and all my acquaintances. Remember me to Sister Roberts and all the children and to Mary the widow of Br. Roberts and to Elizabeth, her daughter.

If you see Br. Daniels remember me to him and to Br. William Lewis (previously from Caernarfon) and to John Lewis (Llanrwst). If you see anybody from Ben-y-Cae or Victoria tell them that everyone here is well. Remember me to Br. James Taylor and Michael Vaughan (Lehi City) and tell them that they will soon get a letter.

I am currently well and comfortable and well. Please be so kind as to write as soon as possible.

With best regards to you and all faithful Saints.

Your brother in the Gospel

William Ajax

Our dearest sister

A long time has passed since we have seen one another - or even received a word from you. But two letters have reached this area - one from Mary Roberts, addressed to Edward Roberts at Gelli and another, from Gwen and her family to John Lloyd of Garth Llwynog. Through these two letters, we have gleaned a little of your story. The few facts that we gathered have had quite an effect upon us. Firstly, our minds are a bit more at ease because we now know something of your circumstances – something about which we had absolutely no knowledge. But there is a second way in which it has affected us and caused great sorrow in our minds; we understand that your husband David Roberts has passed away, leaving you and the children in a strange and distant land.

As you can imagine, since hearing this we have only had a few moments of peace when we don't dwell on thinking about your circumstances. How are you getting on now? We are really surprised that you have not written before now. We implore you to send us details of your circumstances. How is it for you these days?

We gathered from the letters that David Roberts had been ill and that you, as a family, had also suffered from this illness, but the letter sent to Garth Llwynog {*John Lloyd*} said that you had made a good recovery. This change to your circumstances has been a real cause of worry to us. How on earth will you and the children be able to get the essentials needed to sustain you?

We understand that you now have got two cows and a few smaller cattle, also a yoke and oxen and also wagon – at least when David was alive, but by now quite naturally, we are sure that things will have become tighter because of your new circumstances.

We do not think that employment opportunities for yourself and the children are as good over there as they are here. If you were in Ffestiniog, the boys would have a choice of good jobs, and they would make good money and thus be able to help you. And it's also certain that there is no social assistance over there to help widows and poor orphans as there is over here.

If these few lines actually reach you, we really wish that you would send us an acknowledgement that you have received it and also give us details about your situation. Tell us about the children - where are they now? Are they still at home with you or have they gone their own way and left home?

Also, I want to know how you and the children feel about staying over there or do you want to return home? If you want to return home, then it is up to you. We want a definite answer to this question.

Gwen's husband wrote in his letter about the Market over there. Apparently, wheat prices are high at the moment - I hope that you get some benefit from this and that you are able to keep some for your own use.

We really want to know if the soldiers are still there. Is everything quiet and peaceful between you and the United States?

You probably want to know a bit about our situation just as we want to know about yours. I, your brother Richard, generally enjoy good health and I send you and every one of the children my very best regards.

Your sister Jane is fairly well, but suffers badly from pain in her leg – it is not much better than when you last saw her. At times, waves of cramp go through her whole body and these cause her great pain. But Jane sends her best regards to her dearest sister, in true friendship, and also to the children one and all.

Morris Isaac is fit and well and sends his best regards to you and the children. Your Aunt Catherine gets up every day but is bent over with pain, she too sends you her best regards. Edward Roberts and Ellen are both well. Robert Roberts of Erw Fawr is also well as are his family.

Economically, things over here are generally quite good at the moment; animal prices are good, there is plenty of work and food prices are low. A 240lb sack of seed varies between £1-14-0 and £1-3-0 (from best to worst). Ordinary butter costs 1/6 and cheese, 4½ d. There is a plenitude of potatoes this year - to be honest, we have more than enough. A sack of oats is £1-4-0.

With this I bring things to a close in the hope that you will do me the favour of sending me a reply.

Yours
R. Thomas and Jane Thomas

Post Script:

I, your brother Richard, have decided and made my mind up that I want to help you and the children to return home – that is of course, if you are thinking about returning home and if you are willing to accept my help.

I want you to write to me, telling me exactly how I can send you something that will be of assistance. What I mean is that you should make an audit of what money you have to set off on your journey, and then I will send assistance to meet your needs.

But, perhaps you can make up a better plan. I await your reply.

Your brother
Richard Thomas

Creuau,
July 1st, 1859

My Dearest Sister,

I am delighted to send you acknowledgement of receiving your letter dated May 2nd, 1859. It was a huge relief for myself and your sister Jane (as much relief as one could get from reading lines in black and white), but despite that, we remain very concerned about you and the children- over there, in a strange land, lest unpleasant things affect you with us being so far away and unable to help. We try to calm ourselves by remembering that you say in your letter that neither you nor the children have gone hungry since you arrived. Despite that, circumstances can change so quickly between nations causing all sorts of bad things to happen in a short time.

In our old Welsh homeland there is almost no conflict or major change except that food prices go up and down – for man and beast. Circumstances have been good here for a long time now. We get good money for our animals and our food prices are low, despite there being some increases a short time ago – that coming about as a result of war between, Austria, France and Sardinia.

As regards ourselves and this community, things are as follows: I and your brother (R. Thomas) are fairly well, despite being rather ill in the spring with some sort of pox affecting my skin, but I have got over it quite well by now. I cannot say the same about your sister Jane though, the wound on her leg remains sore and painful and some muscle swelling also gives her a lot of pain. Your Aunt Catherine is also fairly well but her life is coming to a close {put poetically in Welsh "bending like a sickle towards the grave"}. Morris Isaac is also fairly well. Edward and Ellin Roberts (Gelli) and family are well. Robert Roberts (Erw) and family are well but Rees is now a widower some months since. Peter is alive and sometimes comes to visit us at Creuau. The girls are fine. Not much has changed for our neighbours. John Lloyd and Catherine (Garth Llwynog) are well and receive the occasional letter from Gwen.

It was a very wet winter but recently it has been dry and a drought is causing a problem with a lack of water for the animals, but we still have healthy crops of wheat, barley and oats, but the potatoes are not looking too good. There is not much grass for the animals to graze.

The news that most people are talking about these days is the war between France and Austria.

By now, I think that I have given you all the information that you asked for - if you want to know about anything else, ask in your next letter. I am replying quickly in order to give you time to reply. We hope that you will give us a more detailed letter the next time. We are pleased that you have two cows – but do you have rent and taxes to pay for your home and land and also expenses towards feeding yourselves and your cattle? I hope that Robert's new adventure works out and that he will have good health so that he can return with his ox and wagon.

I am including all of those friends whom you mentioned together with myself, your sister, Morris Isaac and your Aunt Catherine as I pass on our best wishes and deepest love towards you and the children. We wish you the season's blessings and also spiritual blessings. I hope that this letter you will make you think of the Old Country and that those memories will cause you to start a new adventure that will see you set off on a path that will bring you back, so that we can see one another's faces once more, before we all go the way of all worldly beings. These are your brother and sister's true wishes. Amen.

You said in your last letter that you could not give a definite answer to my question about how I could help you and the children to return home. We expect that in your next letter you will be able to give us a definite answer. I remain committed to wanting to be of assistance.

Your dearest brother
Richard Thomas

From contents, date is likely to be Easter 1859

<i>Name</i>	<i>Address</i>	<i>County</i>	<i>Going to</i>
Hugh Davies	Eglwysbach	Denbigh	The Valley
Grace Jones	Bryndedwydd nr. Conwy		The Valley
**Anne C Roberts	Mochdre	Denbigh	The Valley
Thomas Stevens	Merthyr	Glamorgan	Not known
Israel Evans + Benjamin Ashby			The Valley

There were a few others going from Wales but I did not know them.

** This Anne Roberts was baptised in Liverpool a day or two before leaving. She is a niece of the above Grace Jones and she (Grace Jones) has a daughter living in Wilson Creek, Weber County. If at all possible, can you inform her daughter that her mother, niece and brother-in-law, are on their way. (The address is: Mr William Davies Mason, Willow Creek, Weber County). I am sure that she will be very appreciative. These Saints were very kind to me so I would be very glad if you could do this favour for them.

It was not possible for anybody to be more faithful than these Saints were. All the Saints from the North promised to keep the Word of Truth onboard the ship. They had been re-baptised a few days before leaving and had committed to the Tithe and to keeping the Word of Truth (but they all did Tithe even before this).

There has not been a lot of baptising in Wales recently but there has been quite a lot in various parts of England. About 200 were baptised in Scandinavia in about four months. It is quite likely that the sound of scythes will be heard drowning all other sounds in Wales and England for quite some time, because undoubtedly, many are keener to feed their greed rather than to leave their worldly pleasures behind - despite knowing that they will be thrown out of God's Kingdom.

It is quite a difficult time at the present; it is more difficult to stand up for the Church than it has ever been because of the slippery pavement of the Word of Truth and the Tithe. We have to have members who are flexible - but many have been busy anointing their joints so that they can run on our behalf, and they thank God that they have such embrocation to help them so that they do not have to walk the same path as other people - and in consequence, end up in the same mire as the others. "All strength to the Mormons!"

Despite having to cut out perhaps half of the Church members in Wales, that will clear the way for good men to come in – ones that will help a hand to push the wheel forward rather than to be, as many are, putting in every effort to stop the wheel going forward.

A series of Essays has been written recently by Apostle Orson Pratt and four of these have been published in Welsh, having been translated by Dewi Elfed. Four more are soon to follow – making a total of eight. Every one costs two pence and there are covers to fit over them – similar to the covers for "Old New Religion". On the back covers, there is a list of all places that Saints worship and times of worship. The essays are:

1. True Faith
2. True Repentance
3. Baptism by Water
4. The Holy Spirit
5. Spiritual Talents
6. The need for miracles
7. General recantation in the 17th century
8. The kingdom of the Latter Days

There is no need for me to say that these are good essays - you know the author.

Currently peace reigns between the countries of Europe and the war between Persia and England has come to an end. But there persists some quarrel between Britain and China. This is what "Herald Gymraeg" says about these
 "Here is a letter from Hong Kong, 15th February.

Ten thousand homes have been destroyed in Canton. The British persisted firing on the city and 1,000 Chinese junks attacked the British. The Chinese were overcome."

The same paper has the following to say about Utah

"It is said that the situation of the Mormons in Utah is pitiful. It is thought that Brigham Young will be made to resign and another chosen to replace him. The American government has had to send a regiment of soldiers to the place in order to preserve life and property."

Isn't it amazing how easily the Devil can persuade his friends to believe his lies?

There will be a General Election in this country shortly.

We had a very wet winter here this year – much more so than any that we have had in years. There was not much frost, but today, it is Easter Sunday and all the ground is covered with snow.

Well, it is time to bid you farewell.

Remember me kindly to John your brother, and to Mary and the children and to Margaret Jones. All her family are well and John, her brother, is working with Jason. I send my best regards to Parry (Newmarket), William Lewis (Anglesey) Susannah Roberts (Dinas) and of course, to you and Sister Roberts and to Robert, Thomas, Daniel, Anne, Elizabeth and Jane especially.

Remember to send letters as often as you can because I can assure you that they are welcomed with shouts of joy by all the Saints back here. Br. Thomas sends you all his fond regards and Sister Thomas and Br. Treharne.

Hurry up to send a reply and address it thus: William Ajax, c/o Mr Edward Parry, Tanygraig, Llandudno.

Your humble
Friend in Truth
William Ajax

To Mrs. Catherine Roberts Salt Lake
My Dearest Sister

After quite a wait, I am finally writing to confirm that I received your letter dated November 17th, 1859 on (or close to) the 25th of January – so it must have taken close to ten weeks to complete its journey.

We were overjoyed to hear that you are all well and comfortable and that the children have been able to settle into good worldly employment.

In my opinion, you made a gamble in your big adventure considering that you had made quite a good home and had ownership of the property. But, of course, you know best what to do.

I was very pleased to hear that Robert had returned successfully from his adventures. I hope that he will again be successful in his second adventure to your new settlement.

I gather from your behaviour that you don't really want to return to the Old Country.

I will now go on to say something about ourselves - Ellen and myself. We are quite well and we live in the same place, in Gelli. What concerns us, and everyone that keeps animals, especially in these winter months, is the shortage of hay. It's almost impossible to buy any. They say that it is about 8/- a hundredweight.

We would have written to you earlier but Jason had promised to come down from Ffestiniog with some news about your old friends in Ffestiniog but he never turned up.

One or two interesting things have happened to people whom you used to know. Pierce Owen (Tyn-y-Cefn) was killed in the mine, after being hit in the eye. Tom Evans (Ceunant) died in Rhosydd barracks after being unable to get home. I don't know much about anything of note that has happened in Ffestiniog recently.

Now on to news about our neighbours here and in this neighbourhood; again, there is not much to note (Peter Roberts is still living) and nobody that you would know has got married, apart from Margaret from the Smithy who has married her cousin Robert Griffith. The family at Erw Fawr are all well, without much change to their family.

John Lloyd (Garth Llwynog) is grateful for the tit-bit of information about his daughter, Gwen, which he gathered from your letter and he is really hoping that he gets a letter from her. He asks you let Gwen know that he and her mother are fairly well and in a better place materially. As regards her sister Mary, please pass on our regards to her and her husband and children. Her mother, Mary Owen, is pretty poorly suffering from breast cancer.

As you did not say anything about spiritual matters in your letter, I wonder if your religious fervour has cooled? That certainly is not how things are over here - all the denominations are experiencing Religious Revivals. In Llanfrothen these days there are only about a couple of dozen people that are not regular churchgoers.

So as I come to an end, I hope that these few words actually reach your hand, over there in the new land. We dearly wish to hear from you again in your new place. We wish you every success this season.

I gather that the death of my brother, David, has affected you greatly just as it has affected us.

Be Great
Edward Roberts

About the people at Creuau, your sister, Jane Thomas, is quite poorly these last few weeks. Something like palsy has affected her. In Creuau, they are awaiting a letter from
..... fairly fit but Jane is lonely and send you best regards, in the expectation of hearing word back from you.

E.R.

My Dear Nephew

I have your letter here in my hand and I was very pleased to receive it - although there was nothing special in it, but it at least gave me the assurance that you were, at that time at least, alive and well - however you may be by now.

I understand that the farm did not produce much for you last year. You were under quite a disadvantage, having only recently arrived there, it was difficult to improve the land - hopefully, you will be able to do better this year, now that things have settled.

I am sure that you are feeling a great loss after the death of your father - but there is nothing that can be done except try to make the best of your situation, and you, as children, should look after one another, and especially look after your mother.

It is quite difficult for me to know what to say as regards your well-being. Over here, businesses are flourishing with a shortage of workers so that wages are high. Nobody in Ffestiniog recalls having to advertise in the newspaper for workers before. Unless something major happens, many new workers will need to be found to satisfy industry's needs.

Now is the time for you to weigh up the advantages and disadvantages of the two countries and make up your own mind as to where it would be best for you to make your living.

We have plenty of food here and it is not too expensive – a sack of 240 or 280lb of seed is about £2-7-0 to £2-15-0, butter was quite stable in price this last winter and costs about 1/4 a pound, but it has recently started to fall in price. A sack of Tremadog oats costs £1-12-0 to £1-14-0. As regards cheese and various meats they are as follows - a live pig makes about 4d a pound or, having been killed, from 5½d to 8 ½d a pound and all other meats are similar in price. Potatoes are scarce as many crops failed this last season. I have talked here about prices that the farmer receives, but shop prices are also quite stable. If you were in Ffestiniog, you could easily make £1-0-0 to £1-10-0 a week. This should give you enough to make up your mind as to where is the best place for you to live - Ffestiniog or Salt Lake.

As regards religion, I can tell you that for certain, since God is omni-present, there is no place better than any other in which to worship Him. The only difference is that in some countries, the government oppresses people's freedom to worship as they please. But you know about England's religious freedom.

I will now go on to address other matters, your family and relatives. Your Uncle Robert and his family are fairly well, I will only say one thing about Rees as I understand that he is writing to you himself, he has stopped keeping house. Your cousin Mary, who used to live at Tŷ Newydd Cae Glas is now a widow with three children as her husband died suddenly at Rhosydd quarry and was unable to get home alive. I haven't got much to say about your Ffestiniog cousins.

I and your Aunt Ellin enjoy quite good health. We would dearly love to see any of you again if you decided to come over to the Old Country to visit.

You ask about finding somewhere for Robert Evans to preach, well, there is nowhere convenient, but we would be pleased to welcome him and be of assistance.

Please accept our dearest regards.

In the hope of hearing from you or better still, seeing you...

I remain your dear uncle
Edward E Roberts

Dear Friend

A long time has passed since I last wrote to you or heard from you. Good Friend, perhaps you think that we have forgotten all about you on this side of the world. Be that as it may, but it is certainly not the case. I have been thinking about writing to you for many months but something has always come in the way, anyway, now I am fulfilling my promise. I hope that you and the rest of the family are in good health.

Many things have happened since you left Ffestiniog – far too much to list but here are a few.

Margaret Roberts, wife of John Roberts (Y Mynydd – Dolgarregddu) along with William their son. Robert, son of John Jones (carpenter – Llwyn-y-Gell), Ricahrd Morris (Jr.) of Tŷ Crwn, Lewis Thomas (Maenofferen shop) along with many others. But I should also mention Thomas, son of Elen Thomas (Uncorn) who was killed in Rhiw Quarry.

Ffestiniog is growing yearly with huge growth in population. There are a lot more strangers here now than 'original' Ffestiniog people. Also, there are dozens if not hundreds of new houses that have been built in the last few years. I don't think that it is possible for you to imagine all the changes that have taken place here since you left. Many new quarries have been opened, with dozens of people working at Maenofferen (near the old Lord Quarry) and other new quarries here and there. Ffestiniog is more prosperous than ever.

I would be very pleased to hear that you are planning to visit the old hills of Ffestiniog so that you can chat with your old friends. I do hope that you can spend some time here in the future.,

I saw Robert your cousin last night (Friday August 13th) and he told me that, last Thursday, he'd received the letter that you sent him when he {???should that be *from* ???} was in America. From this, I learnt a lot about what has happened to you recently. I am glad that you are flourishing there and I hope that you are happy there as well - I am glad to hear that gold has been discovered there recently. More than anything, I hope that you will prosper there.

I understand that you have become a Real Saint - that came as quite a surprise to me! My belief though is that being a Methodist or a Church-goer or anything else will result in your being Saved – nor will moving to a new country bring you happiness/blessedness. Oh no! Being in Christ Jesus is the only to be Saved - whatever country you are in, whatever denomination you profess. I hope that you have reached the said Salvation by being a good Christian.

3240-3241

Dated: c.1862

Perhaps what you would like to hear next is some local news, although it is difficult to report all of the changes that have taken place here recently.

Regarding the quarries, nobody can recall it being as good as it is here at the moment. They cannot get anything like the amount of slate that there is a call for, despite working all sorts of rock; some rock being far too poor for anybody to even consider working a few years ago.

There is a lot of work going on in the old Lord Quarry and it looks better than ever. They discovered a new vein of slate which is 60 yards thick. There are dozens of men working there now. They built a huge new mill to saw and dress the slates. It has never been as busy there. They are moving all the old Diffwys tips and tipping them over the rock outcrop that was below, and burying the houses at Tan-y-Graig and Tan-Pistyll.

Diffwys now looks as flourishing as ever. They have built a very large mill above all the working and it is visible from everywhere - bigger than any in Ffestiniog. The quarries have never been as busy as they are these days.

There appears to be the making of a big new quarry at the Maen-y-Fferam ffridd. There are dozens of men working there – from almost all nationalities!

They have driven a rail track from the town to Rhiw Bach. It starts at Dolgarregddu, with an incline up to the Lord quarry and then another one up to the level of Llyn Bowydd. It passes the lake on the Graig Ddu side and carries on until it ends above Rhiw Bach. From there, there is an incline down to the quarry (but this is unfinished at the moment).

{This rail track was begun in 1861 and they started using it in 1862 and it was finished in 1863, so that dates this letter to 1862}

That is quite a lot for you about your old working haunts. This side of town too is full of life.

Llechwedd is much the same as it was.

In Rhiw, they have dug a round shaft near Llyn Iwerddon. It is ten yards square and goes down to the lowest level in the quarry. They intend to have a water ballast there to lift slate and rubble up to the mill. They intend to remove all the rock below the old water ballast. This will be a 'job for life' for somebody!

There is talk about building another large mill at Gloddfa Ganol, in the boggy land behind the Bôn and then work that through into the other part of the quarry. You see that there is no shortage of work here!

You will have heard a lot of talk about Twm Evan James's quarry above Craig Glan-y-Pwll. Speculators have invested £30,000 towards developing this quarry, and they are now working hard – but it is more of a 'rubble sink' than anything else I would say! Be that as it may, what is needed here is employment.

They have started building a flagstone saw mill near the "Mathew" houses. They have also started building an incline up the mountain, but I understand that this must be done in two parts. They are blasting these old rocks until the whole place is shaking!

Cwmorthin is a hive of activity and is looking good. They built a lot of houses there but despite that, they cannot attract enough workers.

They are digging into the Moelwyn in all directions near Drws Ellan – it is like a rabbit warren there.

There are also hopes for a good quarry in Croesor. There are between 120 and 140 working there. They are talking about building a rail track from Porthmadog, through Llanfrothen, to Croesor. This will pass by Erw Fawr and across the Morfa, according to the plans that I have seen. It looks as if Llanfrothen is going to be an important place quite soon. Many who used to live there are planning to move back with the prospects of good employment there.

In this district there are now hundreds of strangers – only about one-in-three is an original inhabitant; the district has changed dramatically. There is a huge boom in building in such a remote place. Dozens of new houses have been built near Congl-y-Wal, Penygroes and Fodlas – and especially around here. There are also many new houses stretching down from Rhiw to Tanygrisiau and a new road has been built down there.

I forgot to tell you anything about wages. Rockmen and quarrymen £1-0-0 to £1-1-0 a week, labourer 18 shillings and miners the same. Quarry men could easily earn £1-5-0 as £1 if they waited a day.???

There is much talk about getting a Hall for the town– but this has been talked about for years and nothing has come of it. Lots of people say that we should not be asking for a hall at the same time as we are getting a new Assembly Room near Llwyn-y-Gell.

There is less business in Ffestiniog since Rhiw is ...?...

Mr Robert D. Roberts along with my dearest relatives living in the Salt Lake Valley, Here I am, trying to compose a few lines from my dear mother's home once more. Fortunately, I am enjoying the benefits of good health - as other members of the family (but these are no longer as numerous as they once were).

I wish to inform you that I received your kind and sincere letter although it had taken a few months to reach me, but it eventually did, perhaps more successfully than other letters. It came via Vermont, where some of my kind friends forwarded it to me. I can assure you that reading that you had arrived safe and well was one of the best things that I have ever read in a letter! I cannot tell you how much I have waited to hear from you. I had sent two letters and another two after going to America, and indeed I was by now not expecting to hear from you ever again as so much time had passed.

I will start with a bit about me; I was very self-confident and enough of a 'lad' (as you know) that I decided to leave my mother's home and head for America. With this youthful determination and commitment, I crossed the wild Atlantic in 13 days - quite successfully without mishap suffering only slightly from sea-sickness. We arrived in New York amidst people from every nation under the sun, speaking every language and where people of all skin colour are to be found – one as numerous as any another.

After spending a week looking around and finding my feet in the majestic city, I decided to set off for the Slate Belt. If I was to try my best, I was sure that I would find something to put in my pocket. I left New York in the all-night steamboat along the North River and arrived in Albany at approximately 5a.m. I then took a train on Troy and from there to Eagle Bridge via many small settlements, too numerous to list. Hence, I was in Fair Haven by noon and that is basically the story of my trip.

The first place that I arrived in was my cousin Kate's home. I was received with a very warm welcome from the whole family – it was as if I was at home on my mother's hearth (but much more contented than I feel at the moment!). I was there for 2 years and 2 months but then the Civil War broke out and no part of the country experienced peace.

I was in school for 3 months that winter and I stayed there until August, only working for 2 or 3 weeks in the whole period. Therefore, I decided that seeing it was so difficult to find work, I should return to Wales - although it was quite contrary to my wishes at the time. But by now, taking everything into consideration, it was much better for me than if I had gone on to carry arms in the War.

I have now been home about a year but am finding it difficult to be at ease. I wish to return as soon as peace returns to the land, and I hope that it happens soon. I much prefer to be in America than 'nesting up in the hills' over here!

Although I was only away from home for a short period, when I returned I found that there were very few faces that I recognised. Ffestiniog's situation had changed markedly. Old friends had passed away and strangers had swamped the area. The words of poet Llywelyn Twrog spring to my mind "Oh! Who does not shed a tear when remembering the Old Times". All the joys and pleasures of childhood are now just memories and have been lost and friends have scattered far and wide. There is nothing to do but seek some comfort in solitude.

All my relatives are well- Eliza and Evan here, and Mam is still working hard but she has aged a lot. Her second husband is healthy and kind enough and is a gang-man at Lewis Thomas's quarry. He regularly earns £1-10-0 a week. He has been good not to drink too much – he's turned out better than expected! Everything considered, my mother has come out pretty well and lives quite as comfortably as ever – if not better (so she says!). The children have left home, apart from four and two of those are earning good money.

Many here have died – I cannot possibly recall all their names, but in a few words, I will try to list some of the ones whom you will recall.

My grandfather from Glan-y-Pwll, Richard Williams (Penygroes), Richard Williams (Tyddyn Gwyn), Bob Jones bach (Llwyn-y-Gell) Daniel Maenofferen's wife, Hugh Benjamin, William Sion Morris (Talywaenydd). Also, Robin Parry bach and Ned Jones (Pen y Rhos) both died in Australia. Hugh (Llandudno) and his old wife, and Robert Jones (Incline) died

a month back. But it is likely that your old friend David Roberts will have told you about some of these already, so I won't tire you by listing more of those that have left this Worldly Realm.

Such a long time has passed without my hearing from you that I find it difficult to know what to write about. I ask your forgiveness but I have written to you four times (at least) and I have only received this letter from you. Believe me that I have been longing to hear if you were still alive.

I understand that you are now a farmer – but, no doubt you would be happier working slates if this was an option for you. One day, I dreamt that I could see Thomas carrying a load of mortar up to the top of the Temple for the stone masons. I laughed out loud. Oh! That I could see you in the Salt Lake Valley!

I often think about Aunt Mary and her dear young children and I wish from the bottom of my heart that they do well there, and also, Uncle Daniel's family. I heard that Catherine had recently married – I am surprised, as she is so young. Send them, one and all, my best wishes. A word from one of Uncle Daniel's or Uncle Sion's {John's} children would be very welcome.

I have to remind Thomas that he promised to write to me from wherever he ended up and promises must be fulfilled. I hope that he writes very regularly from now on.

I hear a lot about the booming gold mines of British Columbia and Vancouver. It is not far from where you are - if you know anything about this, please let me know as I have been thinking a lot about going there. Talking about gold mining, there is quite a boom in the Merionethshire goldfield. They are mining in a place close to Dolgellau, called Clogau. They extracted £10,000 worth of gold from there last year. Pretty good – eh?

Robin Owen (Bethesda) and William (Plas Isaf) have returned from Australia having made very good money there. John (Fourcrosses) and Owen Price (Ty'n y Cefn) have gone to New Zealand to prospect for gold. You see that Ffestiniog boys have gone all over the world seeking their Fortune.

Boys, before I go on to ask you a few questions, take care not to get married whilst you are over there. I do not think that I will be changing my situation in life for quite some time.

First Question: Are you free to leave the Salt Lake as you see fit or are you bound to stay there for life?

Question 2: Do you tolerate other denominations/religions in your midst or others whose beliefs are different from yours, but do not make a point of displaying that to the Mormon World?

Q3: Do you have to be a Saint before you can live there?

Q4: Who is Brigham Young – your governor or your prophet?

Q5: Do you prefer to live in the Land of the Mormons or in Britain?

Q6: How do you live in a Territory before it becomes a State? Do you have laws or is it every man for himself?

I await and expect your full answers to the above questions in your next letter.

I impeach your forgiveness for my untidiness and for going on at such lengths. As I draw to a close, I send you all my warmest regards and also those of my mother, Eliza and Evan.

Your faithful cousin

Robert W. Roberts, Glan-y-Pwll, Blaenau Ffestiniog

Here, I start on the third sheet of this letter without much to add, but yet quite a bit more to say I suppose if only I could remember, but I never can! Let me try to give you the latest about recent marriages.

Dafydd (Bala) and the daughter of Humphrey (carrier)

Hugh Gwilym and Alsi bach

The daughter of Sion William (Penffordd Newydd) and some very nondescript boy from Llanllyfni

Owen (Bron Manod) and Sarah (Bryn Cyfergyd)

Griffith Jones bach and Hannah, daughter of Richard Owen

Thomas O Thomas (Llechwedd) with the daughter of Thomas Williams (Llan)
Old Jack (Llechwedd) and Jane in Ysgol Bachi-haphap {?}
William bach (Ty'n Ddôl) and Margaret , daughter of Wil Jones (flour merchant)
Jack Griffith bach (Tai'r Frest) and Mary Morris (Tŷ Crwn)
Ellen daughter of Andreas with some boy from Bala (policeman)
Daughter Guto (Dolbryn) 16 year old with a boy by the name of Mr. Roberts
Roli bach Sion Hughes with Margaret Morgan.
Hugh his brother with the daughter of Sion Garnmore {?}
Catherine Morris (Tŷ Mawr) with Anne Evan Roberts (Llwyn-y-gell)
Griffiths Price (Ty'n Ddôl) with some girl from Porthmadog
Dic (Betti Richards) with Ellen, the daughter of Creuau Carnedd Hywel.

There! I have named quite a lot for you - ones that have not had the opportunity to enjoy the freedom being young men and, of the women, only a few of them are good enough to stand in front of a washtub for even half a day!

You will be amazed by this huge list of those that have joined the Club.

My Dear Sister

There is something warm and familiar about that word 'sister'. Despite Devine Providence having thrown us far apart, separated by deep oceans, high mountains and vast plains, we are still able to communicate by means of letters such as this, even if we are prevented from meeting face to face. Nor can we be prevented from flying on the wings of imagination, to distant America, crossing lands and seas and not resting until we arrive in Logan City where we can chat to our hearts content about our relatives.

I understand that you had plentiful crops this year and that you get good prices for all types of agricultural produce in your province, and so I gather that you are comfortable. My solemn prayer now is that you get the health and long life to make the most of your blessings and that, at the end of your worldly life, you will be welcomed with open arms by your Good Lord to life everlasting.

There is an unusual vibrancy in this country these days, there is a high demand for slates and consequently, thousands are employed in the slate mines and they are well-paid for their labour.

Railways are being extended in all directions. The railway is being built to connect Aberystwyth with Porthmadog and then on to Porthdinllaen. Another branch goes through Llanllyfni to Caernarfon, and another branch is being constructed from Porthmadog to Beddgelert. These employ lots of men and they pay good wages, consequently, we now find it difficult to find farm workers to help with the hay, despite paying 15 shillings a week and free food.

Our animals are selling well – sheep make good money and cattle as well. These days, you need to pay about £10 to £15 for a cow in calf. Prices of meat and butter are quite high - you cannot buy a pound of fresh butter below 15d or 1/6 a pound. Flour costs are as follows – a sack of best seed £2 to 2 guineas for 280lbs. Wheat 13/- to 14/- a hob. Oat flour £1-8-0 to £1-10-0 a sack (220lb).

From this you can see that it is quite a good life for workers in Wales these days - yes, much easier than it is in England for our English brothers.

I understand that you know that my circumstances have changed. My wife's name is Margaret, she is the daughter of Evan Owen (Glanyrafon, Beddgelert). I can honestly say that I am feeling very happy with married life. It is much better than just living with preachers, like a sparrow sitting on a rooftop with nobody to hear my confessions. {*??? that is definitely what he wrote*}. When our baby was born at the end of last year, my wife was very ill. Indeed, she was so ill that I feared that she was not going to pull through, but the Almighty saw well to save her life, as only He could. The baby however was lost.

Morris Isaac and his wife have two children.

I finish by sending you my best regards to you and all the children. I hope that these few words reach you well and comfortable just as I and all the family are as I write this letter.

I am your dear brother
Richard Thomas

My Dear Nephew

I have hesitated longer than I should have before acknowledging the receipt of your letter dated June 11th 1865. In your letter, you mentioned that you had sent me numerous letters, but had not received a reply. I can assure you that I have not received any letter which went un-answered - I cannot however vouch for the way others to whom you may have written may have responded. I have long awaited a letter from you and I am very grateful for the gift of this letter and so I wish to return your kindness with a courteous reply.

I was very pleased with the contents of your letter as I learnt that you are alive and well and in quite comfortable circumstances as regards making a living in this life. I would like to go on to summarise my own circumstances.

I am enjoying good health and therefore can carry on with my usual employment. I assume that you know that my wife Ellin died almost 21 months ago, consequently, I only have a maid to supervise my material well-being. As you can imagine, however honest and caring a maid is, I am not as comfortable as I was when Ellin and I lived together and saw eye-to-eye on everything. But, however things are, there is nothing to do but to bend to Providence and try one's best to be satisfied with the situation. Providence has been so generous towards me in my present circumstances - I get enough to satisfy my needs - in this world and in the next.

I will now go on to tell you something about your Uncle Robert and his family. He is rapidly deteriorating physically and has almost given up his job in the slate mine. Rhys remains unmarried thus far; he is some sort of supervisor in Mr Holland's quarry {in *Blaenau Ffestiniog*} and the young son is at Erw with his grandparents. Your cousin Mary lives in Tŷ Newydd Cae Glas with her second husband. Eliza lives in Glan-y-Wern. Meurig remains single. He spent some time in Dublin whilst at school.

As regards your cousin R.W.R, I have just received a letter from him asking me to send you his best regards. I understand that your Uncle Richard Thomas has written to you himself, so I cannot add anything about him. Perhaps he did not say anything about Morris Isaac though - he is living at Carreg Alldrem with his second wife (the daughter of W. Hughes, Bryn Celynen) and they have two children.

I think that I have now given you enough detail about your family and what has been going on locally.

But let me finally take you to Ffestiniog. If your mother, or someone who used to be familiar with Ffestiniog, was to return on a visit, they would be very surprised seeing all the new houses that have recently been built there. From Congl-y-Wal to Rhiwbryfdir there are terraces of houses, all facing the main street. They have opened many new slate mines in the area.

There is another major development; you will recall the railway that was built from Ffestiniog down to Porthmadog - it used to be serviced by horses pulling the wagons – but now they have 'iron horses'. They wind their way, steaming through Tanygrisiau down to Porthmadog.

Let us look at Llanfrothen- from the top of the valley (Bwlch Cwmorthin) down to the sea at Porthmadog. A new railway carries the slates down from Rhosydd and Croesor quarries down to Porthmadog. The Croesor valley is dotted with new houses and there is also a brand new chapel there.

We go down a bit now to the shoreline at Traeth Bach and Traeth Mawr, and here we see dozens of men constructing a new railroad to connect Caernarfon with Aberystwyth and necessitating the building of two major new bridges.

The market: a 280lb bag of seed is normally £2-2-0 to £2-5-0 but poorer quality ones may be had for £1-16-0. Oat flour is £1-10-0. Meat of all legally edible animals is between 6d and 9d a pound and butter 1/3 to 1/5 a pound. Animals of all sorts are making good prices.

I have now more or less summarised how things are over here. Religious-wise, things have cooled down quite a bit and things are pretty stagnant these days.

I can now only draw this letter to a close. If it reaches you, then I really hope that you will remember me fondly and give me the gift of an acknowledgement of its receipt. I hope that, as best you can, you will tell me any news about the

families that left Llanfrothen along with you – Wm. Owen's family, Nathan, Ioan Owen (their children), Uncle Daniel's family (that is, his children).

Thus, I close my letter by sending my fondest regards to your mother and all the children. Before I finish and put away my pen, I would like to ask you one final question – does any one of you have even the slightest wish to return to the Old Country – either for a visit or to come back to end your days here?

I am your Uncle
Edward Roberts

A word from the writer to your mother.

It is strange how time slips by and friendships cool with absence. There was great friendship between myself and D. Roberts but to this day, it pains me to think how such a good and sensible man came to be possessed with a fanatical spirit as to lead you as a family to a distant nation rather than stay in your own land, amongst your own people.

I cannot understand that there is any advantage whatsoever to you in this. If you thought that it was a better place to practise your religion, then, as I have heard from one source, you may have been deeply disappointed; surely corruption of the flesh does not glorify religion? A better place to live? It must indeed be a very good place if it better than over here. I am sure that you will have seen the error of your ways.

I have had the opportunity to talk to someone whom I once knew very well, and who has been over there for some time. He gave me a good picture of what goes on with religion – almost too repulsive for me to waste my ink and paper to repeat.

If I am mistaken in what I have said, I ask your forgiveness.

It is likely that there is not one of the saints that can rest comfortably unless they gain forgiveness in this life.

So rests your old friend
No matter who

P.S.

I forgot to say that W. Davies, your Aunt Margaret's husband - that is the wife of your Uncle William has died as a result of an injury in the slate mine. *{make of this what you can – that's what it says!}*

E.R.

Next time I am going to send you my *Carte de visite*.

First of all, I have to tell you that I recently saw Abel Evans {*Mormon missionary*} and another, quite short man who visited this area. I chatted with them and I heard a little about you – mostly good news from when they had last seen you, namely leaving Logan City in a wagon.

Secondly, I have also seen your photographs. You've changed more than I have! But my heart was warmed to see you looking so good and I hope that you remain in good health.

Thirdly, my sister buried her husband, a fortnight before Whitsun. She is now staying here once again and is not as well as she usually is.

We are hoping to send you photographs of ourselves with our next letter- after we hear from you.

I was down in Llanfrothen last week placing a memorial stone on my father's grave. There had been nothing there to mark his burial place, and by now, some twenty years have passed. The Llanfrothen family are all well - in Gelli, Creuau and Erw. I recently received a letter from America from John (?*surname*?). He is now married and has a son by the name of Daniel Abiah Humphrey (what a mouthful of a name – enough to put your mouth out of place trying to get it all out!).

My dear cousin, I feel really bad that I have been so remiss and unmindful not to have written sooner. If you wish to know anything in particular, just ask and I will try to find answers. So many of your old friends have passed away that I could not name them all even if I was able to chat to you for a whole week. The same is true of those who have got married. I am coming to the end of my bachelor days but I would be pleased to hear that you are sticking to your state of bachelorhood rather than getting betrothed to someone from a foreign land.

I must finish by hoping that I receive a letter with lots and lots of your news. I just want to tell you that all of us as a family send you our kindest regards – to you all, from your mother down to Jane and that also extends to the other two families of course, they are too numerous to name individually.

Your friend and fellow traveller/associate D. Roberts sends you his best wishes and promises to write. Many others have said the same but my pen and paper won't allow me to list them all. In the next fortnight, I will write to you again.

I remain your faithful cousin

Robert W Roberts

{*New sheet*}

Six sheets of paper would not be enough to list everything that has gone on in this area in the last two years, so I will excuse myself and just list those things that I think will be of greatest interest. Trying to describe the recent developments in Ffestiniog would be nigh impossible, but in case any of you ever decides to make it over for an unplanned visit anytime I will list a few changes.

A new chapel has been built in Bethania almost adjoining the other one. A large new road has been built from Dafydd Rowlands' smithy way up towards Maenofferen fields and another from Fourcrosses up towards the Unicorn bridge. The fields near Tyddyn Gwyn are dotted with new houses and David (Bron Manod) has built a new inn at the junction with the new road.

You would be amazed at the changes that have taken place.

The Wesleyans have built a new chapel opposite the old Maenofferen store and a Baptist chapel has been built on Unicorn Street and a Methodist chapel in the field below Fuches Wen – the largest and finest chapel in the county and quite an embellishment for the town. It will seat about 800 comfortably.

A new public hall has been built by the new church. There is an indoor market where we can readily buy just about anything that we want and all sorts of public meetings are held in the hall itself. Linked to the hall there is a News Room (a reading room) where all the weekly Welsh newspapers along with the English papers are at hand as well as the various religious denominations' monthly publications.

Hopefully this will satisfy you for now, I will tell you a lot more the next time.

I and my brother.....

{finishes abruptly}

There have been many changes since you set off; there have been many accidents making things quite uncomfortable, especially in the Middle Mill. I will name a few of your acquaintances who were killed and call them by the name that you would recognise. Richard William (Pen-yr-Orsedd) was hit in head by crane handle, David Jones fawr (Tanygrisiau) had a hole blast back on him and Jack (the servant) had a large slate slab slide onto him, hurting him badly. Many whom you would not know have also been killed or badly hurt.

Many have emigrated from here this last summer- young men going to Australia and old Edward Jones (Penrhos) followed them there.

Employment in the quarries was slack this last winter and wages were poor. It was not easy to find work at that time but it has improved lately. There is a good demand for slates - selling better than ever. Despite this, the drop in salaries that happened last winter was not restored and it is unlikely that it will happen at least until the end of the year.

It has been an excellent summer for us thus far. The grass and wheats have been harvested neatly everywhere and there has been an excellent yield. But we have never seen potatoes as bad as this year. Everywhere, throughout the country, they began to show well and flowers appeared, but then a plague hit them.

The prices of everything remain high. All grain and animal flour is about 52 shillings for 280lb, oat flour in a Tremadog sack is 30 shillings. Animal prices, especially horses and cattle, are good.

I sent my cousin's regards on to William Williams the poet and to Ellis Roberts. They asked me not to write back to you without letting them know - but I have waited a long time already but I fear that the Muse must have left them or they would have composed a pile of bungling words by the thousand by now. I hope that they will be ready by next Monday or else I will send my poor letter to swim the sea without them.

I think that you will have heard about recent troubles and disasters. If I knew that you were not seeing the newspapers then I would send a few on to you. We hope that the insurrection will soon be over as many British soldiers have gone over to settle things.

I hope my dear cousin that you will write as soon as you can and that your letter will be full of news.

My dear uncle, how are you there by now? I often imagine seeing you and I would love to have the opportunity to sit and talk to you - but as that is impossible, we will have to do that using paper and ink. We can use this as a means to communicate despite the thousands of miles that separate us. Let us make a habit of this.

I finish by wishing you all, as families, the very best - one and all.

I am yours in the most sincere way
Rees Roberts

My Dearest Sister,

Your letter dated March 26th arrived safely. It feels very special, here in my hands, as I look at it and read its contents.

You have expressed your emotions and feelings of longing for the Old Country and those times that we played together as children, with bat and ball. Such thoughts and memories go around and around in my head as well. The warmth of the love that I feel means that I can almost see you there, in person, in front of me. We will have to share such feelings of emotion until we can fall into one another's arms once again - despite all the vast lands and seas that today separate us. Perhaps there will come a day when we can again shake one another's hands and chat face-to-face about everything and 'put the world to rights'.

You mentioned old friends and who have passed away. I am afraid that I have to tell you that more have left this Worldly Realm since I last wrote. Namely, Evan Jones (Garthfoel) and his oldest son John Samuel (Cefn Cyffin) and Henry Jones (Tyddyn Gwyn). There are no major outbreaks of disease here apart from the measles and scarlet fever. This has struck several children in the Beddgelert and Porthmadog areas but we have been quite fortunate around here.

You were very keen to hear about Thomas Jones and Robert Jones. Thomas moved away some four or five years ago. Bachelorhood had such a hold on his constitution that he was not able to get on with the maids {*young girls?*} in Hendre Sela. He has taken up home with his sister and is now working somewhere. As for Robert, he has gone to work in the working horses' stable. He has a wife and one child and they live in a small cottage; he works hard. You would be surprised to see how old they both look. Robert lives close to Garn Dolbenmaen.

I heard suggestions from someone that your daughter Anne had married, but I cannot figure out from your letter whom she might have married. I would very much like you to tell me in your next letter – is this true or not?

I sort of gathered from your letter that you would like to return to the Old Country. If you were to do so, I would be happy to give you every assistance that I {*emphasised*} could possibly offer and there would be a warm welcome awaiting you when you got back. People make a good living here, there is plenty of work and a good wage. The old Gerrynt slate quarry is again working and there is further construction work going on there. They are planning to build a railroad down through Cae Dafydd, Hafod Garregog, Creuau, Carreg Alldrem and Erw Fawr where it would join the line coming from Croesor and Rhosydd quarries, thereby allowing the slates to be transported to Porthmadog. However, I personally doubt that this plan will ever be realised.

In your last letter, you sent me the costs of various things over there, but I don't see much purpose in doing the same, as there has been little change from my last letter – apart from the cost of sheep. These are some five shillings a head more valuable these days. There is a disease amongst cattle which has meant that thousands have had to be culled since I last wrote. In this neck of the woods, we have been fortunate that the disease has not appeared – but we are not allowed to move cattle from one county to another without a licence signed by a Justice of the Peace.

As you can see from the enclosed, we agree with you that it would be good to exchange photographs. I hope that you can reciprocate with your next letter.

I now bring things to a close and there is no better way to do so than to send you our best regards and good wishes – to both yourself and the children. My sincerest prayer is that these few lines find you all fit and well, just as we ourselves are, and that, when we leave this Worldly Realm, we are deemed worthy of Everlasting Life. Amen.

The following people wish me to convey their best regards: Morris Isaac, Ellin Jones (Turnpike), Catherine Parry (Hendre Sela) and also many more old friends.

Your most faithful brother
Richard Thomas

Mrs Catherine Roberts, Logan City

Dear Uncle Edward Roberts

Perhaps you feel disgruntled, waiting for a letter from me, but I will try to make good if I can. I was really grateful for your kind letter giving a short, concise rundown of family matters and what's being going on locally, where we were all born and raised, where we spoke our first words and took our first steps, where our relatives and old friends – whom we used to love, and to be happy with, but whose company we no longer have after we moved to a distant land. The reason for this separation we will get to later in this letter.

Now we come to your letter. Firstly, I was sorry to understand that Aunt Ellen had died, but there is nothing that can be done when the Call comes to leave loved ones. We are glad that God has blessed you with health and strength. If you have found yourself a good maid then I will be glad to hear that you have made her your wife. If I come on a visit to the Old Country, I will be pleased to meet with any new cousins through my Uncle Edward.

Secondly, I regret that my Uncle Robert is in failing health - this is the situation that my father could foresee happening to himself - it was certain to come. "Whilst I am able to work", he used to say, "I will get a wage, but when I get old and unable to work, I will be thrown aside as an old man, and I will only get whatever they see fit to give me. Something which would not be half enough to keep me I'm sure. That will be my situation before long, so I think that I should get a parcel of land for myself where I could build a cottage that I could call my own. I'd have no rent to pay and would not be left with a month's notice to quit. I could build a palace if I wished and live there, plant fruit trees, work the land raise animals – sheep, horses and cattle and I could live independently and honestly, not relying on wealthy landowners who just sit on their backsides, feasting and making a living on the backs of me and my sort. If I was half an hour late, or if I left early, I would be fined sixpence or a shilling but if I was on my own land then I could work when I wanted and rest when I wished. I would eat the fruits of my own labour, from land which I could call my own and thereby prepare for my old age".

Now I go on to tell you about the Llanfrothen and Ffestiniog families who emigrated. Firstly, Aunt Gwen who is living in Box Elder as a widow, but has enough for her keep. Catherine {*daughter of Daniel & Winifred R*} has married somebody by the name of Amos Wright, an American, and has three or four children, and lives in Bear Lake Valley, 40 miles to the north of here. Elizabeth has married somebody with the name Collap {?} Jones, a Welshman. Aunt Mary lives in Carson Valley, we have not had a letter from her for over a year – she was alive and well at that time. Cadwaladr Owen lives in Hyrum, eight miles from here. He has recently buried his wife and has five or six children. Owen, his brother is living in Willow Creek and is married. Margaret his sister lives in Wellsville and is married to {?} with lots of children. Owen Jones lives in Box Elder with a Welshman by the name William Wilbertt {?}. Owen can go to every house in Park Elder without being led and he can go to David Peters' home, two miles from Park Elder. His sister, Ann, buried her husband some time ago and lives in The Great Salt Lake City with a lot of children. Hugh Jones lives somewhere near Council Bluff but I don't know much about him. David Peters is alive and well, unless something has happened recently. Sarah and Laura his daughters, have married Americans and have two or three children. David Eames lives here in Logan and has about 40 acres of good land and five or six children. David often asks me when I last heard from the Old Country, who wrote and was there anything about Robert Rhys. But I have not heard anything about him – he's probably still alive or somebody would have said something. David Eames would be glad to hear some news about his sisters - if you see Robert Rhys or his family, send them his best regards.

This spring, the weather has been kind and as a result of hard labour, everything looks good. We have had enough rain. The season is a month earlier than last year.

There have been major developments in this valley in the last seven years since we arrived - there were only about forty families living in the whole valley then. Now, there are twenty towns and villages. In Logan, there are some hundreds of families. Seven years ago, I could name every person that lived here, but today I don't know even a quarter of them. Perhaps I am one of the first ones to settle in this area – when I arrived first there were no stores or shops or a market any closer than Great Salt Lake City, but now there are stores, full of all sorts. We used to have to go Box Elder to the mill - 20 miles away, but today there are two mills here – one mills 200 baskets {?} every 24 hours, and in the Valley, there are lots of corn mills - somewhere no white man dared stand some 8 or 10 years back.

Now, since the writer took the opportunity to address my mother in his letter, I take this opportunity to respond.

Firstly, she is amazed that a man of wholesome spirit such as my father, David Roberts, is said to have become possessed and fanatical causing him to lead his children to a foreign land.

My uncle Richard Thomas, in a letter addressed to my mother, stated that it was Divine Providence that had separated us and that is the truth; but what is the reason for this? I said at the start of my letter that I would try to explain this.

If you believe that we have been pure these past days, then I refer you to Daniel 2⁴⁴ and this verse will show you that our Heavenly Father does not have a realm or kingdom on earth during these days – these Latter Days. If so, what have you to say against Joseph Smith? He says that God appeared before him during these days and that he went on to accept the holy priesthood, and God gave him the right to preach that everyone had the right to hear the gospel and to become priests in order to realise God's Kingdom on earth during these Latter Days. He saw evidence himself of the truth of the Gospel, that no individual should miss out on the evidence.

However, some who attended the church and saw the evidence that this was indeed God's Church but despite this, turned their backs, saying that this was all a falsehood - but this does not prove that the Gospel and the principles have changed. God remains the same, but man changes and forgets the evidence. This is natural for man – read about the Children of Israel when Moses led them and you will see how they celebrated and praised God after crossing the Red Sea, but soon afterwards, began to complain bitterly.

Gwynndy, Rhiwbryfdir, Blaenau Ffestiniog
*{Letter mentions Gwen being about 14 years old.
 She is recorded as being 18 on the 1871 Census,
 hence this letter must be dated around 1867}*

Dear Cousin and Family

Here I am after years of delay, sitting down to write a few lines to you. I hope that you are all experiencing good health as we are (perhaps better than we deserve).

I have written you several letters, but I now know that you have not received a single one of them or you would have mentioned it in ...?...

I have seen several from you ...?... and heard that some have reached ...?... Robert ... and Uncle Edward and R.W. Roberts, our cousin.

I don't really know how to start, so I will just start as things come to mind.

We will start off in the slate quarries. From Talywaenydd right up almost to the top of Allt Fawr has now become what a stranger would think of as one huge quarry because the three existing quarries have grown so much. It would be difficult for a stranger to know which is which.

There have been many changes here as regards births, marriages and deaths but it would not be useful for me to name more than a few whom I think that you would know.

Deaths: Owen Thomas (watchmaker), Owen Thomas and his wife (Bethesda), Price Jones (shop), Dr Vaughan Jones. Smallpox affected the town two years ago and many died – far too many to name.

Marriages: A week ago R.W. Roberts (our cousin) was married to a daughter of Owen Jones (Llenyrch Moch). All that I know is that she is a beautiful young woman. (Owen Jones is dead.)

Robert Owen (Bethania) with the daughter of William Jones (The Flour {merchant} – that's how I knew him!).

Robert Thomas (Fuches Wen) with some woman from Capel Curig.

Robert Williams (Congl y Wal) but I don't know details.

And lastly, and most unexpectedly, Thomas (Creuau) has married some woman from Beddgelert!!!

And Morris Isaac has re-married – with some young girl, and he's had three children from her!

I too have got married as I told you that I intended to when you were setting off on your journey. But within three years, I lost her – she went the way of all wordly beings, aged just 23 years. I have a son, who will be ten years old next May 1st and I think the world of him. He lost his mother at a very young age but is a good lad and easy to care for and has been thus these past eight years. I don't yet know if there is anybody else for me - up until now, none has appeared.

Mr Holland's Quarry has grown more than any other around here and there is enough work for two stewards there - and this is how I have been employed these past three years. I am the deputy or foreman to Robert Owen – Mr Holland's Manager. It is quite difficult although ...?... In such a big place, with close to 500 employed, I do a lot of the accounts, although there is a clerk who works full-time in the office and two slate inspectors.

I am lodging close to Dinas in a new house between Dinas and Llwyn-y-Gell. I have two rooms and the family do my chores. That is a bit of information for you about my situation in life.

My mother and father are making a very comfortable living as farmers and quite well although my father suffered from Se?fs Fever a while back and was quite ill - we feared if he was going to make it. His health has not been good ever since. They make a very comfortable living – better off than they have ever been. They have more than doubled their land holding.

My sister married but become widowed as her husband died at Rhosydd Quarry. She remarried in two years with the half-brother of her first husband. You see that she must have been attracted to the breed! They are now living comfortably and between them they have five children.

Elin is married and lives in Wisconsin – that is all that I know.

Elizabeth has married a man from near Pwllheli and lives close to Garreg with three children. She has room for 3 or 4

cows.

Ellis is still farming at home and is as fat as ever!

Meurig is in the quarry and he too is quite ...?... He was recently a sailor {?} with the Paddies in the school {?} in Dublin.

William is also working in the quarry and he too is a big man and ...?...

Lastly, Gwen who is at home with her mother of course. She is quite bad-mouthed, as the youngest child always is! I think that she is about 14 years old.

Now a note about prices over here. Everything is quite expensive these days, but women still cost the same.

Wheat flour 55/- for 280lb Oat flour 35/- 240lb Beef meat 7d to 8d a pound, Mutton 10d, Hams 10-11d, Butter 1/5, Potatoes 1/3, Tea and sugar is not too bad - Tea 3/8 and a pound of sugar 5d.

Clothes are very expensive since they charge so much for making them. Working shoes cost 15/- but fashion ones 20/- Jim Crow hats cost 5/- and Silk hats 15/-

Well dear cousin I have given you a lot of information there. I would be delighted to see you, and all of the family, but that is probably unlikely. I would however like to receive a letter from you, full of news about you all, as soon as you possibly can get around to writing.

Remember me to your dear mother and to all the children. If you see any of my acquaintances, send them my regards – especially my two aunts and their children.

I am including my Card in this letter. If convenient I would be glad to receive your card.

My kindest regards to you all – a thousand-fold. I finish by wishing you as a family every success.

Your faithful cousin

Rees Roberts

Dear Cousin

I received your letter the day before yesterday (23rd January). My heart never felt as joyous as when I saw the photographs that you sent and I was so glad to read that you are all well as a family, out there in the far West. I am pleased to be able to say that we, as a family, are also as well as normal. I cannot put down in words or express how pleased we all were to see your photographs. Previously, my mother and the others had very different ideas as to how things might be over there. The photograph of my aunt kept us smiling for a whole month! She is there, just as natural as if she was alive. "Oh, look! She's laughing" they said "I think that she has lost her teeth" said others. But the story always ended with "If only we could see her...". The photograph of yourself reminded me of your dear father – I think that you bear a great resemblance to him both in your gestures and around your mouth. It is much more of a likeness than the other photograph that you sent. I will treasure them forever.

I think that if your Janie was here, she would get a husband in no time - she is such a pretty girl. Everybody that has seen her picture says that there is something very likeable in her appearance. They are great photographs – very natural and we are so grateful to have received them. When all hope of seeing you has been lost, I will still have these images to hang on to. But where are the photographs of Thomas, Daniel, Anne and Elizabeth? Pardon me for being so bold "This Welshman is always requesting...".

I include my own photograph for you with this letter and am determined to send photos of the rest of the family as soon as we have them taken. But perhaps we will await hearing that you have received this one before we send more. I must get this chapter finished and look for something to say.

Firstly, I would like to acknowledge receipt of three newspapers from you. I enjoyed looking through them although my English is not great. I will try to send you some copies of 'Baner ac Amserau Cymru' {*Welsh newspaper*} occasionally.

You had a lot of questions about the Reading Room {*library in Blaenau*}, asking for as many details as possible. The main sponsors for the building were local nobility and quarry-owners. After this, a local committee of the Great and the Good was elected to draw up rules and to select the newspapers that would be available. Nine different newspapers are provided – in both English and Welsh, along with monthly periodicals published by all the religious denominations. Books have not been yet been obtained but local quarrying companies intend to supply books of all sorts.

By paying a penny, and giving one's address to the supervisor, it will be possible to borrow one of these books for a week or longer. The usual cost for a worker to join this system is a shilling per quarter, or a penny each time that a book is borrowed (note that payment is per quarter). For this we can call in any time from 10a.m. until 9p.m. I can assure you that this has already been of immeasurable benefit to the town but much remains to be done.

In my clumsy way, that is about as much as I can say about the arrangements.

I must now change my tune and turn to the minor key to raise a complaint here about the severity of this winter. I cannot remember seeing such a season – snow drifts, ice and bitter cold (at least in this area). The haggard, dark rocks that surround the town were covered in white and looked pure and smooth. Only a few men have been able to work this month and I am afraid that many have suffered as a result of a shortage of fuel at this, the coldest of times. It is however good to report that the Giver of All Gifts has now seen fit to take away the snow, for a while at least, by pouring rain like waterfalls from the skies. It rained as if it were never going to stop.

I think that I gave you a glimpse of the changes that there have been in the district in my last letter but as time and years pass, generation follows generation and so I do not think that I can list all who died, got married and so on unless I think that you would know them well.

Married:

Joseph Griffith (Dolgarregddu) with the daughter of Will Robert (shoemaker)

Lewis, son of Jack bach (formerly of Tanrallt) with some girl from Beddgelert

From the Erw, my Uncle Eban (Glan-y-Pwll) and his cousin from Llanberis. I went to Liverpool at Christmas to tie together these last two and I had a great time.

Dic Joseph (shoemaker) as well

Will Robin Sion with Lisa (Trefeini)

John Holland with the sister of Stuart Holland

Hugh Griffith (Penygroes) – since dead and buried

Hugh Pengwern and Will Hughes (Fourcrosses) and also his brother (also Ellen, daughter of Griffith Jones (R'unicorn)) with some boy from Llanllyfni.)

But I think that it will be better for me to bring this list to a close although there could be much more that I could add. I am afraid that I cannot remember all the wives' names.

Before finishing, excuse me for saying so, but David Roberts is a 'proper fully-fledged bachelor'. He promises to write to you soon. Don't be frightened if you hear that I have got married by the next letter! What about your branch of the family? You are almost at the stage of life where you will enter the cold world of bachelorhood - take care that you never fall into that category. But I must leave this, and tell you some more about our family.

My mother is fit and well and gets enough for her keep and honestly, I think that she is happier than she has ever been. Betsan has been here with us since she buried her husband. She too is healthy and happy and sends you all her best wishes. At home, there remains just one boy – David, the youngest of the lot, who is 13 years old and is working with us in the quarry and earns from £3 to £4 per month. Despite everything that life throws at us we are living quite well. Oh, yes, my cousin Meurig is now lodging with us here. He has just as large a beard as I have. You will notice from my photograph that I am much hairier than you!

{An englyn – special form of poetry that he wrote. It is impossible to translate. It goes something like this}

Curly rings encircle my mouth

Smooth my chin with sharp implements

Shaving around the mouth never makes you look good

The employment situation around here is pretty much unchanged but things are quite bad in London, Liverpool, Merthyr and many other places and there are fears that this will happen. We hear good news from America though - on the same day that I got your letter, I also received another, saying that there was plenty work over there in the slate quarries and that they were paying \$2-75 this winter- it was \$3½ in the summer. I sometimes have the yearning to return to America but I probably will stay here a while longer.

'Well House bach' has recently come home to visit from over there. He is setting off back home in February. I heard that my Aunt Ellen and family over there were fit and well.

Another thing – have you heard that Wales has been given Patagonia to make a homeland? A group of 150 settlers went over eighteen months ago and they are beginning to make a success of it. Another group are setting off next April. A plan is afoot in the land to raise £50,000 to facilitate commerce. Some of the major players in Wales are working hard for the emigration movement and I am sure that it will succeed if the Welsh populous support it.

That is the end of my news, you will get a lot more the next time, but I have written quite a lot more than I normally do since I had to answer your questions.

Now you remember to keep to your promise and reply as soon as possible! I cannot stress how glad I am to hear from you.

I studied the photograph of Brigham - does he consider himself your regional governor as well as the spiritual leader for you Mormons?

Is there any chance of our getting photographs of Uncle Daniels' wife and family?

Accept my kindest regards, from the bottom of my heart

Your dear cousin

Robert W. Roberts

12 May, 1867

Our Dear Children

We are all well here, we hope that you too are well.

At the moment, there is no supply of leather here in Barkdy to make shoes for you, but as soon as I get some, I will make some, to be ready when you come here.

Robert Fishburn was here yesterday. He wanted to know if you were coming to live here. He has a lot and a house with a KREL?? on it with fence poles, lumber and apple trees - from 20 to 31. {???

I told Fishburn that you could not come here for at least a month. I would like a reply as soon as possible- do you want his place or not?

Sarah Mighels {*Michaels?*} died six weeks before the Conference.

Robert is looking for another wife.

Thornton's wife died three weeks before the Conference. Thornton went to the Conference and he married that woman who was with Samuel Taylor's wife.

There are numerous young women here who have got married recently.

Hugh and Mary Roberts

Hannah's parents, RDR's in-laws, also EWR's in-laws of course)

To. Mr Robert D Roberts, Logan City

Dear Friend

Week after week, and year after year, I have delayed writing to you despite having intended to do so. Now I have no recourse other than to seek your pardon and accept that I was at fault.

I hope that this letter finds you in good health as I and my family are.

About seven years have passed since I last received a letter from you, but I understand that you have sent me your regards in your letters to other family members, and that you bear no grudge against me for being so remiss. Believe it or not, but I did write a very long letter to you about a year after you had left this country (after I had received a letter from you) but it was too heavy when I took it to the Post Office, so I took it back and decided that I should re-write it in a more condensed form by cutting out things not directly relevant, but I waited too long and consequently it never did get re-written.

With that background, I will now go ahead and tell you a bit about what has been happening here and with me these past seven years.

About eight years ago I joined with four others to take over a slate quarry near Machynlleth. The others were Uncle Edward, John Evans, (Tanyclogwyn), William George (Tanygrisiau) and my father. We went there to work and initially we thought that we could work it on our own, but it needed further investment which we could not afford, and so we decided to sell it. We did quite well with it and got £40 to £50 profit each (after paying salaries and costs). After having finished there, I returned to work in the Lord Quarry in Blaenau and found that wages there had improved quite a lot in the 18 months that I had spent in Machynlleth.

I decided to buy six houses that my father owned in Tanygrisiau for £120, and I now rent these out for £20 per annum. After that, I decided to go to school in Liverpool and I spent 15 months there. That was expensive and time-consuming and I didn't actually learn as much as I had hoped that I would; I don't regret going there though.

I returned home about two and a half years ago – returning somewhat before the end of my course, to attend the funeral of my cousin and fond business partner, William George (Tanygrisiau) who died suddenly.

The first thing that I did after that was to get married (March 1st, 1867) but I am sure that you will have heard about that. My wife is the daughter of Owen Mathew (Talywaenydd) and we live in one of William Foulkes houses near the crossroads at Glan-y-Pwll. We have a nine-month-old son.

I moved from Lord Quarry to Rhiw Quarry some 18 months ago. And am doing well there.

I don't know who exactly I should write about – but it would take too long, so I will only mention a few. If any old friend comes to your mind, ask, and I will tell what they have been up to.

Perhaps you did not hear about the deaths in Australia of Edward Jones (Penrhos), William Davies (shop) and Robert Parry bach. William (Plas Isaf) returned from Australia but was killed on the railway coming up from Porthmadog. Robert (Bronmanod) also died after returning from the same place. As you can see, several of my close friends and contemporaries have passed on recently, others have got married or moved away to foreign lands. You could say that only my cousin Robert and myself are left here.

Much has been happening in Blaenau these past few years. Steam trains now run along the railroad to Porthmadog and there is another railroad that goes from Dolgarregddu to Llan. The slate quarries are flourishing. You probably know that Robert Owen (Bethania) is now a steward at the quarry.

I was able to read the letter that you had sent your cousin Rees and I am very pleased to hear that you are alive and in good health and are doing well over there. I learnt that, as a family, you have lost a dear husband and father who was a good man. I was glad to learn from your letter that the country is now doing better and that transport, produce and commerce are all improving.

Don't you sometimes fancy coming back home to work? Now that the railroad has been completed it would not take you very long to get back here.

I was glad to hear that Elizabeth had got married to somebody from Wales.

I finish by asking you to pass on to your mother my warmest and sincerest regards, also of course to everybody else – Thomas, Daniel and your young sister. I send my best wishes to Elizabeth and her new husband.

Please send me a reply when you are able to do so. When I walk these old hills and pass places where we used to sit and talk, my heart fills with emotion and *hiraeth*. I am hopeful that another Saturday afternoon will come to pass when I can once more sit there with you.

The two of us send you our best regards

Your old friend

David Roberts

P.S.

Your cousin Meurig has married a girl from the Trefriw area, Llanrwst. Your family are well and send you their regards.

4th December 1868

Dear Aunt

I hope that you are all well as we currently are here.

My father sent you a letter quite a while ago and hopes to get a reply. He is posting you a newspaper and an Almanac for the new year today.

Please tell Nain and Taid *{grandmother and grandfather}* that I send them my best regards, and all the family too. My father, mother and grandmother as well as Lizzie and Maggie send you all best regards.

I am your niece

Mary Jane Roberts

5th August 1869

Our Dearest Mother and Father

We received your kind letter some time ago. We are very sorry to have taken so long to reply. We are quite busy here now with visitors – there are hundreds of them!

We hope that you are all as a family healthy and comfortable, just as we are when these lines leave us.

Elisabeth, Mary Jane and I were over in Harlech for Whitsun. They were all well there and had received a letter from you; they had answered it before we arrived. We visited places like Abermaw. Robert has become a strong young man and resembles his Uncle John; I really missed you {hiraeth} since Robert reminded me so much of John. Jane and I chatted and chatted about you all. She is going to come here quite soon.

On the front of this letter, you will see a picture of this village. It does not show our new house because it is lower down, opposite the school. We are expecting that this row of houses will be photographed(?) soon.

We have all sorts of sweets, biscuits, toys, shoes and clogs on sale here and they are selling quite well. Mary Jane and Lizzie attend school daily. They have a Tea Party tomorrow, arranged by William Platt in the hall.

Our sister Jane saw that Mary Jane bore a huge resemblance to her grandmother. She is really sharp too just like her grandmother.

We have a very nice, large parlour here. We got a carpet recently and the room is now full of furniture. Our front garden is very pretty – full of flowers at the moment. We have the nicest front garden in this row of houses - and this is just our first year here.

We hope that you will write to us soon and tell us all the news. We will reply sooner the next time.

My mother sends you all her kindest regards.

Margaret has moved to live in Penmaenmawr. Hugh Davies has found a good place.

The two of us and Mary Jane and Lizzie and Maggie all send you our kindest regards

Remember us to anyone there who mentions us.

We are your son and daughter

Robert E. Roberts

Dear Dad and Mam

I am sending you these few lines hoping that you are all well, as we are when these lines leave us.

We received your letter last week. We were so happy to receive it and to understand that you are all healthy and comfortable in your new country. We have often thought about writing to you, but have delayed thus far. After waiting so long though, we don't have much news for you.

My father went to Llanrwst recently. He met Aunt Mary and our Aunt Margaret and found them both well. The Llanfairfechan family were well and very comfortable too.

Aunt Elisabeth intends to visit us at Whitsun. We got a letter from them yesterday.

Aunt Margaret was here last week. They live in a mill in Dyffryn. She took the letter with her so that all her family could read it. She has one daughter and four sons. The youngest is 13. The eldest daughter married a sailor four years ago and they live close by with their three children.

The eldest son is a blacksmith, the second son is a joiner and the other two are still at home. They are all well and send you their regards. They are delighted to hear that you are all well and comfortable.

My Uncle Griffith (my father's brother) sends you his regards. He and his family are well. His eldest son got married a year ago and has a young son. They live in Liverpool. The other son married five years ago and lives in Ffestiniog. He has three children. His daughter is in service in Porthmadog.

My Uncle Hugh lives within a mile of us. He has seven living children and one dead. Two of them are in service.

My Aunt Jane (my father's sister) is in service.

Little Hannah is still pretty small. She has not grown very much - she was one year old last February.

Jane Elisabeth is a lovely three-year-old.

Humphrey is eight and attends school.

We have made a garden outside the front door this year and we carried flowers to plant there.

I, your grand-son Robert, have the honour of writing to you so that you can see my handwriting. I would much prefer to see you face-to-face.

I was pleased to read the letter that you sent here.

I started to work with my father nine months ago.

I hope that these lines find you well as they leave us.

Our kindest regards

Edward J Humphreys and Robert your grand-son.

Dear Taid and Nain {*grandmother and grandfather*} and family

I too am being given the honour of writing to you so that you can see my writing work.

I am at home nursing Hannah - she is a bit of a handful. I also crochet netting headwear.

My father showed me pictures of Llanfairfechan, Aunt Catherine and Mary and Margaret and Hannah.

I would like to see you - everybody says that I resemble the picture of Hannah.

I send you all my kindest regards

Your grand-daughter

Mary Humphreys (aged 13)

Dear Taid and Nain {*grandmother and grandfather*} and family

I am writing a few lines so that you can see my handwriting.

Robert is helping me with my spelling. I am at school.

Mother says that I grow to resemble Aunt Mary more and more every day.

I would like to see her and the other aunts who live there.

I send you all my kindest regards

Your grand-child

M. Humphreys (aged 10)

1860-1861

Llanfairfechan Post Office

28th January, 1870

Our Dear Dad and Mam

We hope that you are all as a family healthy and well as we all are here.

We are feeling very concerned as we have heard from you – even a brief word would be acceptable. I hope that you will agree not to let a single post to pass without replying – even half a dozen words would suffice.

We sent you a letter quite a long time ago, along with several newspapers and an Almanac.

We got a letter from Harlech saying that a baby boy arrived on the 24th of this month. They were doing well at the time.

Mary Jane, Lizzie and Maggie send you kind regards. Jane now writes and she can sew – you would be surprised to see the quality of her work. She runs errands.

Her Eglwysbach grandmother ..?... Owen Jones (Nant) spent the weekend with us recently.

We finish by sending you our kindest regards

We are your son and daughter

Robert and Elisabeth Roberts

P.S.

My mother sends you her best regards

P.P.S.

Remember to write soon. To put us at ease.

Dear Sister and Nephews

I am very sorry that I have not written to you earlier after receiving your letter dated 4th of January, 1867, but there is an old Welsh saying 'Better late than never' so we ask your forgiveness this time and we will try to do better from now on.

We wish you to pass on our warmest thanks to Thomas, Robert and Jane for their photographs. Although we don't have the pleasure of seeing them face-to-face, the photographs create a picture of how they look now, how they have grown and how they are clothed. My, how they have grown since we saw them back here in 'Quiet Wales' when they were children and used to play around the fire here in Creuau. But there is an old saying 'As the child, so will be the man'.

I can't but remember the old times when Daniel (or Little Daniel as he then was) ran away from Ffestiniog one day to come here to Creuau and I had to bring him back up. On the way, I gave him a half-crown coin as a present and he said that he would drill a hole in it to remind him of me. But by now Little Daniel is a man – how strange is that! But things change, generation follows generation, boys become men... and the young become the elderly. I really would like to get a photograph of Daniel, and in return, I will send him a photograph of Catherine Ann - my own daughter

We are really grateful for your photographs and are happy to see that you are looking so good in your new land. We heard a rumour that you had married - we would like to know whether that is true or false. If true, what nationality is your new husband?

Now on to some news about this country. Everything is going on quite well and market prices are good. Cattle in calf make £10 to £16, horses are exceptionally scarce and expensive, fat pigs (living) make five pence a pound, butter is one shilling and sixpence to one and eight a pound, bacon is ten pennies a pound and salted butter 1/2 a pound. The flour market is poor, best seed is £2 for a 224lb sack, and oat flour is £1-9-0 a sack.

Many things have changed in the Old Country since you left; a large railway has been built between Porthmadog and Caernarfon and down to Aberystwyth. It is a great convenience as we can now send anything by rail to anywhere in the country. This has resulted in a significant increase in prosperity and commerce. Especially so for the slate industry, as thousands of tons of slates are now being sent all across the country by rail. There are good employment opportunities in the area and good wages to be made.

We would like to know about America when you next write, and especially about the development of the railway. How has this affected your country? Good or bad?

Since the country is booming, land owners are cashing in and realising the value of their land. Rents are rising everywhere – ours, here at Creuau has risen from 18 guineas to £30.

We hope that this letter finds you well – as we are well here. We send you all our very warmest regards. Give us all your news in your next letter – and be totally honest.

Your dear brother and sister
Richard & Margaret Thomas

To: Robert David Roberts
Dear Nephew

Since I get this opportunity, I too will write to you. I wish to inform you that I am alive and well and still living in Gelli.

I would be pleased to get a letter from you telling me what you have been doing and how things are going in your new country. I send you all our best regards as a family and hope that you are enjoying good health.

I remain your dear uncle
Edward Roberts
Gelli

Dear Uncles Edward Roberts (Gelli) and Richard Thomas (Creuau)

If there is cooperation between my hand, my eye, my mind and my heart then I intend to present you with the story of this land, as correctly as I can. But I am not sure how to start as the American continent is so huge and Wales is only a tiny drop in the ocean by comparison. There are thousands of acres of land here, many expansive valleys with wild rivers running through them, all filled with fish and all uninhabited, apart from a few Indians here and there, hunting and fishing and just living on these.

The railroad is bringing great improvements from coast to coast – I think that it is now 3,000 miles long and about 1,500 of these miles is through uninhabited lands. Hundreds of farms and townships have been built along the track, bringing homes and employment to thousands of settlers. Utah has been transformed by the Saints who have built about 300 miles of railroads, but despite the help and hard work of the Saints, the railroad owners have kept back some thousands of dollars from their wages. The Company was in debt to the Saints to the sum of \$1,500,000 some while back, but I think that they have by now repaid at least some of this.

Here are some of the prices that we pay over here, so that you can see how things compare - sugar 60c to \$1 a pound, yellow calico o 60c-\$1¼ a yard, tea \$4-\$5 a pound, but you can buy sugar for 20c-25c and the calico for 20-25c a yard and tea from \$2-\$3 a pound. Flour is 3c a pound but it used to be 6c a pound and sometimes even 10c. Barley, oats and corn for animals have kept their prices well.

Things are very dead around Utah these days but I believe things will improve when the railroad company repay their debts to the poor workers.

Logan City is the main settlement in Utah and here both companies have decided to build a station. One track comes from California and the other from New York. The Saints have built a road from here to Salt Lake City - some 40 miles thus far, where three branches of the railway come together and are likely to make Ogden a very large town.

Minerals:

There aren't many mines or quarries here. Four or five coal mines and an ironworks have been opened, but they aren't too busy so far. I think that there is a silver mine in the area, but I am not sure. I believe that Utah Mountain is as valuable as any mountain in the world for any type of mineral. It only needs hard work and a bit of time to bring these into being.

Farming:

You can raise all sorts of wheat, corn, oats, barley, ??phug?? and every type of root vegetable – potatoes, carrots, rutabaga, ??mangls?? and they also grow cotton, silk, fruits, apples, plums, figs and raisins. I think that you can grow almost any sort of fruit or raise any animal if you choose the right season.

In the north, summers are quite hot but the winters cold. There is not much rain apart from the spring and at the end of the year and summer. There is usually quite a thickness of snow and ice on the ground. The west is quite different - no snow or ice and their summers are very hot and their winters quite mild. You can see that in Utah there are significant differences in the seasons in various parts - in the north gets about six months of really cold weather but not in the south.

The inhabitants:

Most of the inhabitants are Saints, but there are a few who live in the territory that are not Saints. Some 6 miles from Box Elder and again, some 6 miles from Salt Lake City there are settlements of soldiers. There is one other town at the mouth of Weber Canyon and perhaps a few other places, but I cannot recall.

The difference between the ways of the Saints and the others that come to Utah: In Salt Lake City, there are about twenty five thousand inhabitants. In the whole of the City there is no house of ill-repute to attract women nor an inn to attract drunks. Liquor is available from drug stores and similar places and perhaps there are a few that manage to get hold of too much at times, but that does not happen often.

I do not know the population figure for Logan, but I think that there are about 3,000 people here. I cannot recall when I last saw a drunk or heard that anybody else had seen one here.

In the city of the Saints there isn't much quarrelling or fighting. They are friendly towards strangers but these people often make up stories and lie about them after being shown great the kindness whilst in this territory. Some are grateful for the kindness but many aren't.

Every good man has the freedom to have two or three 3 wives if he has the means to keep, feed and clothe them comfortably. Perhaps that you think that it is impossible to keep two or more wives peacefully? The man whom I lived with when I first arrived in this country two wives and it was a long time before I figured out if they were wife and daughter or just two sisters (I could not judge their ages to allow me to figure that out). But everything was just as peaceful as if there was just the one wife.

Cities of those that aren't Saints:

One of the first things they establish are houses to sell alcoholic drinks and houses for bad women - and these are the very people who say they come here to put the Saints to rights, to bring them chastity and to save the Saints from their barbaric situation! So, here I have given you both sides of the story. Would you rather live with the Saints, in their sober and peaceful cities where love and unity are on the increase or would you prefer to live in a city where perhaps half of them are drunks who go around swearing, blaspheming, fighting, prostituting and sinking ever-deeper into evil deeds of all sorts year after year?

Richard and Margaret Thomas

Dear brother and sister

I was delighted to receive your kind letter - I was starting to think that you had forgotten about me or had died. A letter from my old home warms my heart.

Ann has written a few lines to you but I do not think that she has told you that Elizabeth has given birth to twins – a boy and a girl, but they did not live very long. You ask if I had married, well, I can answer that I have not married a living soul being except David Roberts and it is not at all likely that I will ever marry anyone else whilst I live on this earth.

We went to Salt Lake City January 19th, 1865 when Robert and Thomas were washed and anointed and I was sealed with David Roberts for Eternity in God's House. Perhaps somebody took this as the basis for their rumour but I can tell you it would be unreasonable for me to marry anyone else after my having been sealed forever with David.

If it were ever possible, I would be pleased to see you but we must accept things as they are. I would like to hear news about my old neighbours at Fedw, Hafod, Carreghylltrem, and of Morris Isaac (Parc) and Thomas (Cwm Trwsgwl). I was glad to hear that things are going so well in Wales and that you were well and comfortable. Things are pretty dead over here these days but I am quite well and am happy with my lot. I have plenty to eat and clothes to wear. The boys and Jane are home with me and the other two girls are both happy and well. However, Elizabeth has not been at all well these past couple of years.

I will await your letter if you feel inclined to write to me.

I remain your dearest sister
Catherine Roberts

P.S. Send my warmest regards to all my old neighbours.

Our Dear Sister

As soon as we had written to our parents a while back, the storm hit and little Hannah arrived. I am glad to inform you that both I and the little girl are coming along well. Robert was a bit disappointed as he had hoped for a little Hugh this time. Whatever, we are so glad of Hannah. The children are very happy with their little sister and always call her by her full name Hannah Roberts.

I enclose half a dozen newspapers in two bundles – I hope that they arrive safely.

I would love it if you could see our new house. The front garden is lovely and we also have a kitchen garden where everything grows really well – as they used to do in your old garden. The gardens are hugely important to Robert. Last year, Catherine Davies sent us a lot of apples that had grown on the apple tree in your old home - big green apples.

We don't have any interesting news for you.

Mother, Mary Jane, Lizzie and Maggie and also Hannah send you best regards and also to their grandparents and also to Uncle John.

Accept our warmest wishes. I hope that we will get a letter from you soon.

Your brother and sister

Robert and Elisabeth Roberts

Dear Dad and Mam

How happy we were to receive your letter and photographs! We were just so happy! Seeing you all look so well! We received your letter on 27th of March and despite it being a Sunday *{the Welsh were very strict about "keeping the Sabbath"}* we had a birthday celebration for Hannah and all the children were joyous.

Mary Jane, Lizzie and Maggie look at your photographs all the time.

We were glad to see little Huwcyn's *{Hugh's}* handwriting as we had heard that he had **died** around Christmas – although we did not believe it to be true.

That is why we implored you to write the last time.

It was Thomas Edward the joiner who brought us that rumour, but when he told us, Robert said that we would have definitely heard from you if that had happened. Thomas Edwards went away with his tail between his legs.

Robert was delighted to get the letters and went straight to Eglwysbach the next day to show them to everybody. Everybody who saw them could just about eat the photographs!

Catherine Williams (Cefn-y-Coed) is still alive but I did not see her. Owen Williams (shoe maker) buried his wife but has now married the daughter of William Thomas (formerly of Ty'n-y-Pistyll). Ann Davies (Tŷ Canol) was widowed a year ago. She stayed in Graig for three hours so that she would see the photos. We intend to send the photos to London to have other prints made from them, so that we can give copies to your old friends in Eglwysbach.

Jenny Evans still has had a pair of shoes that you made for her seven years ago. She keeps them in a cupboard. Betsan Wynne also has a pair of "best shoes" that you made for her. She is worried that she will have to keep them another seven years if it is not possible to persuade you to come over to make her another pair.

Owen Evans(?) and Mary Jones (Nant) and Ellin Davies and Catherine Davies and the Chwta(?) family, everybody we saw, send you their kind regards. Aunt ?? has been bed-bound for six months after having had a stroke. She does retain her senses fully however.

Mary Jane is sewing aprons at school. You would be surprised to see her sewing ability. She will be 7 years-old on 9th of June and Lizzie was 5 since 20th of February. Maggie will be 3 on the 9th of May.

If I could, I would get a step-ladder to reach up to John and kiss him on the cheek for the photos.

Not one of you looks much older than when you left. We will send you our photos as soon as we have the opportunity to have them taken. We will have to go to Bangor or Conwy for this as there is nobody locally that can do this.

This is Mary Jane's handwriting.

We do not have anything else to add, other than to send you our kindest regards.

We will expect a letter from you soon. We too will write soon. Tell our brothers and sisters, especially the brother and sister who have not left home that we send our best regards.

Your children.

From your children

Robert and Elisabeth Roberts

{in different handwriting} Mary Jane Roberts Post Office

Harlech
11th April, 1870

Dear Dad and Mam

We had awaited eagerly for your letter; we were delighted when it finally arrived and enjoyed seeing the photograph of the four of you. We too will do the same as soon as it is possible to have a photo taken and I will send it back to you.

I (Jane) am now much-recovered and Edward Humphreys is coming along well. He is quite tall 22" and Hannah is 23". She is two-years-old since the 1st of February and is now walking un-aided.

We can't recall if I have told you that I have been employed as a tax-collector by the parish for a year now. I am paid £15 a year for doing this. We have taken land to keep a cow for the summer. Economically, things are doing pretty well at the moment, but flour is cheap. Butter is 1/6 a pound and mutton 10d a pound and beef 8d a pound. Tea is quite cheap, costing between sixpence to a shilling a quarter – I expect that you are enjoying many a cup of tea over there.

We would like to hear more about our sisters who are there with you. It pains us to read what the newspapers say about you – that one man can take several wives.

Robert is at home, working with me; he will be 16 next June. May has been in school in Talsarnau these past 6 months; she will be 14 next Friday. Margaret is at home nursing Edward and little Hannah. She is 11 since December.

Humphrey attends school here but has learnt nothing in three years! He is 9 since last January. Jane Eliza is four since the 2nd of this month.

Our family in Dyffryn are healthy. We saw your sister Margaret last week and she said that her daughter Mary's husband was drowned last winter. She also buried a child last week. She still has three children.

We hope that you will not take so long in replying next time.

We send you our kindest regards
Jane and Edward Humphreys

P.S.

Here is a piece of satin which Mary sends to her grandmother.

21st September, 1871

Our dearest Dad and Mam

By now I am sure that you had thought that we were not going to write to you. I would have written earlier but we had waited for an opportunity to take the children to have their photographs taken.

Little Hannah, myself and Elisabeth will be going next week and we will post them to you when we get them. There are another four that we are waiting for. Can you just send us a word to say that they reached you safely?

We hope that you are all well – as we are at the moment.

Peter(?) was very ill for four months last winter with rheumatism and was in great pain for weeks. He also had an inflammation of his eye and was not seeing well at all; his eyes are still very weak and he has to wear dark glasses – coloured blue. He was so ill that we had begun to think that he was not going to improve but the Almighty saw fit to make him better and spare him for at least some time. He looks much older after this. He lost all his hair and the wig which he now wears, cost £3-10-0.

In the photo, it is Mary Jane, the eldest, that is sitting and Lizzie is standing on the right. Maggie is in the middle. We will send you a photo of Mary Jane standing and Lizzie sitting in the next photo.

Owen Jones (Nant, Eglwysbach) was here on a visit recently. Also, Ellis Davies (Hendy) brought a whole basketful of apples and plums. We see one of them quite often. We will go there to see them shortly to see how everyone is.

We have taken 12 photos from the card which you sent and shared them with everybody at Eglwysbach. They all send you their best regards.

Edward (husband of our sister Jane) and little Robert were here for a week. He is quite a lad.

The telegraph reached here four months ago but we are having a lot of trouble with it. We would love to be able to send you a note every day using this.

There have been lots of visitors around this summer.

Send us a few words when you receive this letter. My mother and everybody send you kindest regards.

Your son and daughter

Robert and Elisabeth Roberts

Dear Cousin

I received your letter two months ago and was glad to hear that you and family are well. I see that the branches of the family in Utah are fruitful and multiplying - and filling the place. (Some more so than others.) You are far busier than those of us who stayed on this side of the Atlantic. Some of us too have given birth to twins namely Eliza' of Erw Fawr.

Rhys had a son and daughter after re-marrying and Meurig also has had two sons. Mary has six or seven children and has just buried her second husband. Ellis and Gwen are unmarried.

I am sure that you have not heard that Ellen has been buried in Wisconsin, America. Her husband sent her Box (?) and clothes back home to the Erw. Despite being glad to receive them, this did add a lot to their grief. I recently heard from some of Aunt Ellen's family in America - all were quite well. Robert has married some Yank and has eight children. Kate has married and keeps a drug store and she has two daughters. John has married but he buried his wife and his only child, just a week apart. David keeps a saddlery shop and makes good business, staying at his parents'. Ebenezer the youngest was apprenticed as a Tinman and keeps his own shop about four miles from his parents' home. He was here on a visit about five years ago, for about a month. My uncle and aunt have buried William, Daniel and James Henry in America. The last was born after arriving in America. If you feel in your heart to write them a letter, I can assure you that they would be delighted to receive it.

We have had very mild winter but a cold spring; I can't recall such a spring and early summer when things were growing so slowly. The harvest will be very late this year and I'm afraid and it probably won't be a very good harvest.

Things remain flat here in the slate quarries. Wages are low but the market for slate is huge. There is a surplus of workers here, so we will not see much better times. We have though had the honour of having our weekly working hours cut – we now start at 6:00 on Saturdays and 7:30 on Mondays. This was given without anybody having to demand it. The general rule for workers in this country is to work nine hours a day, but amongst us quarrymen, there is no initiative, we just keep our heads down, work like fools and are just grateful for what we are given and there no protestations.

I would like to know about business matters in your country (not women's matters). Our mountains here are full of good slates – wouldn't you be better off here, rather than farming? Are wages in Utah good? Is there steady employment, or do people just go from job to job and just live hand-to-mouth? I want you to know that I don't disbelieve anything that you said about Utah and the Mormons. You did tell me quite a lot in your last letter – tell me more.

I hope that you will excuse me for taking so long to answer your letter. I hope to hear from you soon. I have received several copies of Deseret News from you and have responded by sending you copies of Welsh newspapers – I don't know if you received them.

My family are all well and quite comfortable. I hope to return to America before I die, I hope that have enough years left.

My wife and I send you our kindest regards. You will get our family photos as soon as I have been able to have them taken.

I am writing this in a bit of a hurry on a day when we were turned back from the quarry because of unusually bad weather.

Give my best regards to your mother, your two brothers and three sisters. If you see my other cousins, give them our regards as well.

Your cousin

Robert W. Roberts

Give my best regards to all my relatives. Write soon.

Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin

I have the following note in my diary " letter to R.D. Roberts June 4th 1872" but I have not heard a word from you since.

I received word from old Uncle Edward (formerly of Gelli) on October 8th saying that he would like to see me and our cousin Rees Roberts. He had left Gelli and gone to live in Penrhyn. We had not seen him in years but we went down two days later to see him (the 10th).

I was very surprised to see that he was in a very bad way- so ill, that really, I did not get more than a few words from him. He did recognise me though, and asked me a few things – that's all. Amongst the questions that he asked, one was, would I answer the letter which he had received from you, sometime at the start of February. He seemed to be very anxious to say something if he could, but only managed to grip my hand very tightly. I really felt bad.

He had been sent to such a poor and ignoble corner to die – but, this was all of his making. He had failed to pay his rent for quite some time and so, you see, he had to leave. My Uncle Robert Roberts (Erw Fawr) offered to make him a home at the Erw, but he refused flatly. Hence there was nothing to do but plan to move to the Pant in Penrhyn where he would be solely dependent on the charity of the parish. *{Pant was a very poor area in Penrhyn. A neighbour of ours is from the town and remembers the area as "slum housing" – for the lowest of the low.}* But his time there was not to be long.

The spinster who was his house-keeper thinks that he died from heartbreak after leaving the Gelli, but the doctor put down 'inflammation of the lungs' on his certificate.

Be that as it may, we played our part in making his funeral as respectable as possible. Between myself, my cousin and Uncle Robert, we paid for his coffin, the preparation of the grave and all funeral expenses. As I understand it, the spinster got all his belongings in lieu of wages for the time that she had been serving on him. She had been with him for years and I don't think that that she was paid more than a pittance for her efforts. This did not amount to very much.

{end of page – it seems that he delayed completing the letter}

My dearest cousin, I was very pleased to understand that you are all alive there, but I am sorry to hear that you yourself have been ill. Wouldn't it be better for you to come back to Wales for a while to see if that would do you any good? Improved travelling facilities are enough to tempt one, but it is true that the cost is too much for many.

My family are all well. Oh! How good it would be to see you again - Thomas, Daniel, Anne, Jane Eliza and my dear Aunt, yes, and the other two aunts, and their children as well (I have almost lost all recollection of them), the children of Uncle John, Eliza and William D. Roberts – I can only remember the name of one of Uncle Daniel's children, Catherine and her curly head! Tell Thomas that I have your family photographs – but not one of him.

Would it be possible to receive photographs of the other cousins?

You will get a good long letter from me if you reply to this one. My warmest regards to you and your wife, your brothers and sisters.

Your Cousin

Robert W. Roberts

Robert D. Roberts

Dear, Kind Nephew and relatives

I received your kind letter on the 10th of this month. It brought me great happiness and pleasure to read a little about my dear relatives and to understand that you were comfortable and well.

I too am being allowed to stay alive and being given enough mercy to carry me to my journey's end – which in the order of things, will not be too far off. "Oh! to inherit a Better World!" I have been able to outlive most of my relatives, but this causes much sorrow and feelings of loss.

It is likely that I have told you before how many of us remain alive – namely my children, Robert E Humphreys, (his address is Poultney, Vt.) He is five miles north of me here. He too lost his first wife – the mother of 8 or 10 children but he has now remarried. There are no children from this marriage.

My oldest son is married and lives in the western part of this state. He is a printer. Robert owns the weekly newspaper Poultney Journal and has a printing office and employs 4 or 5 men. His second son is the supervisor there. They make a good living. The second of my children and my only daughter, is Kattie. She lives close to me and I eat my meals with her although I live in my own house. In my house, two rooms are my own, and I rent the rest out to Kattie's married daughter (her youngest daughter). The eldest daughter is also married; her husband is an American, but the other's husband is Welsh.

The eldest daughter lives in Rutland, Vt about 25 miles north of here. Her husband is a storekeeper and does good business. Kattie's husband is also a storekeeper and runs a post office in this town. He too is doing well.

Well, I just have one more child to tell you about – Daniel J. Humphrey, Hoosick Falls, NY is his address. He lives about 45 miles south of here. He is married to an American girl. They have one five-year-old daughter but have buried a four-year-old son. He is a heumis(??) maker and has his own store.

That is all of the children that are still alive – just 3 living out of 9. I really feel the loss when I look back at the large family that I once had. But one must bend to the will of the One who is too wise not to do everything in the best way possible. It is our duty to obey Him and to worship Him. There is no situation that we shall ever face where it could not be very much worse for us. We have the honour and duty to live according to His Word and leave it up to His honour to do as He sees fit. He never does an injustice to any man.

With regards to you and all my relatives, I would be pleased to learn about what has been going on. Where are you all now? How many of your father's family are still living? What is their occupation? Also the families of Daniel and John?

I heard from John's wife a while back and I replied, but I have since lost her address. If you know anything about them, I would be pleased to hear it. Daniel's family in the same. Who is still alive, where do they live and how are they?

A word from my dear relatives would be very warmly received as I am lonely here in my old age. News from afar is like cool water to a thirsty soul.

I have seen that your cousin Rees Roberts lost his wife (around last March). I have not heard from him in a long while. We used to write to one another regularly. You may still hear from some of our relatives.

As regards the picture of the Temple that you sent, it is excellent. We are proud and thankful for it and hope that the Holy Presence will fill it as in Solomon's Temple long ago.

To finish this short letter, I send my kindest regards to you all. Firstly, to you my nephew but also to all my dear relatives. If dear Sister Catherine Thomas of Creuau is still alive, I send her all my love.

I would be delighted to be able to speak to you all. Can you still speak the old Welsh language I wonder? All of my children speak it as if they had just arrived from Wales.

I must finish, but look forward to hearing from you soon.

John W. Humphrey

Logan City
16th December, 1884

Dear Nephew

After a three-month delay, I am now taking this opportunity to write to you from the country of the Far west as we used to say in the Old Country years ago. So much has changed since then, as travelling is now so much easier, more comfortable and faster and one can chat to one another whilst travelling. This brings more places within reach.

Now for a few excuses. When I received your letter, rather than reply immediately, I decided to wait a while, but then, before I could start writing, I went to work to Beaver Canyon on the section which is 260 miles away from here – on the branch of railroad that is going to Idaho and Montana – "The Utah & Northern Railroad". I was working on the first section and making \$1-70 a day and paying \$5.00 a week for food. So, you see that I did not have much left over.

It has been very poor here for quite some time now – no work of any sort to be had anywhere. Farming the land does not bring much profit to the worker – only enough to live on. There is no value to anything that the land produces at the moment.

My dear nephew, I am very thankful to you for your generosity in writing to me. Since I said in my last letter what I thought was best for you to do I won't add that it would great to see you and all the family, brothers and sisters but I do think that this is the best place, especially if you want to serve God. This is my opinion. I will not add to this at the moment but I will turn to Evan.

In the kindest way
I remain your uncle
R.D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

I was delighted to hear from you. I am very grateful to you for noting everything in such detail.

As I read your letter Robert, I could see that times have changed for you and that you have suffered bitter experiences. I was very sad to hear that you had lost your dear wife; from your letter I gather that things are much the same there as they are here with death roaming through the family and taking our loved ones away. I have buried two of my children – Robert Wilfred(?) Roberts and Elizabeth Ann Roberts.

I have four remaining children - Jane M. Roberts, William J. Roberts , Martha Samantha(?) Roberts, Laura E. Roberts. My home(?) is a poor place as I write this letter but the family have been fairly healthy this winter. But I should not complain as we have plenty for our needs and I trust that we are making good preparations for the Life Hereafter which we will spend in Heaven.

In Bangor (America) there are two Welsh chapels- one Calvinistic Methodist and the other Independent and they are both flourishing. I and my family have been (not the best) members of the Methodist chapel since it was established. So you can imagine, there is quite a gap between our beliefs and those of the Mormons. I can tell you from the bottom of my heart that I do not feel any animosity towards Mormons as individuals, definitely not, and I respect the fact that there are in their midst very wise men, but about your ideas and principles, I believe that they are things to put aside. In a time when the practice of having multiple wives exists in your area, I am disgusted at them in light of my Bible's teachings. It is a shame that educated men lower themselves to such depths.

It was very good to read in your letter that after your wife's death left your children orphans that you remain a widower with your old mother looking after you. I feel very grateful that you are so kind and tender towards my old Aunt Catherine of Llwyn-y-Gell (as I used to know her).

Tell her that Gwen Lewis died last March. Her daughter Catherine lives here. Her son Lewis is in Vermont and his sister Ellen. You will well-remember them I am sure.

Oh, yes, I left the subject of having multiple wives. Your letter left me with a good impression that my old family was once again pure and free from the idea of having more than one wife at a time. That is how God taught us and how He set out His laws. The best advice that I can give, is to keep clear of any false prophets and trust in Jesus Christ as Lord and Saviour, with no need for anyone else as a go between. There is only one God and He gave us Jesus Christ, put between man and God, and everyone who believes in Him will have Eternal Life.

Several of my wife's family, her uncle's name is Hugh ?T. Roberts, I believe came there at the same time as you did. He is from Harlech and his daughter still lives there. The daughter of William Griffiths (printer in Dolgellau) is my ...?.... Her mother was the sister of Hugh Roberts who is over there. Her parents and all her family are dead; she is the only one of the family still living.

Well Robert, what next? Don't you fancy going over to Wales? If you do decide to travel, it would be good to have you come visit us whilst passing; we are not 80 miles from New York. It would be great to see some of you.

I hope that you will not feel bad towards me for taking the liberty of stating my opinion about Mormonism.

I hope to hear from you soon – and from Thomas and Daniel (they can write in Welsh or in English).

If health-permits and I have the opportunity I will send you a family photograph soon.

Best regards

Your cousin

Evan W. Roberts

1931-1934

Glan-y-Pwll Cottage, Rhiwbryfdir, Blaenau Ffestiniog

13th February, 1885

Dear Cousin

I was delighted to receive your letter as so many years had passed without my hearing from you. I was glad to learn that you and all your family are well. Since you have so many questions for me to answer, I should get on with it straight away with little more formalities - or the paper will run out!

My son, Robert, emigrated to America almost a year ago. He is a doctor - quite talented but he was also somewhat lazy and thoughtless and considered that I should 'keep' him. So I decided that the best thing to do was to allow him to do as he wished and leave, so that he could fight his way through life, as I did – and he is getting on well and has been very lucky.

I now have three sons and one daughter at home with me. The eldest is 14 years old and the youngest 8. They are all excellent learners but I have no mother for them and this makes life difficult. But fortunately, Providence has been kind to me and given me everything that I need made sure that I will never be in need of anything.

I have been employed by the Oakeley Quarry Co. since Mr Holland's lease came to an end seven years ago; I was with him for the previous 15 years. Things are not good in the quarry these days though, and there are no real signs that commerce is going to improve.

If you were to come to Blaenau now I am sure that you would think that you had come to some foreign land – such are the changes here. No fewer than three railways operate from here now. A tunnel under the mountain to Dolwyddelan brings one track in, another track comes over the Migneint from Bala and the third track comes from Porthmadog. The old Glan-y-Pwll yard is now a station.

The son and daughter of my sister Mary have gone to America and the daughter has got married. The old Llety building is now just a ruin. My mother is quite well but old and frail. She was really pleased to hear that your mother inquired about her, and wishes to be remembered to her and all the rest of you.

William Williams Creuau), Charles(?) Roberts (Carreg Alldrem), Ellen Jones (wife of Richard Jones the blacksmith), Mary Griffith (Bwlch Llindir), Dafydd Williams (Cwm Bowydd) all died some twenty years ago. As did Thomas Jones (Rhosydd), old Williams and Chesel (?) Welsh Slate, Mr Greaves and many more.

Richard Jones the blacksmith still looks much the same. Robert Roberts is a fellow-official with me under the trading name Dafydd Roberts & Co. working here and looking good. He has one son.

Aunt Margaret is well but very frail but she does manage go out. She now lives in Glan-y-Pwll Bach.

Our cousin Robert lives in New Market Square, Blaenau.

In Blaenau, the area from Rhiw all the way down to Congl-y-Wal is now built up – one long as a long street. Every building and street have been given a new name - I find it difficult to find my way around (but I am not one that gets around much anyway).

Jason Thomas died about two years ago and Robert Rhys died quite a while back.

There are still old family members living in Fedw - that is the daughter of one of the old ladies who lived there. She married somebody that I would describe as a cross between a man and a devil!

The old family left Hafod many years ago, but John Roberts is alive and has built a new home close to Garreg. He too has grown old and frail.

The same family live at Ynysfawr – namely the eldest son. His sister lives close to Pwllheli. The other brother and sister died a while back along with their father.

The Park family have all passed away, the only living daughter lives in Cwm Bowydd, having married Lewis Thomas's son.

Nelly Robert died years ago. Her sister Laura lives in the Gatehouse leading to Ynysfawr. That place has been turned into something of a palace by Mr Jones. He is the chairman of the Penrhyn Magistrates.

Mr Holland is still alive and well and living near Barmouth, aged 83.

Meurig has been managing a quarry near Towyn for quite a few years. He has a wife and, I think, eight children.

Ellis is a bachelor and lives here with me. He fractured his arm three weeks ago. He refused to take up farming after my father died although I offered to take on the farm so that my mother would have a home. But I had to find her a home with my brother William. He offered her rooms in his house.

William lives in Penrhyn and works in the quarry. He is married and has lots of children.

Elizabeth lives in Glan-y-Wern, close to Garreg, in a small farm. Her husband is from Caernarfonshire. There are loads of children there.

My sister Gwen, the youngest of us all, died, leaving three children, three years ago.

Thirty years have brought major changes – far too many for you to comprehend from reading a letter. Young children at that time are now middle-aged and the elderly have moved on to the cemetery. This area has seen more change than any I can tell you.

Welsh Slate, Gloddfa Ganol and Holland quarries have all merged in to one huge quarry - from Talywaenydd to the top of Allt Fawr. But a few years back there was a major 'fall' in the quarry which fractured the mountain causing untold damage and huge expense.

The buildings in town are so numerous that it is impossible for me to begin to name them all. There are six schools in Blaenau and every one accepts from 400 to 600 children. There are 20 to 30 chapels belonging to the various denominations. The population of the parish is about twelve thousand. The Valuation for the Poor Rate is £70,000 with the Poor Rate set at 2/4 in the £ and the Local Board charging 9d at the moment.

There is a Market Hall by the new church with an Assembly Room above it and this can accommodate 1,500 to 2,000 and is often crowded when meetings are held there.

There are lots of shops and hotels – far too numerous to list.

The town is a nice place to live in and has all the facilities that one would need. Alcohol is not a problem here and the townspeople are pretty law-abiding and honest people. It is a very Radical town - nobody apart from a Liberal would dare to turn up here! The people remain religious and always speak out when there is any wrong-doing.

Well, I am coming to the end of my paper, so I must finish by wishing you all well. My mother, my brothers and all my friends wish you every success. We look forward to hearing from you again soon. Perhaps I can compose a better letter the next time.

Best regards

Your cousin,

Rees Roberts

Bangor, Pa.
22nd May, 1885

Dear Uncle

After a long delay I take the greatest pleasure in sending you a bit of news about me in reply to the letter which I received several months ago.

The first thing that I am going to do is seek your forgiveness for taking so long to reply. But the blame is not solely mine, as I waited because you had written to both myself and to my Uncle Evan and he wanted to reply to you and wanted me to wait until after he had written before I replied. April came and went but eventually he did write, but even then he forgot to bring the letter down to me to post. He lives in ...?...Tavern(?) namely (?)Great East(?) and I don not live there with him. Eventually I went up to collect the letter and visit my aunt.

Evan got a son after he wrote and the baby is doing well. Aunt is getting better. Things here in our community are pretty flat, wages are very low and there is much unemployment.

Few came over from the Old Country this spring and they are wise not to do so. Evan, myself and two others have taken the lease of a quarry but thus far have not profited at al from it but we hope to make a little money this month.

I got a letter from the Old Country the other week and they are all well. Things are pretty flat there as well, with the wheels of commerce turning very slowly, and if the war between England and Russia goes on things will be terrible over there.

That is all that I have to say so I will now finish by asking you to write as soon as you can and not repay me by doing as I did, although I well deserve it.

I am

Your Nephew

R.M. Parry

Dear Cousin and Family

Thank you for kind letter. I had intended to write much sooner, but had hoped to gather some information about the family of David Eames for you. I gave your letter to the son of Gwen (his sister) who works with me, to see if he could give you any information. However, very few members of the family remain around here now as far as we can surmise – perhaps two sisters and their children. I attach a little that Ephraim Jones wrote (Gwen's son) and he promises to find out more for me.

I knew David Eames well and I am sorry to hear that he is no longer in this world. He was always courteous, kind and friendly. Did he leave family members behind?

I don't have much interesting news for you, commerce remains pretty flat in all areas and we have had a very hard winter - snow and ice these past three months. It is said that about 20,000 sheep have been lost as a result of this, at a huge cost to farmers. The price of animals is very low and rents and taxes high.

The slate market is very slow and many are out of work, although salaries are not so bad that one could complain too much. Quarry men earn, on average, five shillings a day and the surprising thing is that the quarry owners are so tolerant of this situation.

There have been more changes than you could ever imagine in the quarries and in the town itself. It seems that there is just one big quarry from Talywaenydd to the top of Allt Fawr. It has been worked to such an extent that, in several places now, you can walk through the mountain into Cwmorthin. The slate though is of much poorer quality than in your day, with faults ruining many rocks. If we did not have powered engines, the produce would not be worth very much.

The town has improved a lot - you would be amazed to see the boggy ground at Glan-y-Pwll now covered in railway carriages and trucks. Go on a bit to Dolgarregddu and you would see the same again there. The London & North Western Railway is in Glan-y-Pwll and the Great Western and Ffestiniog Railways are in Dolgarregddu. Houses have been built in every nook and cranny as well as shops, hotels and chapels. Somebody coming back after having been away for years would be lost. Despite the growth in the town, the behaviour of the population remains good and they are to be praised. There is not much drinking or such like here.

I can't think of any interesting news about anybody that you would have known I'm afraid.

There are only about eight or ten people in old Holland's Quarry who were there when I started working there, over 40 years ago. Similarly, here in Gloddfa Ganol quarry. I don't think that you would even know six people if you came back here now - "One generation leaves, another comes along".

David Roberts works here and is looking good. He has a boy working with him. The Llanfrothen family are much the same. You would be surprised to see Creuau with none of the old family there now. So too Carreg Alldrem and Erw Fawr and many other places.

My mother is still alive, but is getting on in years; she still remains fairly healthy. Also, Margaret Roberts (Glanypwll bach) but she is becoming very frail these past couple of years.

R.W. Roberts and family are well.

Evan is in America and Betsan is long-buried.

My sister Mary is a widow, but not doing too badly. Her youngest son is about 18 years old and works in the quarry. She has two daughters at home and a son and daughter, both in America.

Elizabeth and family are well and living in Llanfrothen.

Ellis lives here with me – a perfect bachelor!

William and family live in Penrhyn and are quite well and living comfortably.

My son is very clever and working in America as a doctor – in ??Rutland?? County. I also have three sons at home and also a daughter who still at school and doing really well. Despite having four children at home I often feel quite lonely, although my situation is comfortable - but I should not complain about God's Providence – I always say that complaining without good reason is a sin.

I had thought about sending you a photograph of myself and the children but unfortunately, I have not had the opportunity to have a group photo taken. I will do so soon.

In finishing, I can only send my regards to you and your family also to the family of my uncles Daniel and John. Are they well? I have not heard about them in years.

I remain your faithful cousin
Rees Roberts

2nd November, 1887{?}

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

Several months have passed since I last wrote – not for any lack of thinking about you or any carelessness, but I have been very busy all summer. I often feel that there should be two or three of me not just one so that I can manage to do everything at the same time. I am not trying to do everything just to make money, just that I feel that I cannot cope. You know as well as I do how much work is needed to raise children and how expensive it is. But our children are beginning to reach the age when they can help out. The eldest daughter stays in New York with a well-off family. She is in a good place. My son worked all summer and now attends school. The other children are coming along well.

Oh, Yes! Whilst I remember, Mr. Willi Williams (of the mail stable) sends you his best regards. He used to work with you in Gloddfa Ganol quarry *{in Blaenau}* – he comes from Harlech.

The slate quarries here are working well but wages are low.

Hywel, the son of blacksmith Dafydd Roland often inquires about you as a family. Edward Foulkes (son of Wil Foulkes formerly of Rhiw, Blaenau) also wishes to be remembered to you. Joseph Jones lives close to us. "Joe bach del" and his brother John, are the sons of William Richard (Dolgarregddu). Many, many people inquire about you – far too many to list or to recall names.

I am sure that you hear from my brother and my cousin Rees in Wales. Last week, Robert M. Parry said that he had received word that Ellis Roberts of Erw Fawr had set off from Wales for Washington Territory – I don't know if he has arrived there yet. He is accompanied by Lewis Roberts, the son of Evan Roberts (Llwyn-y-Gell) and some family from Glan-y-Pwll.

As you can see, I am including a newspaper cutting in this envelope at the request of R.M. Parry. I forward it to you - you can see what they are after, funds for a new organ for the chapel. They are writing to Welshmen all over the world asking for financial contributions to reach their goal. They hope that you will not think this presumptuous.

I remain and send you best wishes

Evan W. Roberts

Again it is likely that he will get real dd... ? next spring. The committee have met with me and asked how much I was willing to donate towards building the house. I said \$50. Well, that will do pretty well to begin with. From the way they were speaking, I could guess that they expected to get another \$50 or more before the end.

There are a lot of collections going on here at the moment and of late, in order to defend themselves in the Congress and the various courts in this territory. This is how I understand that there is enough room for me to support the cause that is under such oppression and under so many disadvantages. I have contributed some hundreds, if not thousands of dollars since I was in Utah towards one cause or another. It would be a huge pleasure to assist you too but at the moment I don't have much money. And I see that many are asking for contributions from me. I have lost my good health these past 20 years. I am not very strong due to rheumatism which is a big worry and means that I am not always able to work. But I have been a bit better these past three years.

{continues on back of this sheet}

Friendly towards Robert M. Parry. I am pleased to understand that you are attempting to serve God. There is nothing better for a man than to receive personal evidence that he has understood the plan and order that God laid down for man's salvation. If man does not get evidence of the reality of the order then he will be in doubt and ignorance and there will be no certainty. But if he receives from the sacred priesthood and the Holy Spirit comes to rest upon him and light up his mind and open his eyes and understanding get full happiness this is how I hope that you are as you read this letter.

It made me think like this.

Has God changed or not in the time of Jesus Christ? There was only one way to serve him. Are there more ways by now or not? There are many differences between my cousin and myself in the way in which we try to serve. I know what I know and he knows what he knows. Everybody is responsible for their own actions. For that reason, be quiet and go away.

In the kindest way, your cousin
Robert D. Roberts

P.S.

I sent my wife's note to you. Hugh Roberts

1978-1979

Logan County
29th December, 1889

Dear Cousin Evan Roberts and Family

I got your letter around the start of this month. Thank you, I had not heard from Wales in about two years.

We are all well here and nothing much has changed since I last wrote to you. Therefore, I do not have anything much to tell you in terms of family news.

I am enclosing a photo of Hugh and Mary Roberts - but I expect you to return this to me. This was taken about eighteen years ago. I encouraged them to have their photo taken before they moved to Bear Lake Valley but they did not want to do so. They are now old and frail. I thought that you would be glad to see the photograph and so I am posting this to you. This photograph belongs to one of the children so I hope that you will return it after having a good look at it. I believe that they are fit and well at the moment.

About the assistance that you wanted in order to ????

I was called one ...???... collecting money to get a new organ for this Ward. This City is being split into seven districts or seven bishoprics. I lived in the Third District when we came here to establish this place, 28 years ago. There were no houses or anything here then, but from around 1862 we built a schoolhouse and we used to worship there, up until now. But this place is going out ...???

David Roberts – to - Robert D. Roberts

Dear Friend,

It was a huge surprise to see your brother, Thomas D. Roberts turn up here a month back. But it was tears of joy and not surprise. It's certain that there is no other person from that side of the ocean that I would be so pleased to see - that is of course, unless I saw you. I have a child-like longing *{hiraeth}* for you still - although I have not written to you in years.

Thomas recognized me straight away - from my voice apparently. I only had about three hours' time with him whilst he was here for a few days, but I hope to have much more time with him before he returns. I look forward to taking him to those places where we used to play and work back in the day; places where we had so much fun as children.

It was good to hear about Daniel and your two sisters, and of course, about your dear old elderly mother and yourself. Although you are now well, you have suffered great loss and have been in pits of despair, but you are still alive and prospering. Give everybody my very best regards- especially your highly-respected mother. I cannot go into detail about everything that goes through my mind – a wealth of fond memories, but I do not have the words to describe them.

If I have not misunderstood what Tom said, I understand that Dafydd Peters and his wife Lowry (of the watermill at Rhydsarn) are still alive. If so, please convey my sincerest good wishes to the elderly couple. I have enjoyed many of Lowry's tasty honey-and-treacle sandwiches as a reward for carrying milk down from Llechddu farm to the factory in order to feed their daughter, Sarah. Tell them that 'Dafydd Llechdu' sends his regards – the grandson of old Lowri Lewis (Llechddu). If you have their address please send it on to me before they pass away – they were a very kind-hearted family.

And Robert, wouldn't it be great if you could come over to the Old Country once more? I really think that you should; as I understand it, you are now a widower.

I have a wife and four children, the oldest is 24 years old and the youngest 13 - two girls and two boys.

I will not write more this time, but wait until I get a letter back from you.

With my sincerest good wishes,

Your faithful friend

David Roberts

P.S.

My father died ten years ago

Dear Cousin

Well...I finally received a letter from you - after many years waiting.

I was delighted to meet your brother Thomas and learnt that you were quite well and comfortably off, so we have reason to be thankful. Things are fairly good for us as a family as well.

Well, what shall I write that will be of interest? You will have heard of my mother's death on January 7th, 1892. (My father also died in the month of March, but 15 years earlier).

I was pleased to hear that that your mother was strong and healthy. All of the old Llety family have by now 'gone to rest from their labour', leaving behind only their sons and daughters.

Well, I finished working in the quarry six years ago having worked hard all my life. I am glad to say that I receive £100 as a pension. My eldest son is an engineer working on a ship these past 18 months, not setting foot in this country, but he will return in October. He will soon be sitting the Chief Engineer exam and now earns £8 per month and his keep but will be much better off if he passes the exam. My second son is a pharmacist in Bangor and doing well. My third is in Liverpool preparing for the civil service exam – he will be lucky to pass. My daughter is aged twenty, and is in Dublin.

Well! I have re-married – a widow with five children. Quite a handful don't you think! But I have been lucky. One boy is a clerk in the bank, another is training to be a pharmacist, and the other three preparing for their future. And we have a two-and-a-half-year-old daughter together. If such a thing is possible, she is even better than my other daughter.

Ellis has been living in Shelton Mason County, Washington for a few years now.

Meurig is in Abergynlowyn, working as an quarry agent. He has a large family and is quite content.

My sister is a widow and has two daughters living at home. One is in service and the other is a school mistress. The third is married and living happily. The eldest son has been living in Pennsylvania for years.

Ellen died in America.

Elizabeth lives in Llanfrothen and has a large family.

William lives in Penrhyn and has a family and works in the quarry.

The old Llanfrothen family has almost gone now – very few of the ones whom you knew when you visited Llanfrothen are still there. Much the same can be said about Ffestiniog, few of your old friends remain. The place has changed out of all recognition.

I don't know where your brother Tom is by now – somewhere in South Wales.

Commerce in this country has been pretty poor for a few years now, but we shouldn't complain, but rather, give thanks, as we get much better than we deserve.

This year we had a very hard winter and the harshest spring in years.

I am hurrying now so that I can catch the post. Best regards to you, your mother, your daughter and all my acquaintances there. Also, I would appreciate receiving your next letter a bit sooner than the last time.

R.W Roberts and family are well and live quite close to us in a good house which he owns outright. His old mother looks well too.

Remember that your few acquaintances that are left here, will be asking about you.

Kind regards

Your cousin

Rees Roberts

1901-1903

Bangor, Pa.
16nd January, 1893

My Dear Cousin

Your letter arrived along with your dear mother's Remembrance Card and a picture of the Temple from(?) Hugh T(?) Roberts, my wife's uncle. Many thanks.

Your mother had had a long life on this earth and saw many difficult times on her journey through this world. I hope that she has gone to rest in the arms of the Great Saviour. She spoke to Him often in this world, so when the Call came, there was nothing to be done other than enter his Everlasting Peace.

I am glad to hear that you have buried her next to your father (although there is nothing unique in that) but again, there is some subconscious feeling that the family is again reunited in the same patch of earth. Such feelings are expressed very early on in the Old Testament. I can only thank you as a family for putting your mother's body to lie next to your father's.

Is there a general cemetery there? If so, what is it called? Just in case I can come visit any time – or one of my family members. It would be a good feeling to visit that place where my dear relatives are resting, or give others instructions to find the place.

Robert M. Parry lives quite close to me. He got married some time back and now has two young children; the eldest is a son he got a daughter this morning (13th Jan, 1893). They are doing well.

I have not heard from Wales since the start of last summer. My mother is well but is becoming frail.

That old gentleman Griffith Robert Ellis (Dolwyddelan) who used to work in Gloddfa Ganol quarry when you were there was buried here last autumn. Edward Foulkes is here and has a large family so too Howell Roberts Rowlands (son of Dafydd Rowlands the blacksmith), you may also recall William Pritchard (Dolgarregddu) – brother of JCO Richard). His son, John, died here in the madhouse a while back. William Williams (Wil Stabal Mellt we used to call him in Wales) and the other lads here send you their best regards.

As I write this, my wife is writing a letter to Harlech to her cousin; we have not heard from them in a long time.

When is your brother Thomas returning? I would like to know so that we can arrange to meet. I intend to go to New York to meet him so that he is not inconvenienced and loses his ..?... on returning.

We are all well as a family and send you our warmest regards

Your Cousin

Evan W Roberts

Mr Robert Roberts

Dear Cousin

After a long delay, I am at last putting pen to paper to answer your letter which I received at the start of May. I am sorry that I did not write sooner following the death of our cousin Rees Roberts.

I miss him because he was my only relative on your father's side who still lived in this area. Professionally, he was in a situation where he could have been of considerable assistance to me - but he did not see fit to do more than the minimum. He worked as a quarry supervisor for old Holland for 20 years. We all have stories to tell about unjust supervisors don't we, but he wasn't one of those. He had a quite a good reputation amongst the workers generally.

He was put out to pasture a few years ago, but continued as a pensioner; they say that he got £100 a year in pension from them. He had gathered quite a fortune by putting money aside during his working career but he spent a lot of it on his eldest son - trying to make a doctor out of him, but to no avail. Similarly, he spent a lot on his daughter, but again to no avail. She is currently cleaning floors and black-leading! *{black-leading was polishing cast iron fireplaces and hearths}* His third son, Rees is trying to become a pharmacist, but he too has failed two recent exams.

Daniel, his youngest son is an apprentice mariner. He has another year before he completes his training and sits the Mate's exam and later a Captain's exam. If a boy or girl excels at their studies, there is plenty of room for them at the top - but many more people have to slot into the lower tiers.

I see that I have somewhat left my intended topic. Here's my excuse, I went to see Rees's wife to ask what had happened during his illness and she promised ...?... But I will let that promise pass and I will you give you all the details of Rees's death.

He was suffering from?...tula which had started three years before, but he had dismissed it and did not go to get medication and things went from bad to worse. He was getting out of bed, but it was clear that something had gripped his constitution and taken its toll on his spirit and on his complexion. The end came quite quickly – he was in bed less than a week.

It was at that time that he received your letter. He was unable to read it and said that it should be passed on to me. I am ashamed that none of the children answered that letter. He had a Private funeral with just a few family members present. He was buried in Bethesda cemetery, in the same grave as his son Gruffydd.

He died without having made a will. I fear that his children will have to be dependent on the wife's compassion, but she is one of the wisest, most careful and quietest women. She had a good education and taken advantage of every opportunity. She was born October 24th, 1842 - so she is 54 years old this year. She was born in Betws-y-Coed. Her family are from the Eglwysbach area of Denbighshire. A cousin of hers emigrated to the Salt Lake - a girl who was reared as an orphan, 40 years ago – was she perhaps your first wife? I cannot remember names – her father was called Roger and he came from Flintshire. He was English on his father's side. I cannot remember what else she said – my memory is failing (it was never good).

I began this letter a month ago but let it ride, but here goes again, I will try to continue. But I feel a bit reluctant to re-start as I have been so remiss about writing.

I was sad to hear that you had been injured and were feeling weak and worried as a result of the injuries that you sustained in your fall. I hope that you are better by now and feeling as good as ever. In the Bible, Job says "Man's days are full of sorrows".

I am not going to enter into any discussion about the teachings of the Saints in the Salt Lake as I do not have a good thing to say about them or false religions. I am surprised that you followed such a foolish teaching but I do not doubt that you moved to a country where you are much better off materially rather than if you had stayed here.

I received several newspapers from Thomas and am grateful to him for them. In one of them, I read about your giving a report after returning from your mission to some of the Southern States.

I would be very glad if the children of my Uncle John and Uncle Daniel could send me their photographs. I have some recollection about how Elizabeth and William Daniel Roberts looked, but I can only recall Catherine, from my Uncle Daniel's children.

God willing, I will send you a photograph of us as a family. My youngest daughter has gone to college in Swansea for two years, God willing. Her name is Mary Ceridwen Roberts (aged 18, birthday 27th June); she won a Queen's Scholarship (First Class) of £100. The other two have each had two years college. My second daughter has now been given charge of a school here earning a salary of £85 a year. Elizabeth Alice has not yet been given charge of a school – she is an Assistant and gets £60 a year. I worked hard to give them a good education, hoping that they would benefit from it, so long as they also are of good character.

I am still working hard and generally fit and well, but I am starting to feel my age with my limbs not being as flexible as they used to be. I would like to rest, but that does not look likely.

I read in the last newspaper that you had a successful eisteddfod in Denver, Colorado. Apparently, the Great Salt Lake Choir excelled. Well done Saints! But it is not true that nothing good came from Nazareth.

I also understand that you have got a second wife – an Irish woman. She may make you a good wife – being a Papist converted into a Mormon. I hope that she is a wise and virtuous woman – they are Celts and of the same blood as the old Welsh. I would like to address her in English tongue *"I wish you a happy and a long life to live together and rear a lot of children whom will fight their own battles in this sinful world with ease and success. I hope my cousin in law Mrs Roberts will pardon me from these untidy lines addressing her."* Pardon my disorder, I would like to be able to write better English, but words fail me as I have little practice speaking English.

I would like to see you all and your country too, but it is too late and old age has crept up on us.

Your old acquaintances have long gone from Blaenau, newcomers fill the district these days. There are so many changes in the town and in the quarries, which have hollowed out these mountains. Business is booming for slate but wages remain low, despite all efforts. Supply is greater than demand and so we can only hope that the demand increases to kill the supply. That is the only way things will get better for us.

I guess that I should end it here lest I burden you by going on and on. If you wish to write to me, I will reply. I love getting some family news every now and then.

I cannot remember anything special to add. I am sure that you have heard that Hugh Gwilym has died.

I and my family are well and send you all our best regards - Tom and his wife, Dan and his wife and children.

The walking stick which Tom brought back to you was grown in my garden; I hope that you enjoy walking with it in your hand.

I have had to re-start this letter two or three times. I have just put it to one side. I began it in May but did not finish it until September! Please, please, excuse my failings, dear cousin and do not follow my example of laziness and delay.

We had a nice summer but it has been raining this last month.

I am, your cousin
Robert Roberts

Mr R.D. Roberts

Dear Cousin

After a long delay, here I am trying to acknowledge receipt of the photographs which show such a large portion of my family. I was delighted to see my aunt and her husband in the photo - looking so good. I think that she has put on some weight since leaving Wales. Also, her husband looks a really nice gentleman and they look very happy and contented. Great! I hope that they have every success and blessing. I can remember one particular occasion, when she was a maid at the Hafod; she stole a bag of red gooseberries and brought it to us children at Tan Lan. So much has changed in almost fifty years! I hope that she has a long and happy life to the end of her days.

Next comes my cousin W.D. Roberts. Seeing the photo of him really reminded me of his father. Doesn't he look just like him? He has lovely looking young children.

Elizabeth (Mr & Mrs Shippley) – I assume that her husband is an Englishman (at least his name suggests that to me). I am delighted to see them too and their children.

I see that I am mistaken, Robert E. Roberts and aunt was the one I last received {???}. Robert is a boy. Weren't there five children that set off from Rhyd? I am proud of them all. There is nobody here from my father's side but now I can turn to my album, and I will be there, in their midst. About the other side of my family - well, I might just as well not hear from any one of them! It would be very boring for you if I listed everything that has happened. I won't start as I would have to tell you the whole story. Pardon my expressing such bad feelings about my close family.

There are few left of the old families that you knew when you were here. Generation has followed generation. It is pointless to list the changes. One of your acquaintances has died – Robert Owen bach (Bethania). He had been an official at the quarry in Rhiw for 20 years, but had been retired a few years ago and gone to live in Porthmadog. It was said that he left a sum of £20,000 in his will. Owen Rowlands and Hugh Lewis died years ago - both of these men also had amassed quite a large sum of money. Few workers have been able to rise above their status in life like this.

S.D. Roberts sent me several copies of The Salt Lake Tribune and I got a lot of enjoyment from reading them. The old Dome gets a very good share of paying taxes {???}. This makes me think that he must be doing good business. Good for him!

Where are Daniel and family, Aunt Gwen and children, and my Uncle Daniel? A word about them would be much appreciated.

I can only remember Catherine and Eliza. I seem to recall that one son died crossing the Missouri?

I and my family really appreciate getting your photographs. Tell Aunt Mary and children that I am very grateful for their kindness too. I intend to have my own family photo taken, and I will send a copy on to you in the Mormon Land.

I can only hope that this letter finds you all well and I end by sending best regards to you all. "My best love to your Missus and baby" {*in English*}. I would be grateful to hear from you at your earliest convenience.

Yours until death

Your Cousin

Robert Roberts

Dear Cousin

I got your letter on November 6th and was very pleased to receive it. It gives a good account of all the family, not just news about the death of old Aunt Mary. I hope that she was warmly welcomed to the Happiness of her Lord.

I got a letter from her about 25 years ago and she asked me for a "long Welsh letter", but I lost her address, so I did not get back to her. I hope that her children all are well. Give them my condolences.

I am re-reading your letter. David the son of your old friend David Roberts was badly hurt as one of the pulleys in the quarry mill caught him as he was trying to replace the strap on a moving pulley. He broke his arm, sending his shoulder out of position and received a huge wound to his head. Thankfully, he is improving and starting to go out.

I understand that you have heard from Evan that my mother died about eighteen months ago. Of all bereavements nothing is as bad as losing your mother. You probably have already received quite a full account from Evan since he is a member of The Leaders of the Third Party {???}. It would take me too much time and space to go through what happened, so if you have been given any account which you would like an explanation about, please write me a note and I promise to reply in detail about the circumstances.

Somebody that you knew very well died last week – Robin Dafydd James (aged 80).

I have received several papers and books from S.D. Roberts. Tell him that I am very grateful for them.

I must say that I am surprised that your son is a Mormon missionary. It is a pity that you misunderstand and misuse the holy Scripture. I accept that the olden times have ...?... but you are confident that when predicting for another 30 years {???

I am glad to hear that you and your wife are having more children. They will doubtless be of great comfort to you when you are 90 years old. I am quite different; I often think that this may be the last that you hear from me. When I return to the area where I used to live there are no family members left. Rees (son of Rees Roberts) sometimes visits me - his wife and daughter live just a few yards away from me.

I have been given the address of Ellis Roberts and enclose it with this letter.

If you can, send my best regards to the children of Uncle John and Uncle Daniel.

I would dearly love to see you just one more time but "Goodbye" as I have almost reached 'three score years and ten' and if I have strength, I may reach 80 years "Our days may come to seventy years, or eighty, if our strength endures" {*Psalm 90*}.

We had a lovely summer and we have still not had any frost or snow.

I would be very grateful to hear from you. Make your wife write a letter in English - my daughters can compose a reply. Can your sons speak Welsh or are they monoglot English speakers? Is there any wish in Utah to see the Old Language be kept alive?

I must finish by wishing you all a happy new year. Accept our warmest regards as all family.

I remain your faithful cousin
Robert Roberts

Dear Cousin

I got your letter a while back and I am now going to try to reply. But before I start, I have to admit that you are far better at remembering things than I am. You can remember back forty years as if it were yesterday. I was only young when you set off and I can only recall yourself, Daniel and Thomas, I cannot for the life of me, recall the girls.

I too have lost both of my parents, my brother Rees and my sisters Ellen and Gwen. I still have two brothers living and two sisters – Meyrick, William, Mary and Elizabeth.

My father died aged 70 and my mother lived to be 85. My sister Ellin died in America – in Wisconsin. I don't know how old she was. My sister Gwen died aged 27 years and recently, Rees died aged 63.

Rees had three wives. From his first wife, he got a son, whom he brought him up to be a doctor – but he died aged 27 in America. His second wife gave him four sons and a daughter, but two of the boys died leaving him with only sons and one daughter living. The girl is married and lives in Corwen. One of his sons is a druggist and the other a sailor (now in South Africa). The third wife is still alive and has one daughter.

Mary was married twice, but is now a widow. She had two daughters and a son from both husbands.

I do not know how many children Meyrick has – but it is about 12.

My brother William has 5 or 6 children

My sister Eliza is a widow and has three daughters and two sons living – but has buried quite a few.

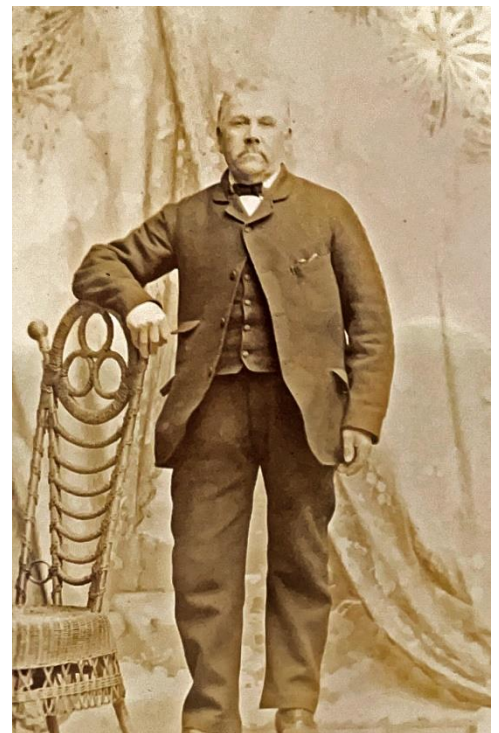
That's about all about the family. I am an exception in the family in that I have not wanted to get married thus far and it is unlikely that, considering my situation, I will decide to do so. I have not had much luck since I got here a little more than 12 years ago. I had £1,500 when I arrived but I spent every penny. I don't have much to show for it - I have 120 acres of land, but it is of no use other than to have to pay taxes for! I am going to try to sell it this summer if I can. Also, I have two houses in this town and I get a little income from them every month.

I would be glad if my circumstances allowed me to come there to see you but I am certain that I would not be able to recognise any of you! I am including my photo with this letter so that you can see what your American cousin looks like.

I am now drawing this letter to a close and send you my best regards.

Your cousin

Ellis Roberts



1301

Bangor, Pa.
November 1903

Here is the address which I received from Mrs John C Jones from Kate's eldest daughter. Kate is our cousin.

We send our best regards and wish you a Merry Christmas and Happy New Year.

E.W. Roberts

West Rutland, Vermont
6th November, 1903

1300

Dear Mr Jones

Mrs Hugh Williams asked me to send to you the address of my uncle Daniel so that you might send it to someone in Pennsylvania.

It is:

D.J. Humphrey
Hoosick Falls
New York

Hoping that you are all as family well.

I remain sincerely
Agnes Roberts

Bangor, Pa.
25th July, 1905

Mr Robert D. Roberts and family

Dear cousin

I got your letter and was glad to hear that you were all well - as we are here. I feel very blessed that we have such care over us.

You asked about my father's date of birth, but I cannot provide that at the moment. I believe that I can get it by sending a letter to Wales, to some of my brother, the late Robert's, children. I will do so and send it on to you as soon as I get it.

I do not know the address of our cousin David J. Humphreys - somewhere in New York state. But I will write to one of Robert Humphrey's children in Poultney, Vt. and as soon as I get it, I will send you this as well.

Warmest regards

Evan W Roberts

Well, cousin Robert D. Roberts

I got your letter at the end of the week. I was very sorry to hear that you both had been "imprisoned" in such circumstances. Whatever, I hope that you will both return to your normal good health very soon.

I am sorry that the doctors failed you so badly - carelessness when handling the knife! I fear that they had a poor understanding of their work and that you will again have to seek medical advice. Anyway, I hope that next time they will be more successful and that you will make a full, speedy recovery – both you and your wife, so that you can again enjoy good health together for many years and see your children grow up to be men and women of good character.

I see that your families have established themselves in that part of the country. I hope that through everything that you all – young and old, sons and daughters ..?... through faith, will see the Hills of Canaan so that you can forget your worldly grief and see Jesus as He is, excelling in everything and everybody can socialise with him – and not through any prophet or priest, but solely by having faith in His name. All communication with Him will be quiet and through the Spirit - of which the world knows nothing. That sweet community, between the spirit of God in Heaven and through His dear Son. There will be nobody that stands between us and Him. The pleasure will be a personal one, between us and God, in His Son. I trust that you, in your illness, get some consolation from this.

As you can see, I have started replying to your letter the very day that I received it, but I was called away before I could finish it. Three weeks have passed before I continue.

Dear cousin, I hope that you are keeping your spirits high despite your illness and that you get a speedy recovery next summer – both you and your wife.

The weather here is very changeable. Wet and damp some days, then turning very cold, like today. We had a snowstorm, then rain and again we had snow today with perhaps a lot more snow tomorrow. The poor weather has been responsible for much sickness here. Changeable, wet, damp and cold.

There are several things in your last letter that I wish to comment upon, but I will do so fully in my next letter.

You asked about slates. I see that you can remember that roofing slates come in various classes 1st, 2nd and 3rd class. The 3rd class are quite cheap and I would not recommend you to buy these - they aren't worth shipping so far. "No.1 slate is the best of all. Our number 1 in this valley will compare good with Old Country slate. They are good in every way" *{in English}*. I am not afraid to say so but remember that there are different prices for the different sizes.

{Table showing some size and price – illegible}

By tonight I will have made inquiries about prices as well as the cost of shipping.

Well, this letter is beginning to drag on.

Several people here are inquiring about you. Hywel, the son of Dafydd Rolant (the blacksmith) has just buried his wife. He often inquires and sends you all his regards.

Old 'Sutafiel the Mail' as we used to call him used to work with your father in Gloddfa Ganol *{BFf slate mine}*, very often asks about you and sends you his regards. He is now old, frail and quite lonely.

I am glad to say that we as a family are all well and send you all our best regards and hope that God gives you every blessing.

Regards from your cousin

Evan W. Roberts

P.S. *{different handwriting}*

Evan has been ill in bed since Monday

Mr R.D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and family

I see from your letter that I received at the start of this week that you have again met with a bereavement. I was very sorry to hear that; it leaves you with your children orphaned. I am praying that that you will be supported to meet the bitter things that come against us, wave after wave.

When bitter things come upon us it is good to remember that the Father of the Adopted and the Judge has promised to look after us in our hour of need. Our three Great Archbishops will help us out in our distress. I hope that you have come to know Him before now as the Brother and Friend of all sinners who implore Him through faith to receive His Grace. It is good for us to receive every help from godly brothers and friends in our time of tribulation but we must, each one of us, on our own, have faith in Jesus Christ, and then we will receive comfort and solace in our own hearts.

With respect to various faiths, they are good in their place, as far as they go, but they cannot keep us nor can ministers or bishops open the doors to Paradise for us nor get atonement for us for our sins. We must ask for this ourselves. Nobody is forgiven at the request of another. Sinner come into the dust and plead for it in the name of Jesus Christ who accepts us out of the grace of His heart. So we turn to Him in our hour of need and He will be found to be there waiting for us.

I see that I have gone slightly off-track. I understand that you are going to have more surgery. Well, Robert, I see that you are again to go through difficult times. It is my hope and prayer that you get a full recovery for a few more years – for the sake of your young children.

Next, I hope that your brothers Thomas and Daniel are close by so that they can help care for you and that your families are all close.

The family here are all well and talk about you very often. They send you their warmest regards and send their sympathy to their uncle in his bereavement and also wish him a full recovery.

Accept our sincerest regards – both of us, me and my wife.

I wish you the very best always and hope that you succeed in all meanings of the word.

I am as usual

Your sincere cousin

Evan W. Roberts

{added in different handwriting}

Dear Cousin

Excuse the poor handwriting and the paper.

We are worried and wish to know how you are getting on.

I wish you a speedy recovery dear brother.

I am the wife of E.W. Roberts, namely

Laura R

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Relatives

I always read your letters with the greatest pleasure. Just so this time. I was delighted to read that you are better. I feel grateful for your photograph but I have to say that it looks nothing like I remember when you were in Ffestiniog. Time changes our appearance and takes its toll on us all. I am glad to hear that your brother Thomas and his son have gone to enjoy themselves in California. I hope that they had a brilliant time there.

The //... are awaiting a girl for Daniel Hughes(?) of Pengwern(?) she is a widow with children.

What next!

I and my wife have been to Wisconsin. ...?... We were away for a month. The reason why we went is that our minister's wife died at the end of May and on behalf of the church, we went there to her old home before putting her to rest there.

There are many Welshmen in that part of the world and they have done well there. Everyone looked happy. That state is excellent for farming and a good country. It is beautiful there as you travel from Buffalo to Chicago especially.

Most of the time was spent in Chicago. A huge huge city. Really it is like a world of its own and there is beautiful country all around.

Commerce is progressing well in these areas. Everybody is in work and wages are good. This town (Bangor) is growing rapidly. There are about 7,000 inhabitants. When I arrived, there was no more than about a dozen families living here.

This has happened in just 40 years since I arrived.

You can see how time flies! We too will have sped past the limits of our time very shortly.

The most important thing is that we have prepared for our next journey which awaits us all. Oh let us hope to inherit the Truth!

There was a Sunday School meeting yesterday(September 1st) and the son of Pierce Dafydd (Tanygrisiau) spoke of Baptism and Jesus in the desert. We had a very good time and everybody took it very seriously. We got a taste of the old truths as we discussed this over and over.

Well, I must draw this to a close. I trust that these lines find you all well and that you receive all the worldly blessings that we do not deserve.

So I end with my sincerest regards

Yours faithfully, your cousin

Evan W Roberts

P.S.

We are very grateful for the photo - it is excellent.

Mr R.D. Roberts

Dear Cousin

I am not certain that it is my turn to write, but I will do so anyway since I cannot find your last letter. I have looked everywhere - but anyway, I will write.

I hope that you are by now in better health than when I last heard from you.

In part of May and June, my wife and I visited Wisconsin state, about 1,200 miles away. We went following the death of our minister's wife. Rather than leave him and his young daughter to travel all that way on their own, we went along with him. We were away from home for a month and had a very good time. My wife was keen for us to go on from there to see you as a family, but we realised that it would take us all summer, and even then, we probably would not get to see everyone.

The places that we visited were beautiful. Everyone looked comfortably off there. The Welsh have progressed to take up important positions in the area. Listening to them speak, I think that they are generally of independent means and I feel good to this day when think about them. I believe that that is how it might be in your area as well. I hope so. Nothing would give me more pleasure than to think that some of you had become *legins*?? or that some of the old family had become millionaires in this new country! It would not surprise me; it is people like us who go on to make fortunes here. Only one thing gets in the way of us, the Llety family of Llanfrothen, from becoming rich and that is that we are too honest and speak the truth when discussing business opportunities. In my opinion and in my experience, this type of person will never become very rich.

How are things regarding commerce, employment and wages in your area? Is it still good there? Farmers are dependent on next years' crops. Is commerce, employment and are wages good in the area?

There is good demand for slates and for milled stone here. This area has become an important quarrying district and the area has grown significantly. We dispatch thousands of tons every month. Prices are increasing every month in this valley - over \$60,000 in May. Within two miles ...?... their prices are similar; other things have gone well too since we arrived here 40 years ago. There was nothing here then. But what is next?

I must draw this letter to a close as it is getting too long – but I find that I get pleasure from chatting away to you like this. I hope that you too feel the same as you read it.

My mind often wanders towards my time with you. I remember you when you were young and living in Llwyn-y-Gell - a very long time ago. Now I received your photo and Oh! you are an old man of 70! I find it hard to believe, I just cannot get my mind around all the changes and new circumstances. It just wants things to stay as they were but reason tells me I must move on and accept the changed circumstances.

Despite receiving your photo (and it is a very good photo) in my mind, I will still see you as you were in the Old Country – a young man. That's what you will always be for me. And the rest of the family the same – namely Thomas and Daniel and your two sisters. My memory will still stay there and enjoy the old pleasures. But if I was ever to see you again of course my mind would have to accept all the changes that have taken place - for you and all your family. I have a good recollection of all three families in the Old Country, but time sure has changed things.

Well Robert, my dear cousin, please accept my dearest, warmest regards.

Yours

Evan W Roberts

Bangor, Pa.
2nd Sept, 1907

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Relatives

I always read your letters with the greatest pleasure; just so this time. I was delighted to read that you are feeling better. I am grateful for your photograph, but I have to say that it looks nothing like I remember you when we were in Ffestiniog. Time changes our appearance and takes its toll on us all!

I am glad to hear that your brother Thomas and his son have gone to enjoy themselves in California. I hope that they had a brilliant time there. The ...?... are waiting a girl for Daniel Hughes(?) from Pengwern(?) she is a widow with children.

What next!

I and my wife have been to Wisconsin about 1,200 miles away; we were away for a month. The reason why we went is that our minister's wife died at the end of May, and on behalf of the church, we went there to her old home, before putting her to rest there. There are many Welshmen in that part of the world and they have done well there. Everyone looked happy. That state is excellent for farming and a good country. It is beautiful as you travel from Buffalo to Chicago especially. Most of our time was spent in Chicago - a huge, huge city. To be honest, it is like a whole world of its own and there is beautiful country all around.

Commerce is progressing well in these areas too. Everybody is in work and wages are good. This town (Bangor) is growing rapidly and there are about 7,000 inhabitants here. When I arrived, there was no more than about a dozen families living here. This has happened in just 40 years since I arrived. You see how time flies! We too will have sped past the limits of our time on earth very shortly. The most important thing for us is that we have prepared well for our next journey, a journey which awaits us all. "Oh! Let us hope to inherit the Truth!"

There was a Sunday School meeting yesterday (September 1st) and the son of Pierce Dafydd (Tanygrisiau) spoke of Baptism and the experience of Jesus in the desert. We had a very good time and everybody took it very seriously. We got a taste of the Old Truths as we discussed this over and over again.

Well, I must draw this to a close. I trust that these lines find you all well and that you receive all the worldly blessings that we all get but do not deserve.

I end with my sincerest regards

Yours faithfully, your cousin

Evan W Roberts

P.S.

We are very grateful for the photo. It is excellent.

1702-1704

Bangor, Pa.
20th July, 1908

Mr R.D. Roberts and Family

Dear Cousin

Your letter arrived along with the newspapers (which are published weekly or monthly) which contained the article by the son of Uncle John Roberts (formerly of Llety, Llanfrothen).

I was delighted to read that you had all been blessed to such a degree and done so well and are now to be comfortably off.

About the ..?... and family, my wife and I were talking about the fact that it might be better for us get a ticket to come there to visit you as a family. But you are most likely all quite far apart, so that it would be difficult for us to see everybody.

I am glad that you are so happy in your current circumstances. We send you our best regards and wish that God guides you.

I go on to answer your question regarding the slate industry here. This country now compares well with the Old Country as far as the slate business goes. Our monthly payroll in this (Bangor) valley is \$100,000 per month ...?... in Slatington and communities, without considering West Bangor itself. And there is also Virginia, Vermont and Maine – those places produce huge amounts of slate. I think that we produce more slates than the Old Country at the moment. Another thing, we are gaining a foothold in the old country as well, and export a lot to England, Scotland, Ireland and Wales. They send thousands of tons from here to Wales every year. The slate industry is now important in the States and increasing all the time. The population of this town grows all the time; when I first came here (a little over 40 years ago) there were no more than two dozen families in the town, but today it is close to 7,000 and the surrounding villages add to that. The population has increased a lot along with the slate industry.

I must draw this to a close – it is getting too long.

However, I feel that it is only fair that I tell you something about my circumstances. I am not what you would call poor – I have a *little* put aside. I am not rich by any means but, by the grace of Heaven above, I hope that we have enough to carry us through this life, so that I will not have to depend on others. These days, I feel that I am getting on – I was 65 last February. Daniel is a bit older than me if I recall correctly.

Edward Foulkes and Howell (son of Blacksmith Dafydd Rowland) send you their regards. Joseph Griffith ("Joe Dolgarregddu") was here recently and asked about you and sends his regards. He is now a very old man. His wife is the daughter of William Roberts (shoemaker).

The weather has been very hot this year and it affects my healthy more than in the past. Well, accept my sincerest wishes.

I remain, your cousin

E.W. Roberts

102 Bellevue Ave. north
Seattle
July 22, 1908

Dear Cousin

I heard from your brother Thomas and he said that you wanted a programme for the big fair that is being held here. I am afraid that there is no such thing as a single programme, just daily timetables; that is just a daily programme.

It is likely that you will be here when the Eisteddfod is to be held, namely August 27-28. It looks as if there will be more Welsh here than ever before on the shores of Puget Sound. Many compositions have already been received and there will be choirs attending from all over the place. There are signs for a very successful eisteddfod - let's hope that it turns out that way.

The weather in this part of the country is now very favourable and many thousands visit the Fair every day - I have kept records from the first day. It is certainly worthwhile to make a sacrifice in order to see what they have assembled there. Truly excellent.

If there is anything that I can do for you, then I will do it at once if I can.

Best regards

Ellis Roberts

Attendance at Fair on July 21st was 26,134

Total to date 1,244,948

Daily average 24,410

Mr David D. Roberts - the son of my old and faithful friend David Roberts of Blaenau Ffestiniog

I received your wise and courteous letter giving me information about the Ffestiniog district and its inhabitants and asking about some of the Welsh who had emigrated to Utah.

Travelling to Utah in those days was quite a dangerous ordeal – there is a thousand miles between the Mississippi and Salt Lake City. The travellers set off from the Mississippi near Omaha and crossed the Plains and the Rocky Mountains whilst being ravaged by wild animals and savage Indians who believed that the White Man had no right to set foot on their land. They spied on us migrants, waiting for any opportunity to steal our animals and kill us. We had to be on the lookout day and night with guns at the ready and up to a year??? 1863 when soldiers settled in Salt Lake City and controlled the Indians and there was fierce fighting between the soldiers and the Indians in the northern part of the Valley. They more or less eliminated the whole tribe, before this, they were dangerous and out of control – stealing and threatening to come down to kill the inhabitants. Day and night, we had to carry arms when went into the fields or forests in case they jumped us without warning. The inhabitants had to fight them for various parts of the province before 1863. Since then, a change has taken place and the Indians have become more docile and begun to live like the White Man and build houses and schools.

Sometime towards the end of 1857, arrangements began for the holding of an eisteddfod in Salt Lake City on January 18th, 1858. The main competition was to compose six *englyn* {forms of Welsh poetry} – I can't remember what the other competitions were. People travelled 100 miles on foot or by wagon. There was, at the time, no money around and everybody had to carry their own food and bedding or rely on the charity of those they met along the way – just like hobos. From this we can see that love for the old Welsh traditions still burned in their breasts. There was disagreement and violence between the Government and the Saints and there was no eisteddfod or gathering of the Welsh until 1895 when another eisteddfod was held in Salt Lake City for two days and also in Logan for two days. This was a very successful eisteddfod. Another eisteddfod is to be held in Salt Lake City on 1st 2nd and 3rd of October of next year. It is likely that a large crowd will gather in Salt Lake City. A Cymanfa of Saints will be held on the 4th, 5th and 6th and a fair of everything that is grown locally – all sorts of fruit, trees, animals of all sort. The winners in all categories will go forward to compete for the main prize. In Malad City, Idaho, the Welsh from all over the Malad Valley come together to hold a one a one-day eisteddfod annually.

Regarding religion:

The Christian world is full of religions and this is increasing year by year, with various reformers forming groups and beliefs to worship according to their own interpretation or fancies. They all aim to lead their followers away from evil. This is good, but by reading the "old" Bible we read that religion in the time of Jesus Christ and the Apostles, ???Sadiwsas Faresis??? and others, and forms of religion, but this was not acceptable to the Saviour of the World. They had formed new forms of worship. They did not Tithe and they encouraged people to do good deeds thinking that they were following the teachings and the commandments set down by Moses. They said that Moses and the prophets were enough for them - in their blindness and in their blind belief in the laws of Moses they rejected the inheritor who was given authority by God to perform the sacraments of His house. I was talking to a Catholic once and he said that read that their authority came from Peter. Of course, Peter and the Apostles ...??... death of world religions or end of different religions.... collect in the city of Nice if I remember correctly.

...???...going around following different religions ... that would bring religious peace and an end to murder and stoning by forming beliefs that would be acceptable to all the world's people. Constantine the Great was emperor at the time and according to his command, a huge gathering of people was called. His father was a heathen but his mother was a Christian. According to the story, he did not follow any religion but he must have felt compassion for the Christians because of his mother. After the church officials were done away with, there was nobody left with authority and the ability to defend the Church. They were like a land subjugated by its enemies with nothing to do but watch on as its enemies did as they saw fit, and all through the influence of Constantine, calling themselves Christians.

Today, on which foundation do the Latter Day Saints stand?

On the basis of revelations that Father and Son revealed to man in these Latter Days. Joseph Smith was a 14-15 year-

old boy at a time when there was a religious revival in his local community. He went into the woods to pray and to ask the Lord which one of all these religions was the True Religion. And the Father and Son appeared...

Regarding the religion of the Saints in Utah:

The basis for the religion of the Latter Day Saints is a direct statement from God that the Father and Son appeared in our days to speak with man and in order to train him in the proper way of life they sent angels several times to prepare his mind to accept various the keys of various ordinances of the Kingdom – just as in the time of Jesus Christ and the Apostles. The Angel John the Baptist came and placed his right hand on the head of Joseph Smith and his left hand on the head of Christ. ...?... and presented the Aaronic Priesthood to them. Peter, James and John presented the priesthood of Melchizedek. Moses came and presented keys to collect the saints together. Elijah brought the keys to turn the hearts of the Fathers towards the children and the children towards the fathers. His way was to build temples and to celebrate ordinations in the Temple and present blessings to the deserving. They were authorised to call men to different occupations in the Church- Teacher, Priest, Elder, Three-score-and-ten, Archbishop, Patriarch, and Prophets; all the church members just as in the time of Jesus Christ and the Apostles. They have been instructed to set out before the world that which they have been given and the evidence which they know. All who obey with open hearts and come forward to be baptised and who present themselves to the Holy Spirit will get evidence for themselves to allow them to decide whether it is God or Man that they are going to obey.

Now, where is it the fraud in this promise - which is just as it was in the time of the Apostles? Everyone will get evidence. When Jesus asked the Disciples who do they say...??... to Peter he answers "Well who do you say that I am?" Peter answers. Jesus answers. God bless you Simon, son of Jonah because it is not flesh and bone that you have seen but my Father who is in Heaven. It is not possible for our flesh to give information or evidence about the truth of the gospel of Christ; this comes directly from God.

If the leader of the Church gets a revelation then the members are entitled to know if it comes from God or from Man. The Saints are not in the dark if they live according to their professed beliefs. We can read Revelations Ch.14 Vs.6 and also Daniel Ch.2 Vs.44-45 from which we see that God in Heaven will do something different to anything on earth in the days of the Kings themselves. The world generally believes that there will be no Revelation or prophesy after this. Read Acts Ch.2 Vs.17 and from this we can see that prophesies and visions happen regularly. Also read Micah Ch.4 Vs. 1+2 Esiah Ch.2 Vs.2+3 As you read these verses you will see that the Saints have come in order to present these prophesies that were foreseen hundreds of years ago. Over all the years, they have lived on, on mountain summits, on the continental backbone of America.

When the True Religion reigned on earth a promise was made between God and Man. They were given visions and prophesies to guide them in all sorts of circumstances and to light their way in darkness. Now when the revelations and prophesies stopped the world was cast into darkness. People stumbled around, shouting that they had found the route to salvation – so that the world became full of false creeds with no light to lead them. But then, after Babel, Joseph Smith came when there was a big religious revival in the area where he lived. All the sects were fighting to attract larger audiences. Joseph Smith went into the woods to pray and asked the Lord which of all the religions had the Truth, so that he could join them. The answer was that not one of them worshiped Him – they had been led astray and that He, the Living God, had great deeds that he was going to do on earth and He would restore the Holy Bishopric and that he Joseph would be God's instrument to carry forward this work.

Well Mr Roberts, it is likely that, by now, you are more than tired with my ramblings. Remember that I have left Wales some 52 years ago and it is not easy as I would wish for me to find the right words to convey my thoughts. If you see any merit in this article, I would like you to dress it in the appropriate language so that it will satisfy linguistic perfectionists and other critics.

22 Main St., Bangor, Pa.
3rd April, 1909

Mr Robert D Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

Here I am writing you a short note, hoping that it finds you fit and well, as we are, to a degree. I am partly recovered, but not totally, but I hope that, as the weather improves, then so shall my health improve.

This winter has been very changeable sometimes wet, cold and damp. The weather has caused a lot of illness here; much illness and many deaths among the young as well as the old; no difference between them— when the Call comes, they have to go. It is important to be ready when the Call comes.

I have nothing much to add. Commerce has not been very good here this past year or so, but we hope for better times as spring comes. That's what everybody says.

We as Calvinistic Methodists are repairing our chapel. I think that it is going to look pretty good when finished. We will re-open around the start of June. At that time, we expect to have ministers to lead our prayers that God gives us Eternal Life.

I enclose my photograph - you complained that I had not done so.

Well, accept our sincere regards.

Bangor, Pa.
24th May, 1910

Mr Robert D Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

I received your letter on the 23rd. Thank you very much for your kind invitation to come visit you. I would be delighted to see you all; I very often think about you. However, we have already made all the arrangements to visit the Old Country. We will be setting off from New York on Saturday the 28th. We will be on our way by the time that you receive this letter.

The main reason for my trip is to follow my doctor's instructions as I have not been too well for quite some time. I am though, feeling better now, otherwise I would not think of going. My wife will of course accompany me.

If we have a few more years, we may well come out there to see you, but our time is running out. If we are spared a few more years, we will make every effort to come to see you.

Things are quite busy here now and it is difficult to get this letter written. Old friends are popping in as I try to write. There are three or four women chatting to my wife in the other room as I write.

I must repeat words that you wrote in one of your letters a few years ago, that I am truly fortunate to have a life-partner who is a good wife and has looked after me over the years and is a truly religious person and a quiet woman.

Accept our kindest regards as a family.

Your Cousin

Evan W Roberts

P.S.

I really hope that you are fully recovered and that your family are all well and enjoying all life's blessings.

Bangor, Pa.
12th May, 1910

Mr Robert D Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

After far too long a delay I answer your letter. I hope that you will excuse me. I have been quite poorly in my health this past 18 months but now feel better.

It has been a long fight in my mind these past few months whether to come there and visit you family members or go to the Old Country to visit. Now, I have made my mind up. My wife and I will be going to the Old Country setting off on the 28th of May if everything goes right.

The children have all grown into men and women who can look after themselves and so I feel compelled to visit the old haunts one more time before I leave this world.

Last summer my wife and I were down in Maryland visiting Joseph Griffith (the *Del* as we'd call him) and his wife – the daughter of William Roberts the shoemaker who used to live in Four-Crosses. Humphrey Lloyd and his brother Ed all send their regards.

On returning, we heard that your son was in Washington D.C. with the government. I am sorry that I did not know this before now. It is not far from here to Washington – I would have gone there to see him.

The son of Joseph Griffith I believe is a foreman in one of the newspaper offices there.

My wife got a letter from your nephew William Morgan recently along with a photograph of her and her mother and also brother and she was pleased to receive it; she has shown it to lots of people.

Next, a man from Seattle called on his way to the Old Country. He had met you in Salt Lake City and had met your brother and his son in Seattle as I understood. He was not well though; I hope that he is now better and that you too are now healthy.

With kindest regards to you all as family.

Your Cousin

Evan W Roberts

P.S.

I hope to visit old Brondanw {*Ramoth*} cemetery in Llanfrothen and will place flowers on the graves of those resting there.

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

Here I am sending you a few words after our return from the Old Country, having spent four months there. To be honest, I have never spent a more pleasant few months in my life. I experienced the utmost hospitality and my health was much better than I had anticipated before I set off.

There have been huge changes there since we left. From the bog at Glan-y-Pwll, all the way across, they have built and there is now one large town. They have all the travelling facilities that you would expect and you can go from there to anywhere very easily. The old quarries have really grown; the more they work, the more wealth they discover. The slate has been developed and it is clear that there are sufficient resources for centuries to come.

The faces there have changed; there were few of our acquaintances remaining, having been taken to their Eternal Rest. I visited about twelve cemeteries to see where old friends had been laid to rest.

I visited the old Brondanw {*Ramoth*} cemetery in Llanfrothen, and saw my father and brother's grave. The gravestone is in good condition and did not require any work done to it. My Gelli grandmother and grandfather are also there, as is my Uncle Edward and his wife, Uncle Robert and his wife, and their son and daughter – Gwen (& husband) and William.

At my father and brother's grave I felt how strange it was to see a man of 64 standing beside the grave of his father and brother, and shedding tears, which fell on a tiny patch of ground which was their grave.

I met all my cousins from both sides. Mary and Elizabeth (daughters of Erw Fawr) have grown old and frail. Their brother Meurig Roberts is still well and lives in Towyn, Merionethshire with his sister, Mary. It is a pleasant place – lots of visitors in the summer.

The name of my Gelli grandfather's father was Robert Roberts. I did not find out exactly where he came from, but it was somewhere around Clynnog. That's where the old family came from.

We visited Harlech, Beaumaris and Dolgellau and then went on to Leeds in Yorkshire, England. This took us more than five weeks.

Then we returned to Ffestiniog and afterwards we went via Llanrwst to Penmaenmawr, Llanfairfechan, Bangor, Caernarfon and Lanberis. We did not climb Snowdon as it was too wet. After a week in Lanberis we returned to the old town of Caernarfon for a day and from there on to Penygroes and Llanllyfni for four days, before returning to Ffestiniog.

By now it had almost become time to head home. We visited Dolwyddelan, Trawsfynydd, Penrhyndebydraeth and Llanfrothen - but none of the old family remain.

We set off on October 7th (?) on the Moritania and arrived in New York on the 7th and got home at 7pm after travelling all day. Our youngest son, second daughter and two granddaughters were waiting for us. They were all well and everything had gone well and there was no bad news to report. We were grateful to the Father of all Goodness for his utmost care for us as a family on all our travels.

We had bad weather on the voyage home – everyone was sea-sick for more than half of the voyage; I have never seen as many people being ill. Everybody felt relieved and happy by the time we arrived in New York and had been met by our families.

In Harlech, we stayed with the sister of your first wife; she's called Mrs Humphreys. She is 80 years old but still very smart-looking. Her oldest daughter lives with her and they are very contented. We had a great time there with all the old relatives.

Well, I will finish now as I have no more news. Everybody sent you their best regards.

I am as always,
Your Cousin
Evan W. Roberts
P.S.

I have one small favour to ask. Bryfdir asks if you have any poetry that you could send him. If you send them to me, I will forward them.

Dear Cousin

Here is a photo of my cousin Jane and me that I took in a bit of a rush just before setting off. You can see how well she looks. She is 13 years older than me. We were delighted to meet once again. She said that she had lived with my parents for a few years when she was young.

She has one daughter at home with her who is a seamstress and her mother helps out as needed. I will try to get a better photo for you.

We must make some economies now I'm afraid – but if I had the means, I would like to go on travelling.

Best regards
Laura Roberts

Mr Robert D Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

I am taking a few moments to write you a short note, hoping that you are well, as we ourselves are, to quite a degree, at the moment thanks to Heavenly Providence.

Firstly, as you know, your son D.R. Roberts came here to visit us. We were delighted to see him and enjoyed his company for about ten days. Time just flew – we didn't have half enough time with him.

We heard a lot of news about the family in Utah and surrounds. We were very happy to hear of your successes and to hear that you also partook of the spiritual and eternal aspects of life.

I am surprised that you have not made more of an effort to retain the Welsh language in your religious circle.

I must say again that we enjoyed their company immensely whilst they were here with us. I felt bad that our daughter Margaret was not home so that they could see us all. But she did not return home until after they had left. I have sent them a photo of her (to Washington).

We really hope that we can see you here before your son and family return back there. Perhaps you will visit him in Washington and, from there, come on to visit us. We will eagerly await this.

I am not going to give you any Bangor news as I am sure that he will have told you all about that.

Before I finish, remember us to Thomas and family, Daniel and family, Ann and family, and Jane and family, and also the family of your late sister Elizabeth. We wish you all well.

It is likely that you have received the photo of the 'old crew', I hope that you will be able to remember everybody. Old William Williams (the 'mail stable' we'd call him in the Old Country - and we do here as well) who used to work with you when you set off. He is now 84 years old and, as the photo shows, still quite well. All the crew send you kindest regards.

I will finish by hoping that these lines find you enjoying full health.

We as a family come together in wishing you all the best.

I remain

Your cousin

Evan W Roberts

{in different handwriting}

Your son and his family are very nice people. They look just like my family – by which I mean his mother's side of the family.

I am your cousin's wife

Laura

22nd Main St, Bangor, Pa.
15th April, 1913

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

Thank you for your kind letter expressing sympathy to us as a family in our bereavement.

I don't know what to say other than we are reasonably well these days. Our son William's wife has started to improve and we are very thankful for that.

We miss my wife terribly; she was a caring wife and mother. A better wife, mother or Christian was never put to rest.

I am enclosing this Memorial Card along with the letter. My son Clarence sent a dozen of the cards to David R. Roberts a while back but has not received an acknowledgement. He thought that he knew better than us how to distribute these cards amongst the family. Anyway, I am sending this directly to you.

Accept our very best regards,

Your Cousin

E.W. Roberts

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

I have delayed writing much longer than I had intended to. Although I have intended to reply to your very kind letter every day, I just could not settle down to do so.

Things have changed dramatically here for us. Mrs Roberts left us a year ago today – exactly a year ago today was her last day here on earth. She finished her worldly days at half past midnight, with her husband, sons daughters and grand-children around her bed as she drew her last breath.

I feel very lonely despite having all the children around me. But I must say that they have been very good to me.

It is likely that you have heard of the bereavement in Harlech last summer near Dolgellau. He and his family used to come on holiday to Wales every year from Leeds. Perhaps you remember that near Dolgellau there is a steep hill, down into town. The car lost control and she was thrown out and injured. She died within a day at a local hotel. She was buried in a family grave in Harlech. She was a good woman who raised a good family all of whom who grew into good men and women. I and my wife visited them and spent a week there. They were well-off, in a good business there.

Things are looking pretty bad around here. Several of the quarries have shut and others work a three-day week. Many are unemployed.

I do not know what to make of this Democratic government – things look pretty bad! The large towns complain bitterly that nothing is happening. Everything is being shipped into the country from the old countries and millions of dollars will have left the country very soon if things continue as they are. Perhaps things may improve, but at the moment, things are looking bad.

Where is Jab?(Job?)? We have not heard from him since he left for Washington. Are they alive and well? Give them our regards, also Thomas & family, Daniel & family, your two sisters, Ann and Elizabeth. I hope that you are all, as families, well and enjoying life fully and making preparations to enjoy the next life in the presence of the Saints and Jesus Christ in Heaven.

Our views on these things differ, but the important thing is that we depend upon Jesus Christ as our only Saviour . He is the Truth who will pay for our sins. He is our Archbishop who has ascended to Heaven to plead on our behalf. It is not any man-made organisation that will bring sinners into Heaven but Jesus Christ, who died, rose the third day and ascended to Heaven. It is not Mormonism, nor the Papacy of the Church of Rome, nor John Wesley, nor John Calvin, nor any other man, however good he might be, only communion with faith in God in His son Jesus Christ. This is the only basis for hope of our Eternal Life in His Son.

I am not going to say any more. It is not things that men believe that will keep others, it is necessary for everyone to argue their own case in the name of Jesus Christ. Also he is the Truth for our sins. Neither Pope nor Bishop will keep us, man himself must bend down and plead for forgiveness in the name of Jesus Christ.

He is the head of the church and nobody else will do.

Happy New Year to you all

Your Cousin

E.W. Roberts

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

At the start of a new year I need to write you a few words to inform you of our loss - namely the death of my beloved wife, on December 19th after five days of illness. She died quietly, releasing herself into the arms of Jesus, with faith that she would have a better future. She was buried on the 23rd. I, and all the children, were by her bedside as she drew her last breath. She recognised us all up until an hour before the end. I can easily say a better wife waws never laid to rest than her.

She has gone to her reward and left us behind for a while to grieve. Our sadness is huge.

I believe that she suffered a stroke on the Saturday 14th December as we were going to bed around midnight. She was well before that and enjoyed herself and ate a good supper and put the dishes away as usual and was as happy as any of us. At around 11 o'clock she complained of a headache. "Well," my eldest daughter said and prepared some spirits of camphor and alcohol for her and she was then much better. My daughter added "You had better go to bed. It is close to midnight. I will come and help you undress" "No, No. I will manage myself" she replied." I said "You go first and I will wait until you have gone and I will put out the light". So, she went to bed. We went to our bedroom door and asked "Are you ready?" and she replied that she wanted a damp cloth to put on her forehead. I asked her if she was better and she replied that she was better but asked for a warm cloth for her forehead. She went to bed and I brought the warm cloth and put it on her forehead. As I was putting it there, she had a stroke. I thought that she had died there and then – even before I had called the girls. But we called for a doctor and he arrived within a few minutes and stayed until 4a.m. On the Sabbath she improved and became quite coherent and recognised us all by the afternoon. She was again better on Monday and Tuesday, and began to talk more and to recognise us all. But by Wednesday she was obviously not as well and was clearly weakening. She was the same on Thursday but still ate a little and recognised us all. At half past midnight on the 19th her spirit flew up to God who gave her Eternal Peace.

I hope that you will inform the Rev. William Morgan and family of this, as I cannot find their address. Our son Clarence will write to David D. Roberts in the next few days so I will not go into detail.

I ask you to accept our kindest regards as a family.

Here I am, in quite a bad mental state,

Your Cousin

E.W. Roberts

Mr Roberts

Dear Cousin

Thank you for your letter. We had mis-placed your address or I would have written to you earlier, to inform you that I had left America, a while back - I did not stay very long after having lost my old friend M.J. Williams. It is not likely that I will return, except, perhaps, to attend the large San Francisco exhibition to celebrate the opening of the Panama Canal.

I will try to answer your questions as well as I can. First of all, questions about family matters.

My brother **Rees** died aged 63 and left his third wife widowed; by now she too has followed him. He had one child from his first wife, and he brought him up to be a doctor, but he died in America over 20 years ago. From the second wife, he had five children, three of whom are still living. One keeps a drug store in Menai bridge, another is a ship's captain, then there is a daughter who has married a preacher and lives in Corwen, another daughter, from the third wife, has graduated as B.A. and now works in South Wales with the Insurance Act and has a good salary.

Mary lives in Towyn and is widowed, having lost two husbands; one child from first husband lives in Ffestiniog. Both the son and husband were killed in the setts works in Penmaenmawr. He was in America for a short while. She had two daughters with the last husband, one lives with their mother in Towyn, one is a teacher and another is a cook. They keep a lodging house.

Bryfdir (the poet) is the son of Mary. He has won about two dozen eisteddfodic chairs.

Ellin died in America over 40 years ago. She was married and her husband has now joined her.

Eliza, had lots of children - six of whom are still living. She is the least successful of all of us. Her husband died around the same time as my brother Rees.

Meurig has lots of children – seven sons and one daughter (living) and two who passed away. They all had a good education. The eldest is a quarry supervisor in Corwen, one is in South Africa (and quite poorly at the moment), one is a farmer, another a carpenter, another a doctor, another a banker and one is the secretary of an education board. The daughter is married to a newspaper reporter.

William died aged 61. He had several children, five of whom are still alive. One has been to South Africa for a while and two has been to America. Two are married and one son and two daughters living at home with them.

My sister **Gwen** died quite young. Her husband was killed in the quarry, shortly after her death. They had three children. One son is a quarry supervisor (in Llanbedr near Harlech), another is a minister in Manchester. The daughter is married and lives very close to us. Her husband has gone to South Africa. I think that they are comfortably off.

I don't have any more family information for you. They have all moved away from Llanfrothen, except for one of Eliza's daughters. It is now strangers that live everywhere apart from Ynysfor- where the same family live (now into the third generation there).

The old **Llety** is no more – it fell into ruin many years ago.

Griffith Griffiths now lives in **Erw Fawr**, the son of Bwlch Llindir (Croesor), his brother used to live in Carreg Alldrem but he has since died, but family still live there.

The old **Factory** is empty as well as the **Pandy**. Strangers live in **Gelli** and in **Parc**. One of Aunt Gwen's family now lives in **Cae Glas** (my mother's old home).

Best regards to you all as family

Ellis Roberts

People's Coal Company
One Block North of Logan Depot
Corner 1st North and 6th West St

19th October 1914

Mr. D.D. Roberts – son of my dear friend David Roberts who has left this worldly realm

Mr Roberts, as you see, I have not totally forgotten you! Quite a while has passed since you have heard from me, but from this you will see that I am still in the Land of the Living!

I am enjoying quite good health and have food and clothing to fulfil my worldly needs. How are the people of Ffestiniog doing? Are things continuing with their good deeds and are they successful in worldly matters. How has the War affected the country?

Can you tell me your father's date and place of birth and also when he died? Is your mother still alive? Who are her family? I hope that this does not inconvenience you.

I am sending you the Revelation that was given to Joseph Smith in May 1843. In the year 1844, he was murdered by a murdering mob who disgraced themselves with this treacherous act. Do with it as you see fit; if you think that it is worthy of your attention, you may want to translate it *{into Welsh}* and send it to the newspaper. If so, remember to send me a copy of the paper. But remember, if you do not think that this would be wise, then I will agree with you. It is likely that he did not recount his Revelation with the purpose of publication, but during the present War, some might want to keep a written copy, lest it be lost. One of my neighbours took it to the newspaper and here is a copy. Do with it as you see fit. If convenient, show it to Bryfdir.

Bangor, Pa.
10th April, 1915

Robert D Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

Today I am sending the rest of the hazel trees by Adams Express. That means that they will arrive more quickly and safer. I think that they have been well-packed in a strong box.

I did not pay Adams Express but chose "Pay at other end".

I paid \$1 to a farmer who lives close to me to dig them up and bring them down here. They were raised in the foothills of the Blue Mountains. The reason why I asked the farmer to raise them from his own farm is that I only go out very rarely these days. I hadn't been out for four weeks until this last week. My son William is now working and so he did not have the time to go looking for them either.

I hope that they will reach you safely.

I finish by wishing you all well.

Your Cousin

E W Roberts

P.S. Let me know when they arrive. All that I paid was the \$1 for the Dutchman.

Your Cousin

E.W. Roberts

Mr Robert D. Roberts

Dear Cousin and Family

I received the two letters from you and a large bundle of newspapers. The reason that I have not replied sooner is that I have not been well. I have not written more than two letters in the whole of the last year.

Last spring, I had a bad spell and I was in bed for about four weeks and I have still not recovered fully. I feel weak and cannot eat very much – I have no taste for food. I don't mind missing mealtimes. I have recently had more of an appetite, but still not enough for me to gather my strength back.

Some of our family news now. Everybody, apart from me, are well. Commerce is poor – most small businesses have only been working three days a week since the middle of last summer. Recently they stopped working in all the big quarries and only some of the smaller ones still produce slates. It appears that we are going to have a hard time until we change the government in Washington. Wilson & Brayn (??) have run us to the wall. The Democratic Party cannot run anything here. They need a lot more schooling. There were never as many people unemployed as there are now. New York Stant (??) Steel has thousands dependent on charity.

Despite this, there is a religious fervour in our midst and God is being hailed. In Bangor, hundreds have become members of the churches. There is a big General Revival - amongst all races in our town and Balle(??) Sunday has been a means to save thousands. He is doing good and a great service to our church as I understand; I hope that his health keeps up so that he can keep on doing good and serve our Heavenly Father to bring thousands to the Saviour of Souls. I believe sincerely that he is being used by God to save sinners and to draw them towards Christ our Saviour. All success to him I say! My prayer is that they should not stop doing good.

Some news about our church now. We have been without a minister for three years now. We tried several men, but failed, but by now we have attracted one from the Old Country and he is just as excellent an orator in both languages. We pray that he will be a means for us as a church to attract more people to the Great Saviour, who gave His life for us and who was resurrected on the third day and who went to Heaven to plead on our behalf. "We thank Him for remembering the dust of the earth."

I finish by hoping that you will pardon me for having taken so long to reply.

In your letters, there were a few things that I had intended to comment on, but I will just finish by sending you, and all the family, my best regards.

Your Cousin

E.W. Roberts

2972-2973

Brynsaethon, Penrhyndeudraeth

March 4th 1915

Mr Roberts

I have often thought that I should write to you, but have delayed doing so I'm afraid.

I am sorry to have to inform you that Uncle Ellis has died. He had not been well all summer and died November 29th. He was buried at Ramoth, Llanfrothen in the same grave as his mother and father.

He died as a result of bladder cancer.

He leaves a big gap behind - he was always so cheerful and pleasant.

The newspapers that you sent arrived safely – thank you. Uncle would have ben very glad to have read them.

We see that you live in a very rich and beautifuyl city.

Kind regards

M.G. Roberts

Evan W. Roberts

Dear Cousin

I got your letter dated 11th February. Thank you for thinking about me and, as I am not currently busy with work, I will try to reply. I will collect my thoughts and find acceptable and understandable language and ask for a wise spirit to help me. I do not feel very confident in writing - I tend to make spelling mistakes and my mind is not as strong and as stable as it was in days gone by.

Myself and the children are quite healthy. My sister Jane has not been too well but is now improving. Ann likewise has not been too strong. David and family are in good spirits. As I understand it, Thomas has not been too well as a result of getting a chill but he is improving at the moment; he has a wife and two children.

This area has been very successful this past year. But at this time of year there is not much work around – hundreds in Salt Lake City and Utah are unemployed. The weather has been mild this past winter. I cannot remember any time when people felt more optimistic though.

I got a letter from William Daniel Roberts, the son of our uncle from Troy County (the other two children are Robert and Elizabeth) and they are all in good health and doing quite well. I also received a letter from Ellis Roberts from Penrhyn – the son of Uncle Robert. It is possible that he will come to the fair in San Francisco, California quite soon.

That's about all our news for you.

It is likely that, very soon, the children and great grandchildren of our grandfather, will have spread out so much that it will be difficult to trace and they will be strangers to one another.

Permit me at this time to draw to your attention to the Bible and Joseph Smith.

In your letter, you said things against President Wilson. Now let me draw your attention to some verses from the Bible. I will be as succinct as possible because I do not want to go on and on.

Firstly, let me draw your attention to Revelations 14⁶⁻⁷ and Daniel 2⁴⁴⁻⁴⁵. Read these chapters and verses and you will find that neither the Scripture nor the Kingdom on earth were not to be found on earth at that time. What was to happen after this arrangement read Revelations 18⁴ where were you to go, look at Isaiah 2² and Micah 4¹.

When the Saints came to Utah, there was a Mr Bridger, a mountain man who had lived here for years, trapping and selling animal skins. There was actually a community of such people living here trapping and carrying the skins to market, over a thousand miles away - to St. Louis. It is said that they told the Saints that they would pay them \$1,000 for the first ear of corn that they could grow here as it froze here every single month of the year.

In the Valley (or Salt Lake Valley) some of the Saints wanted to go on to California, but Brigham Young said "This is the place. I have seen it in a vision. This is an excellent place to be led to by a prophet."

One day walking around, he struck his staff on the ground and said "This is where the Temple for our God is to be built some day."

There were only about a hundred and fifty of these poor people; how strange that anybody could think such a thing.

But the United States sent an army of 40,000 armed men, with splendid weapons, and all trained fighters. When the Army was within 100 miles of Salt Lake City the word went out that everybody should collect to SLC to prepare to go to meet the army. My father was one of those soldiers. When they were about to set off from camp, Brigham Young came to address them and said "Brothers. If you will keep good order and attend to our prayers, you will whip them without firing a gun. There will not be a man of you lost."

The government spent \$40,000 on this. After peace was declared and they had settled here for some time the soldiers' opinion was "Nine months of winter and three months of cold weather. Let those God-damn Mormons have it!" They did not think that this land was fighting for.

What did Brigham Young have to say "Brothers. This country will become the finest country in the world. You will be able to raise anything that you want." I draw your attention to Isaiah 3⁷ once a desert but now blossoming like a rose.

Any traveller s through this country from East or West, North or South, they all praise this area for being so beautiful, and healthy.

The world pre-judges Joseph Smith because he said that he had seen the Father and Son and had spoken to them, and that angels had visited him and taught him and prepared him to be an instrument in God's hand to spread His word in these Latter Days. That was the reason for the persecution. The practise of having multiple wives had not begun at that time.

Read Joel 2²⁸⁻²⁹. From this we understand that the Spirit of God is poured generously onto God's people. If you believe in the Bible and promise to do so, as we read in Peter ii 1²¹ that God's holy people shall speak as they are inspired by the Holy Spirit with prophesies that they had quoted would come in the future or in the Latter Days.

Ask yourself, isn't it time that the Angel brought the message to the people on this planet? The last part of Nebuchadnezzar's dream that the Kingdom was to govern and that rock would rupture from the earth and fall to fill the whole earth. The question is, has the time come for this to happen? As Daniel said, somebody must be a sacrifice in God's hand and John had been baptised and prepared to come ahead of Jesus Christ, Saviour of the world.

What reason do we have not to accept Joseph Smith as an instrument in God's hand to come to prepare for the Second Coming? The promise is that we will be given proof, so that we can know what is true or not. Read John 3¹⁹. If Joseph Smith is a prophet, sent by God, remember that you are refusing God and not Joseph Smith. The Bible says that a cruel retribution will follow for the people of the earth for ignoring God's words. Joseph Smith and no other, held God's hand in 1820. Joseph Smith had the first revelation and was taught by angels, several times up until 1830, when they formed a group with six members and as they had been taught. They called it the Church of Jesus Christ Latter Day saints. As Noah had called to warn the inhabitants of the earth in those times that destruction was to be brought upon the wicked people of earth. But who believed him? You know the story. And who believed John talking about the son of God? Just a small wise group. The deluge came to seal Noah's words. Jesus Christ was the son of God. It did not matter who believed or dis-believed. It was true.

The world has received the evidence of Joseph Smith and his followers, for 95 years, know that the scripture had been restored and Joseph Smith's prophesy verified. But who believes them? Only a small handful, to preach to all the people of the world. But it is true that there are thousands in Utah who testify that they know that Joseph Smith was one of the prophets and that God had honoured him with His presence in these days just as in Abraham's days.

My father was very keen to come from the Old Country before the sea closed so that it would be dangerous to cross the sea. He sought to escape before war, hunger and plagues struck the people of the world. I thought that these things would have happened before now, but God has His own time to do His will.

About 25 years ago I worked in SLC and stayed at the same hotel as a Catholic. We started talking in a friendly manner about religion. The government was unhappy with the Saints at that time so I did not volunteer to speak about religion. He asked "What's happening in your religion? Was it handed down from the Apostle Paul?" "Well, didn't your religion exist before Jesus born?" Yes! Who persecuted and stoned the Saints? Not the different religions which existed at that time. In what way did they get their authority from Peter? The big question!

Constantine the Great, his mother was a Christian, the daughter of Coelgodebog(?) and his father was a pagan from Rome. When Constantine came to power he felt and wanted to join up all the religions so in the year 314AD he decreed that all the world's religions were to come to the city called Nice, France. With a view to assuring peace they would create one religion, which everyone could agree to, thus ensuring peace. This would be called Catholicism or General Unity. In Welsh Peter had died 200 years before this mix-up was to happen. One of our priests met with one of the Catholic priests to talk. The Catholic said that the big effort was to be between us and you, and the other religions do not count as they are just derived from us and it is likely that the children will turn their backs on them.

My father joined the Saints on May 24th 1846. I arrived in Utah in 1856, almost 59 years ago. I have seen many changes and much persecution and mocking of the Saints. This is cruel and unfounded and it has poisoned the minds of thousands of people across the world so that they cannot read or listen to anything that comes from the Saints. Many say good things, and like Nebuchadnezzar, they worship the god of Daniel. But they would not come together to worship the god of Daniel. He had a god whom he had worshipped all of his life.

Now I can testify to you in all seriousness and truth that I know without a shadow of doubt that I am certain that Joseph Smith was God's chosen prophet and the vision of Joseph Smith is what I have passed on to you.

Most of it has already come true, the remaining part is sure to be realised.

I will not judge you at all if you do not believe what I have written. If one is to judge God's deeds then He has to open our eyes so that we can see and understand His words. We will get evidence as Jesus told Peter "The blood made this known to you but it was my father that was the one"(???). Read. Understand. Be wise. Do not refuse the incitement of the Holy Spirit. Judge for yourself.

Be great!

I remain in the kindest way

Your cousin

R.D. Roberts

Preswylfa
Rhiwbryfdir
Blaenau Ffestiniog
N. Wales
July 27th 1917

My Dear Uncle

Thanks to the local postmaster, I received your letter yesterday. I find a letter from a distant land to very interesting – especially as it comes from a branch of the Llety and Erw Fawr family. I have spoken often about you and made inquiries.

I did not receive the letter which you said that you had sent me a few years ago – I have only received a Christmas greeting from your sister (my aunt) and then she did not include a return address so that I could acknowledge receipt.

I remember your brother well; he stayed for quite a while with my mother (who is still alive and 83 years old).

David D. Roberts (son of David Roberts of Dorfil Street) is no longer in this area; he moved to work in Liverpool due to the recession in the slate mines. I will probably see him soon and will be sure to say that you were inquiring about him and asking about the old family.

With this letter I attach an issue of *{the journal}* Cymru. In it you will see a photograph of me and be able to read a bit about my career. (I have another copy if any other member of your family wants a copy – just let me know in your next letter – a letter which I hope to receive very shortly).

My mother is not at hand and so I cannot immediately find out the family information which you wanted and so I cannot include this with my letter. I will however have formed a full genealogy for you in just a few days.

We are trying to live our lives with the backdrop of War. We spent all our money on our two eldest sons – one is working in a bank, the other works in a store, but we have to yield them to the army. I have no idea what will become of them – their mother and I daily "fear for the worst and hope for the best".

By the way, my wife was over in the States for seven years. She graduated with honours from Albany College. We have a very comfortable home, were it not for the shadow of War. We are well-known across the country and have featured often - on paper and on stage. Anything that you have sent should certainly have got to me – I get letters from all over the world with just the simple address "Bryfdir, Blaenau Ffestiniog". You must bear in mind though that the Germans have sunk many British and American ships recently and a letter is easily lost as it makes its way over the waves.

I would like you to send me the addresses of more of the Old Family in Utah and I trust, dear Uncle, that you will continue to write to me, despite the weight of old age pressing on your shoulders.

I do not know what will become of us in the slate district. If the war lasts another winter, I believe that every slate mine will have closed (at least temporarily). That would be a huge loss but the wheels have been turning slowly for many a year.

I must not tire you with an over-long first letter. I cannot stress enough how happy I was to hear from you. I will now be like the fabled watchman on the tower looking expectedly towards the rising of the sun from the land of the darkness.

Wishing you a good and restful afternoon.

Your nephew
Humphrey Jones (Bryfdir)

Mr R.D. Roberts, Logan City, Utah